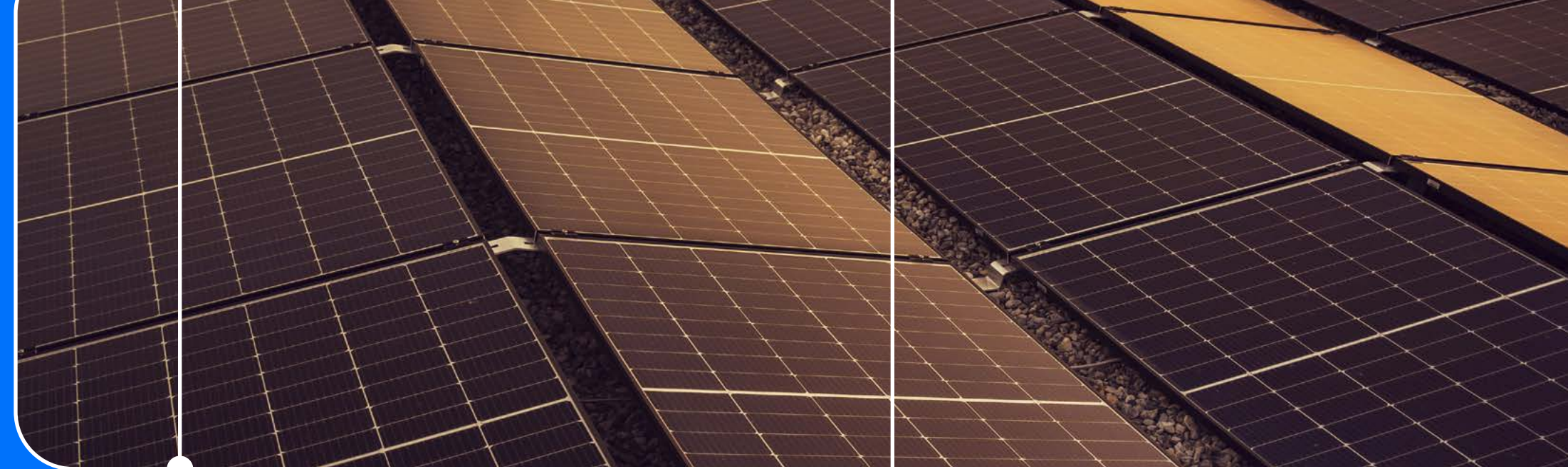


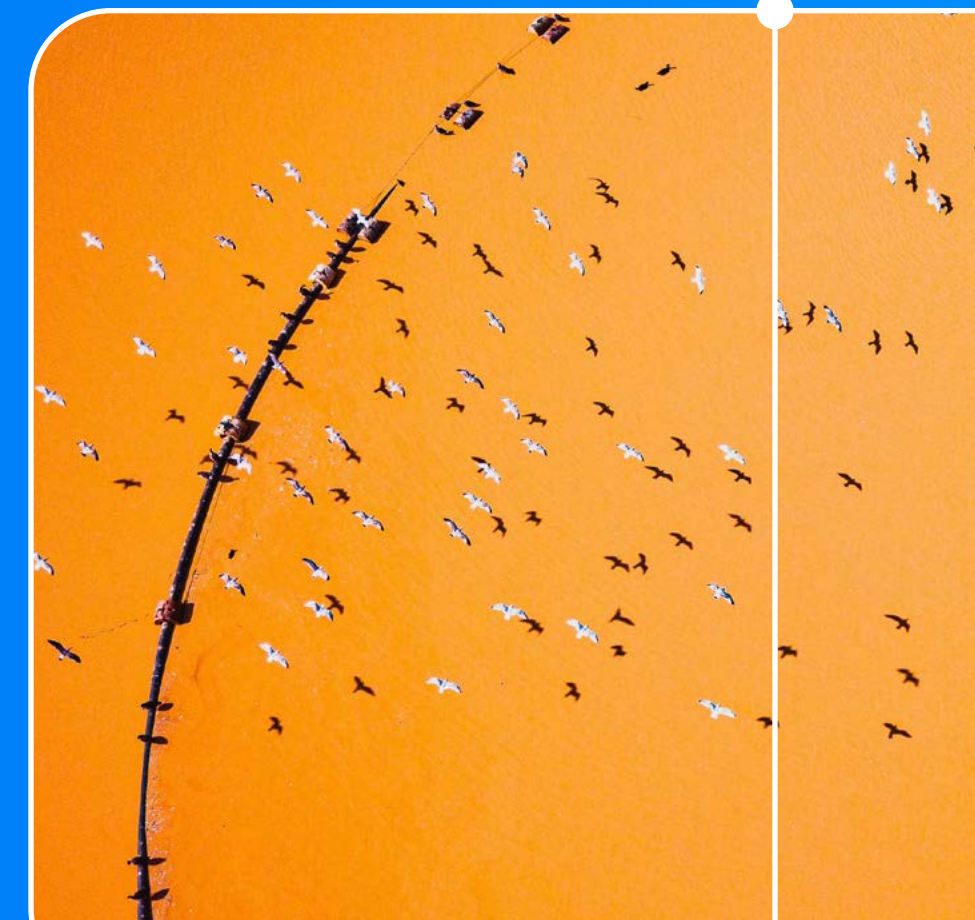
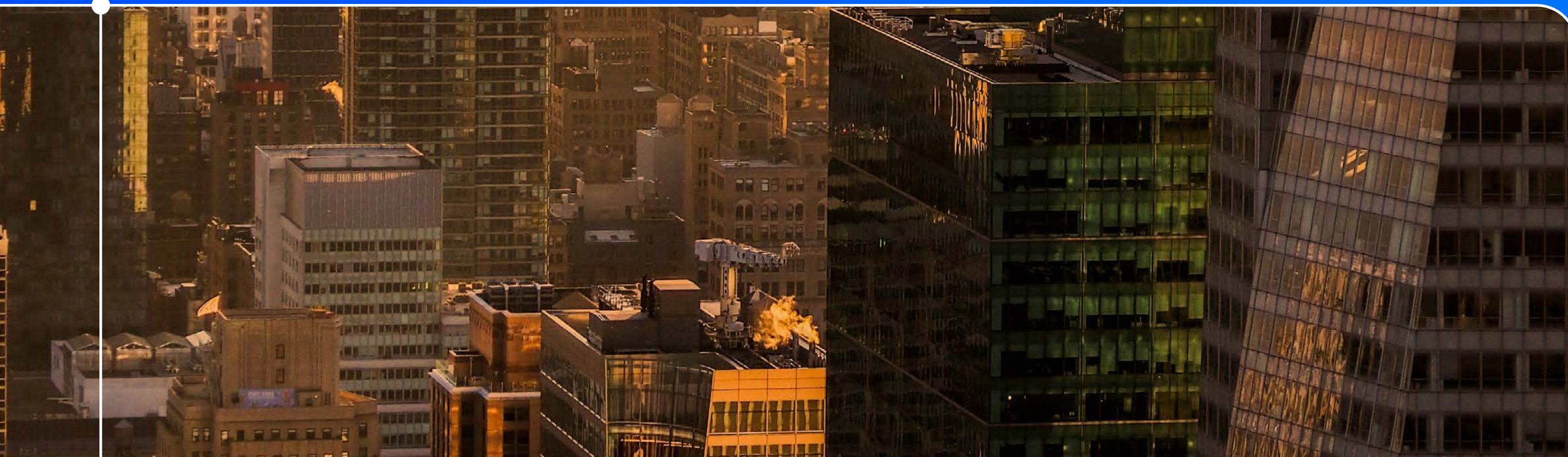


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*Sustainability  
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Examining trends of companies on the S&P 500® + Russell 1000®





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# Executive Summary

## Largest U.S. Companies Stacking New Standards and Assuring More Data, Even as Reporting Ebbs

**86% of Russell 1000®, 94% of S&P 500® Published Sustainability Reports  
in 2025, Both Slightly Lower Than in 2024**

With this 15th edition of our annual research, G&A Institute shares our latest findings on trends in how the largest publicly-traded companies in the U.S. report on sustainability.

Each edition of *Sustainability Reporting in Focus* presents detailed data and findings from our research, which draws on publicly accessible corporate reports on sustainability and other disclosures. We analyze both whether and how companies are reporting on sustainability, and we identify trends in the use of various reporting frameworks and standards. G&A makes the results [freely available](#) to benefit a wide range of stakeholders.

The level of corporate sustainability reporting rose steadily among companies on the Russell 1000® index for several years, becoming widely recognized as an essential business practice for both large- and mid-cap publicly-traded companies in the U.S. The practice remains strong despite dramatic change in the environmental, social, and governance (ESG) landscape.

In the past few years, voluntary disclosure driven largely by investor interest has given way to proliferating regulations, on one hand, and political headwinds on the other.

On January 20, 2025, companies in the U.S. faced a landmark change. On the first day of the current presidential administration, an Executive Order initiated the U.S. government's withdrawal from the Paris Agreement on climate change, signaling a new and nebulous operating environment with regard to corporate reporting on greenhouse gas emissions and climate-related risk. Our analysis aims to capture some of the impacts on sustainability reporting trends.

Finally, a note on how we have changed, too: in this research cycle, we recalibrated our long-standing methodology. Historically, our analysis looked at reports published in the past two years, in order to include companies with a biannual reporting cycle. However, in line with contemporary trends in corporate reporting, we have shifted to an annual reporting timeframe, looking only at reports that each company has published within the year.

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THEN 2006

G&A is founded, emerging from its roots in crisis management to become a sustainability-focused research and consulting firm advising corporate leaders and investors at the intersection of strategy, governance, and regulation.

NOW 2026

We have served 158 clients over the years, representing all 11 GICS industries, community organizations, educational institutions, government agencies, faith-based groups, and professional associations. G&A provides actionable, research-driven guidance to make companies more responsible, profitable, and sustainable.





## 2025 Key Findings

Sustainability disclosure among companies listed on the Russell 1000® Index decreased slightly in 2025, as detailed below. The decrease in reporting is seen both by the smaller companies on the Index, for which reporting fell by more than six percentage points, and the larger companies, for which reporting fell by nearly four percentage points. Overall, the percentage of reporters remained very high, especially among the largest companies.

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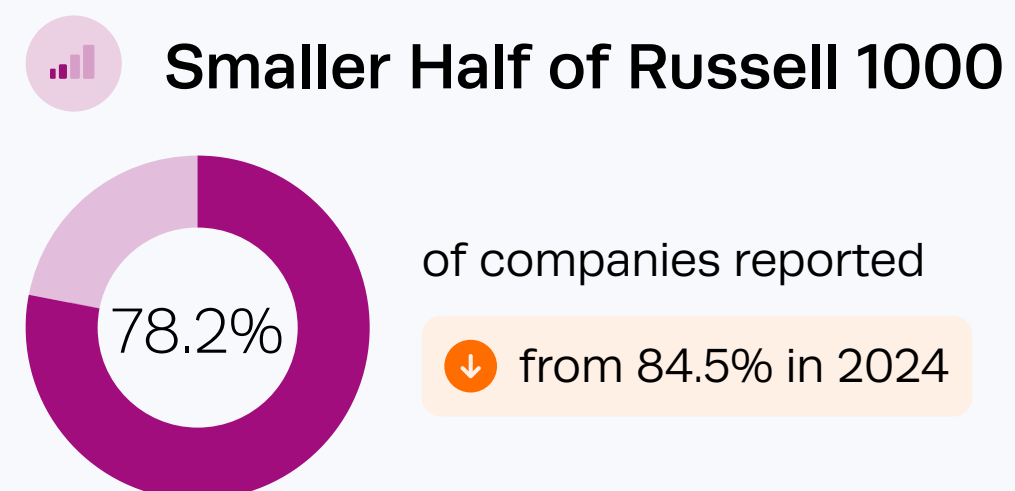
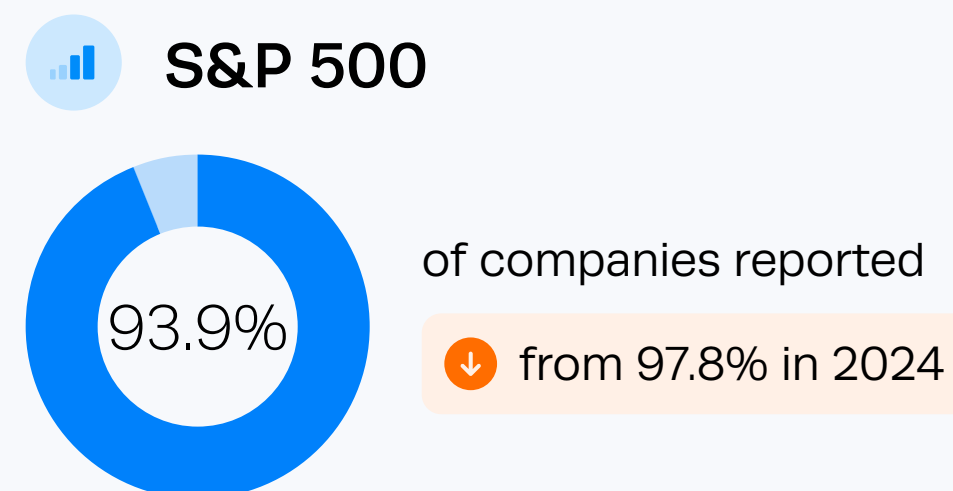
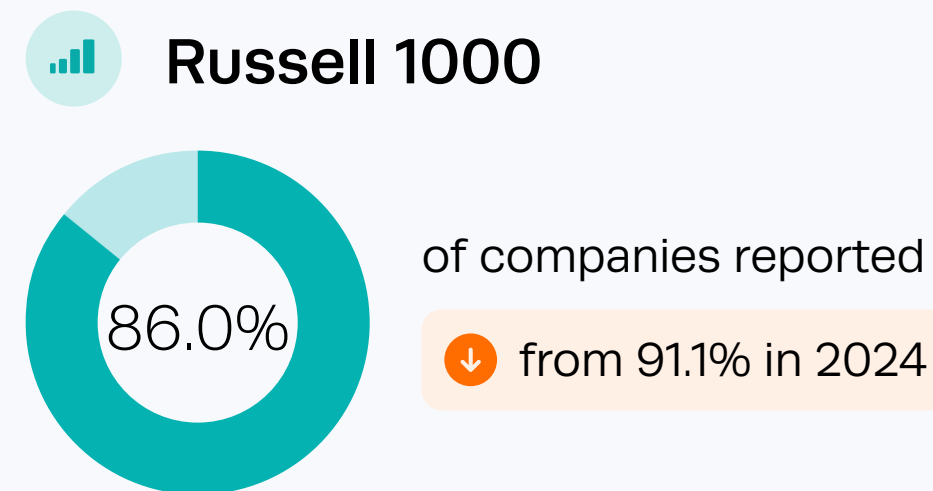
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**GRI** **ISSB** **ESRS** and **TNFD**  
alignment  **increased**  
among reporters

**SASB** and **TCFD** alignment  
 **decreased** among reporters  
overall – but **TCFD** alignment  
 **increased** among the  
 **smaller companies** on the Index

The percentage of  
companies committing  
to **science-based targets**  
 **increased**

The percentage of  
reporters obtaining  
**external assurance**  
 **increased**

Fewer companies  
responded to the **CDP**  
Climate Change questionnaire,  
but  **Water Security**  
responses  **increased**





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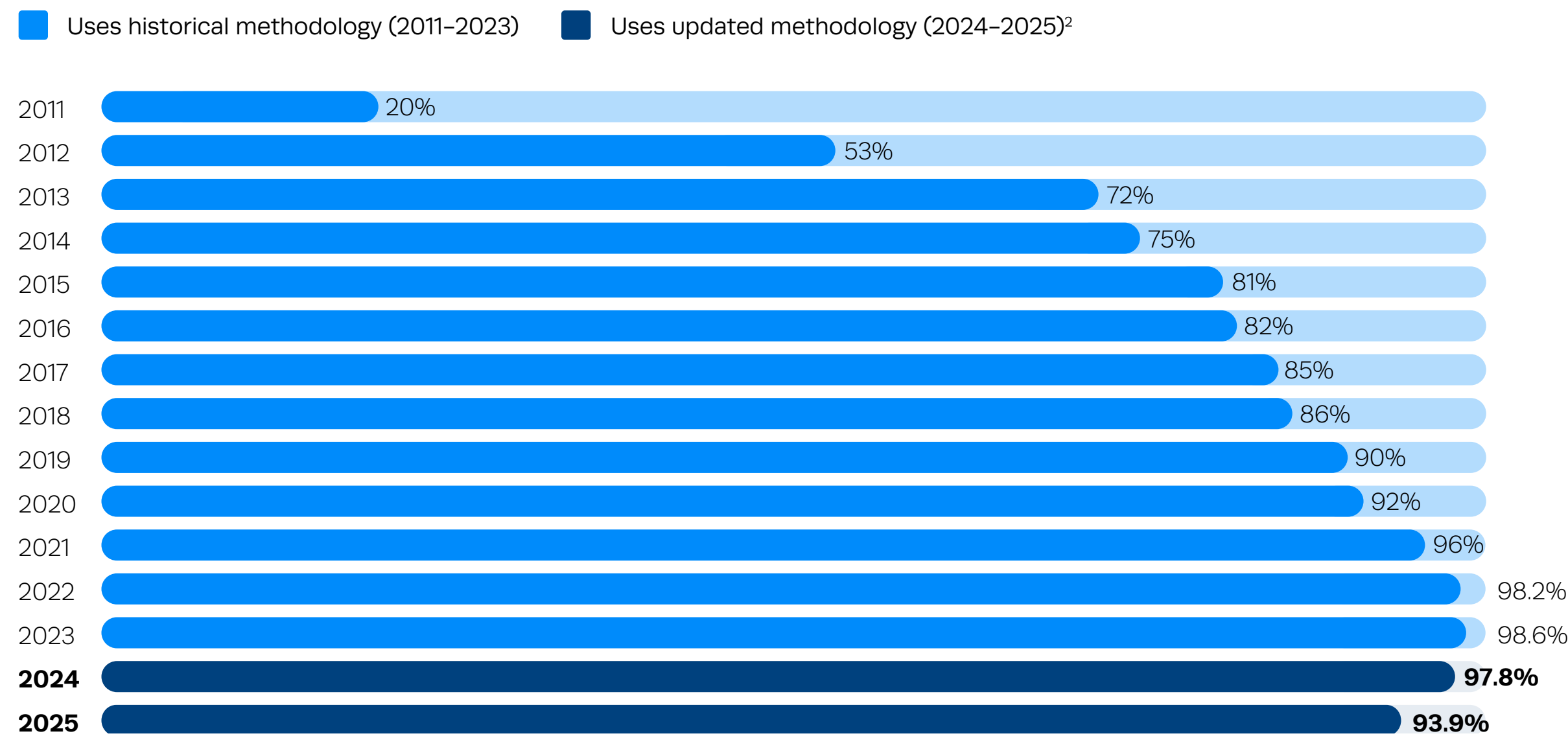
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# 15-Year Track Record of Reporting by S&P 500® Companies

In 2012, G&A's analysts began researching sustainability reporting practices among S&P 500® companies in the 2011 reporting year, and found that just 20% of those companies published sustainability reports or disclosures. This became the foundation for our annual examination of corporate sustainability reporting trends. Fifteen years later, in the 2025 reporting year, we see that only 6.1% of S&P 500 companies did not report.<sup>1</sup>

G&A's annual research has shown voluntary sustainability reporting being adopted as a common practice among S&P 500 companies. Through the lens of our recalibrated methodology, the level of corporate reporting stalled in 2024 and 2025. However, the percentage is still very high; we found that 93.9% of the S&P 500 published a report or made other sustainability disclosures in 2025.



<sup>1</sup>In previous editions of G&A's *Sustainability Reporting in Focus*, we provided reporting data in rounded numbers; however, since 2022, to better show incremental changes of less than one percentage point year-over-year, we have rounded percentages to one decimal point.

<sup>2</sup>These figures reflect G&A's updated research approach outlined in the [Methodology](#) section of this report.

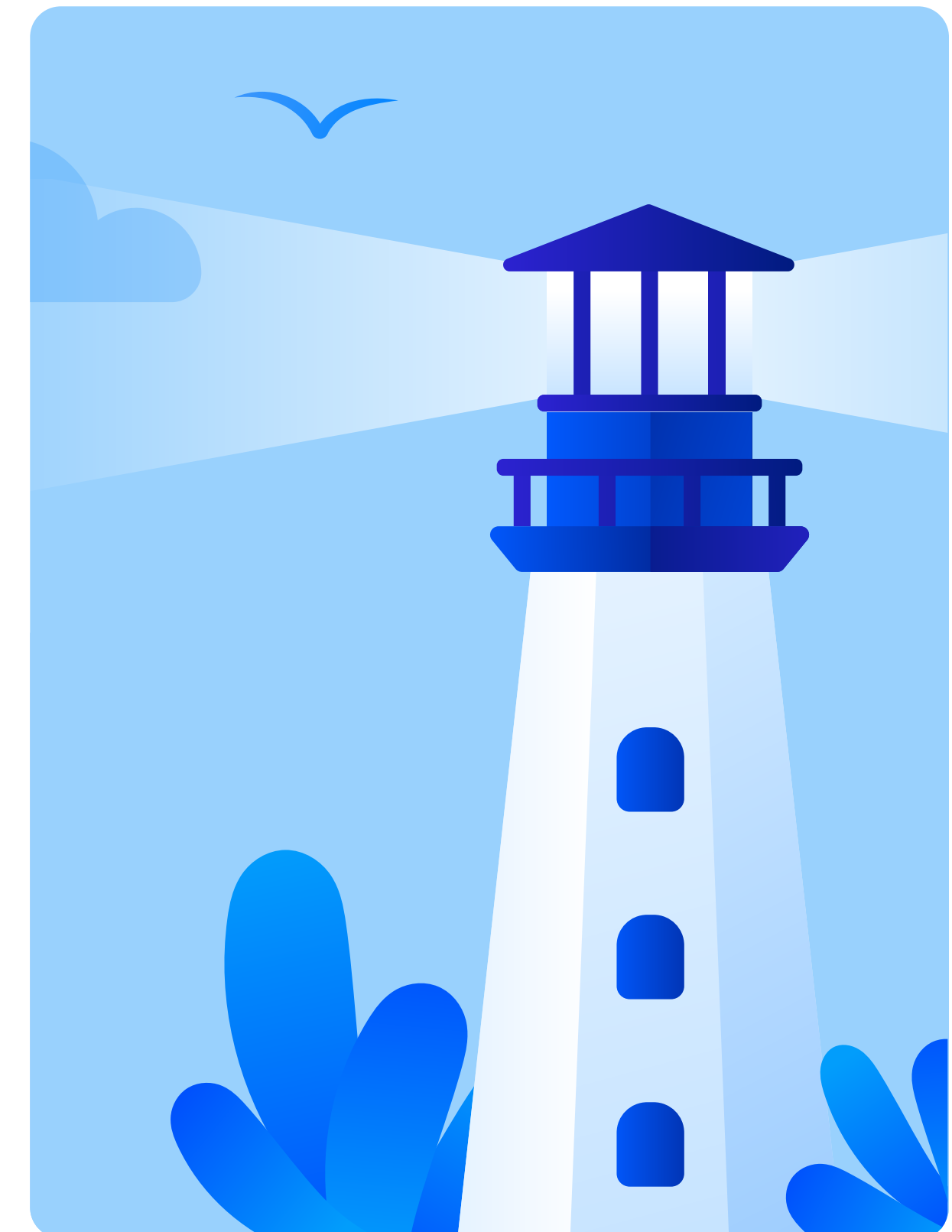
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## S&P 500 Reporting

THEN 2011 ..... 2025 NOW

20%  
reporting

93.9%  
reporting





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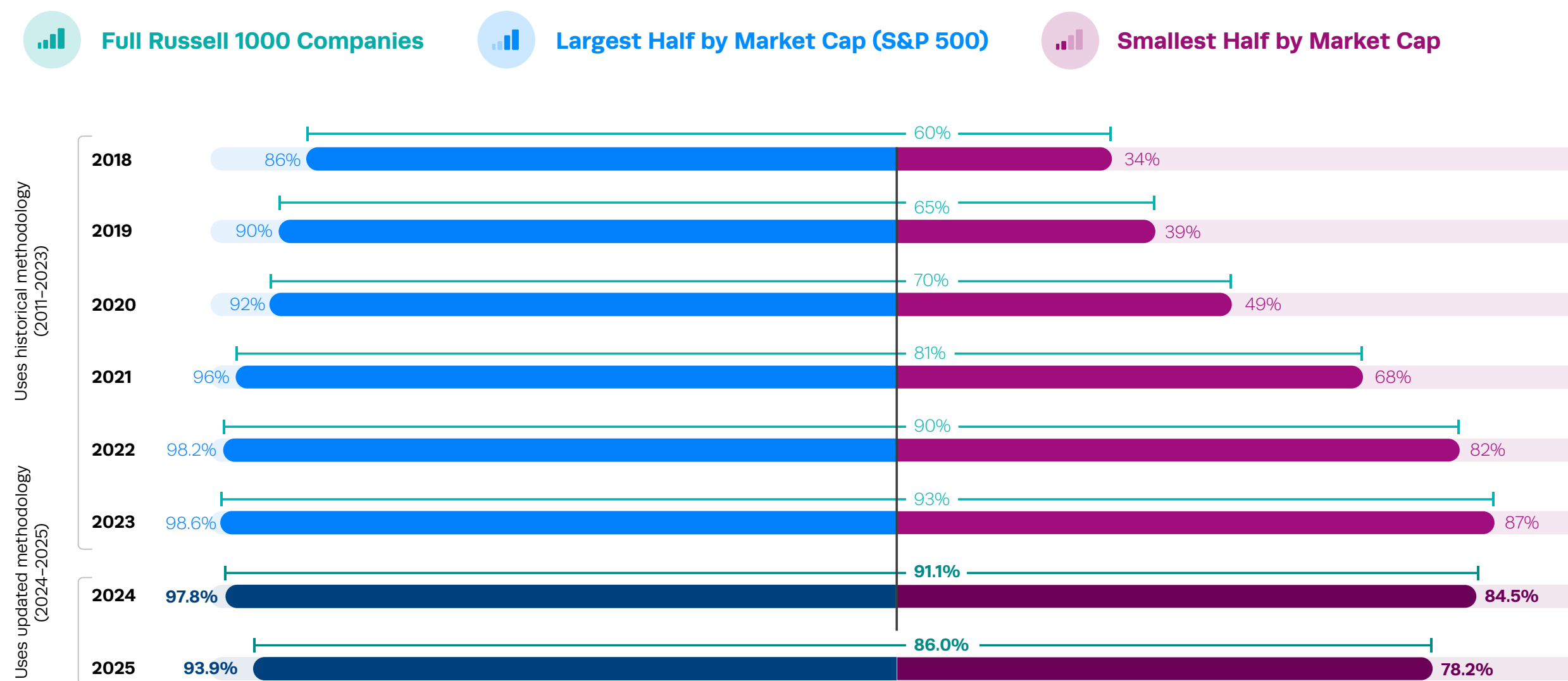
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# Eight-Year Track Record of Reporting by Russell 1000<sup>®</sup> Companies

Since 2019, when we reviewed data from the 2018 reporting year, G&A's research has tracked not only the S&P 500 (larger companies on the Russell 1000 Index), but also the mid-cap companies that make up the bottom half of the Index.

By applying our revised methodology to reporting practices for the years 2024 and 2025, we observed that reporting levels had stalled across the Russell 1000 Index. In 2025, reporting decreased to 86% of the companies on the Index.

Specifically within the smaller companies on the Russell 1000, reporting levels had grown between 10 and 20 percentage points per year for several years. In 2025, the level of reporting decreased and is now at 78.2%.<sup>3</sup>



<sup>3</sup>In previous editions of G&A's *Sustainability Reporting in Focus*, we provided reporting data in rounded numbers; however, since 2022, to better show incremental changes of less than one percentage point year-over-year, we have rounded percentages to one decimal point.

## Russell 1000 Reporting

THEN 2018 ..... 2025 NOW

60%  
reporting

86%  
reporting

## Smaller Half Reporting

THEN 2018 ..... 2025 NOW

34%  
reporting

78.2%  
reporting





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# Overview of Reporting Initiatives

This year, our research tracked companies' use of the following reporting initiatives. Continue reading for an overview of each, including its evolution and advantages.

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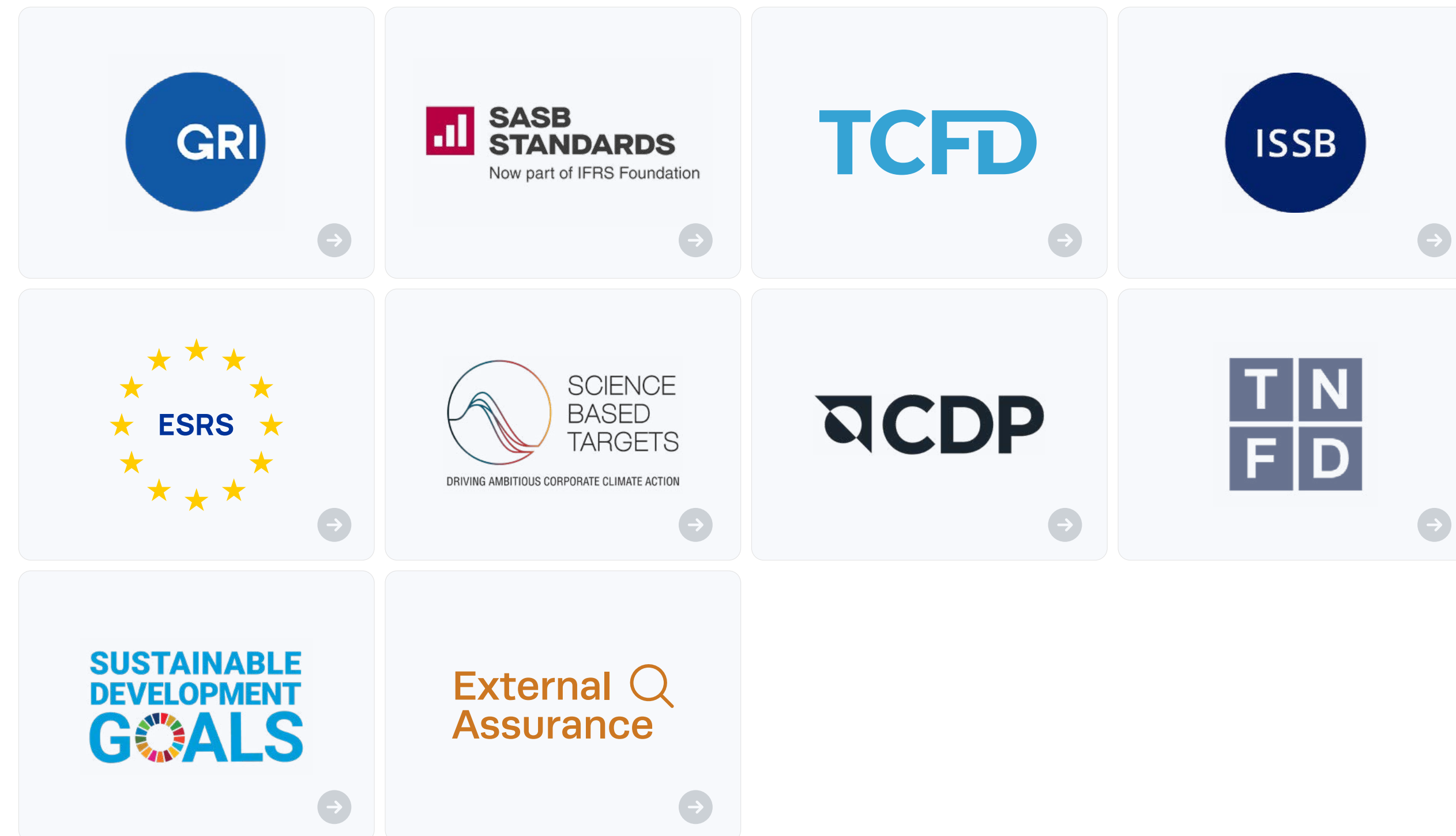
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## Leading Standards

MOST-USED

SASB

Since 2021 – among Russell 1000 and S&P 500 companies

FASTEST-GROWING

ISSB

Increase of 3 percentage points from 2024 to 2025 – among Russell 1000 companies

LONGEST-STANDING

GRI

Since 1999





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# Global Reporting Initiative

The **Global Reporting Initiative (GRI)** has long been the source of the de facto global standards for corporate sustainability reporting. Since 1999, when the first corporate reporters began using GRI's original framework, hundreds of organizations have followed.

GRI currently provides three series of Standards to support the reporting process:

- + GRI Topic Standards, each dedicated to a particular topic and listing disclosures relevant to that topic
- + GRI Sector Standards, applicable to specific sectors
- + GRI Universal Standards, which apply to all organizations

**Advantages:** Organizations have found that the GRI Standards provide structure and consistency, helping them disclose the materiality of sustainability topics and their impacts. The Standards are modular, allowing for updates, expansion, and enhancement, and they are oriented to a multistakeholder audience.

To promote alignment with other sustainability standards, GRI collaborates on tools for interoperability with the ESRS, the IFRS Sustainability Disclosure Standards, and others.

More information on the GRI Standards can be found [here](#).

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The non-governmental organization Ceres establishes the GRI to enable any organization to understand and report on its impacts on the economy, environment, and people in a comparable and credible way.

1997

GRI formalizes its framework into standards. The GRI Standards are designed as a modular set, delivering an inclusive picture of an organization's material topics and how it manages related impacts.

2000s

After releasing the first-generation (G1) framework, GRI goes on to develop more than six generations of the framework.

2016

The Universal Standards 2021 go into effect.

2021

GRI releases its Universal Standards to put greater emphasis on due diligence and human rights, in the most significant update since 2016.

2023

Revisions to Standards and new developments are ongoing. GRI has also been developing Sector Standards, including those for Financial Services and Textiles and Apparel, with releases expected in phases as they are finalized.

2025

GRI launches a digital sustainability taxonomy to support improved accessibility and interoperability of its Standards.

2026





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# Sustainability Accounting Standards Board

The **Sustainability Accounting Standards Board (SASB)** Standards aim to ensure disciplined, organized, and comparable reporting by publicly-traded companies for ESG performance disclosure, and to ensure that disclosures are financially material. Though originally created for U.S. companies, in recent years their language was revised to support disclosure in any jurisdiction. Although they are now consolidated within the International Financial Reporting Standards Foundation overseen by the International Sustainability Standards Board, the SASB Standards are still in use by companies around the world.

**Advantages:** The SASB Standards guide companies in disclosing the sustainability issues that are most likely to affect long-term enterprise value. The Standards now play a crucial role in supporting the ISSB disclosure requirements, particularly in the application of IFRS S1, which requires companies to use the SASB Standards to identify and disclose sustainability-related risks and opportunities.

More information on the SASB Standards can be found [here](#).

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SASB  
STANDARDS  
Now part of IFRS Foundation

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SASB is created with the purpose of developing industry-specific standards that help companies disclose financially material sustainability information to investors.

2011

SASB releases the SASB Standards, designed to foster more disciplined, organized, and comparable reporting of financially material sustainability information by publicly-traded companies. Unique Standards are available for 77 industries in 11 sectors. Each Standard identifies the subset of ESG issues most relevant to financial performance in the respective industry.

2018

SASB becomes a part of the Value Reporting Foundation when it merges with the International Integrated Reporting Council (IIRC).

2021

ISSB continues its ongoing project to enhance the SASB Standards, progressing additional exposure drafts and stakeholder consultations as part of a multi-year update process.

2023

2026

SASB is one of two standard-setting organizations to be consolidated under the IFRS Foundation. The Foundation then establishes the International Sustainability Standards Board (ISSB), which updates the SASB Standards for better global application and to ensure alignment with the general sustainability-related disclosures issued by the International Financial Sustainability Standards (IFRS).



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## Task Force on Climate-related Financial Disclosures

The **Task Force on Climate-related Financial Disclosures (TCFD)** was organized by the G20 nations' Financial Stability Board to review how the financial sector could account for climate-related issues. The resulting TCFD Recommendations were later adopted across many industries. The TCFD Recommendations remain widely used in their original form though they have also formed the basis of IFRS S2 of the International Financial Reporting Standards (IFRS) Sustainability Disclosure Standards.

**Advantages:** The TCFD Recommendations are voluntary, reliable, clear, efficient, and consistent, enabling companies to accurately measure, report, and plan for resilience to climate-related risks and opportunities. This helps generate useful information for investors, lenders, insurers, and other stakeholders.

More information on TCFD can be found [here](#).

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TCFD

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The Financial Stability Board of the Group of Twenty (G20) creates the TCFD to review how companies can better account for climate-related business impacts.

2015

TCFD publishes the TCFD Recommendations as a voluntary reporting framework to improve and increase companies' reporting of climate-related financial information, including more effectively disclosing climate-related risks and opportunities. The TCFD Recommendations are structured around four core elements of how organizations operate: Governance, Strategy, Risk Management, and Metrics and Targets.

2017

The IFRS Foundation assumes responsibility for monitoring the progress of companies' climate-related disclosures, and the TCFD announces that it has fulfilled its purpose, with the ISSB Standards marking the "culmination of the work of TCFD." The TCFD is officially disbanded. The TCFD Recommendations are fully incorporated into IFRS S2.

2023





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# International Sustainability Standards Board

The **International Sustainability Standards Board (ISSB)** Standards, also known as the International Financial Reporting Standards (IFRS) Sustainability Disclosure Standards, consist of two standards which were largely built upon SASB and TCFD, respectively:

- + IFRS S1, General Requirements for Disclosure of Sustainability-related Financial Information
- + IFRS S2, Climate-related Disclosures

By design, both IFRS Standards should be used together, but in jurisdictions where ISSB reporting is strictly voluntary, they may be used separately.

The Standards build upon the work of previous reporting initiatives including the Climate Disclosure Standards Board, the TCFD, the Value Reporting Foundation's Integrated Reporting Framework, and the SASB Standards. These frameworks have been integrated into the ISSB's structure, with TCFD Recommendations fully embedded within IFRS S2, and SASB Standards maintained and enhanced under ISSB oversight.

**Advantages:** IFRS S1 and S2 create a streamlined global baseline that meets the needs of investors and capital markets.

More information on ISSB can be found [here](#).

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ISSB

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2021

The IFRS Foundation forms the ISSB, which develops the IFRS Sustainability Disclosure Standards (also referred to as the ISSB Standards).

2023

The Standards are issued and endorsed by the International Organization of Securities Commissions, which regulates companies in over 95% of the world's securities markets.

2024

The Standards become effective on January 1.

2026

More than 35 jurisdictions globally begin active adoption pathways or actively work to incorporate the ISSB Standards into their regulatory frameworks, reflecting increasing global alignment among sustainability reporting requirements.

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## Global Landscape

THEN 2021

ISSB emerges

NOW 2025

**21** jurisdictions have adopted the IFRS Sustainability Standards, and an additional 16 have plans to adopt them

## G&A RESOURCE PAPER

## Evolving Sustainability Reporting to Align with the ISSB Standards





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# European Sustainability Reporting Standards

The **European Sustainability Reporting Standards (ESRS)** must be used for sustainability reporting aligned with the EU's Corporate Sustainability Reporting Directive (CSRD). The ESRS have two general standards and ten topical standards covering issues across environmental, social, and governance themes.

A central feature of the ESRS is double materiality, a vital element of corporate sustainability reporting in Europe that provides insight into both how sustainability issues affect a business and how the business, in turn, affects people and the environment.

**Advantages:** The Standards support the EU's sustainability goals by improving the quality and comparability of private sector reporting.

The ESRS have principles and disclosures in common with the GRI Standards and the ISSB Standards, which now encompass the SASB Standards.

More information on ESRS can be found [here](#).

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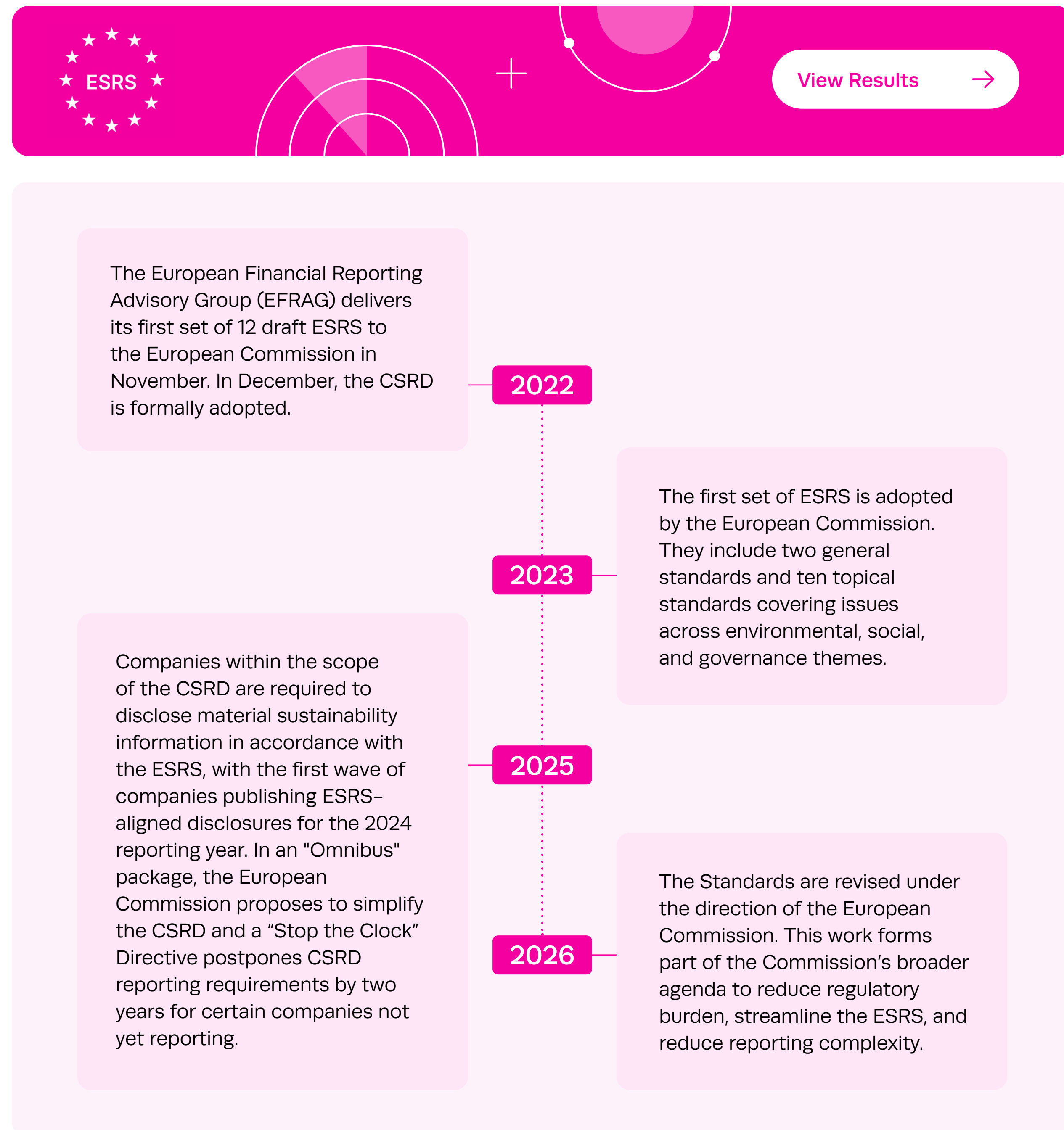
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## Science Based Targets initiative

The **Science Based Targets initiative (SBTi)** works with companies to set greenhouse gas (GHG) reduction targets that are scientifically aligned with the Paris Agreement goal of limiting global temperature increase to 1.5 degrees Celsius above pre-industrial levels. Companies can decide to pursue a near-term (by 2030) or a long-term (by 2050) reduction – or both.

Setting science-based targets enables companies to measure and plan for emissions reduction across their value chains. A science-based target is generally considered an aspect of corporate climate strategy, rather than disclosure.

**Advantages:** SBTi helps companies understand how much and how quickly they need to reduce emissions to help prevent the worst effects of climate change, by providing companies with independent assessment and validation, ensuring a standardized scientific basis for corporate targets.

More information on SBTi can be found [here](#).

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SCIENCE  
BASED  
TARGETS



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The SBTi is formed and is incorporated as a charity in the UK, with partnership from CDP, the UN Global Compact, the We Mean Business Coalition, the World Resources Institute (WRI), and the World Wide Fund for Nature (WWF).

2015

2021

2025

2026

The SBTi launches its Corporate Net-Zero Standard to provide companies with a clear framework to set science-based targets, manage transition risks, and capture opportunities associated with the transition to a net-zero economy.

The SBTi launches its first Financial Institutions Net-Zero Standard to enable financial institutions to align financial flows with pathways to limit global warming and achieve net-zero emissions by no later than 2050. The Standard is fully aligned with the SBTi's flagship Corporate Net-Zero Standard, as well as other relevant sector-specific standards and guidance, supporting integration into existing risk and investment processes.

SBTi releases its Corporate Net-Zero Standard 2.0, with updates reflecting developments in climate science. Key changes in version 2.0 include separating Scopes 1 and 2 targets, introducing tiered requirements by company size, and shifting focus from target-setting to implementation and accountability.



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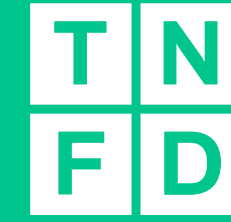
## Taskforce on Nature-related Financial Disclosures

The **Taskforce on Nature-related Financial Disclosures (TNFD)** Recommendations follow the same general structure as the TCFD Recommendations with four disclosure pillars: Governance, Strategy, Risk and Impact Management, and Metrics and Targets. Unlike frameworks limited to financial materiality, TNFD addresses both financial and impact materiality. Its recommendations go beyond risks and opportunities, requiring organizations also to disclose their nature-related dependencies and impacts.

**Advantages:** Companies face notable challenges in assessing and reporting on nature risk, such as the availability of data and the intrinsic complexity of nature-related metrics. The TNFD Recommendations are the only comprehensive framework for disclosing nature-related information, and are a valuable tool in helping companies close the gap on managing their exposure to nature-related issues. The TNFD's familiar format following the TCFD serves as a useful support for companies as they begin to recognize their nature-related dependencies, impacts, risks, and opportunities.

More information on TNFD can be found [here](#).

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The TNFD is launched as a "market-led, science-based, and government-supported global initiative." Its members represent financial institutions, corporates, and market service providers.

2021

TNFD moves into an implementation phase, with increasing adoption of its recommendations across financial institutions and corporates and growing integration into broader sustainability reporting practices. The framework is supported by extensive guidance materials, tools, and case studies to assist organizations in identifying, assessing, and disclosing nature-related risks and impacts.

2023

2024

The Taskforce publishes the TNFD Recommendations. They follow the same general structure as the TCFD Recommendations and are also aligned with the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework, which was adopted through international agreement and sets global biodiversity conservation targets and goals.



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# CDP

**CDP** (formerly the Carbon Disclosure Project) is a non-profit organization that supports organizations in disclosing their environmental impacts related to climate, water, and forests through an annual scored survey.

The disclosures are collected through questionnaires, largely on behalf of investors and customers. CDP analyzes and scores each company's responses regarding their management of the respective issues, and the scores generally become public and available to all stakeholders.

CDP maintains the most comprehensive database of disclosures from companies, governments, and cities about their performance related to carbon emissions, water use, deforestation, plastic, and supply chain engagement.

**Advantages:** CDP has fully aligned with the TCFD Recommendations and IFRS S2. It has partially aligned with ESRS, the TNFD, and various sustainable finance taxonomies, including pilot questions on EU Taxonomy objectives. This alignment supports interoperability across frameworks, reducing the reporting burden on companies and encouraging broader disclosure to CDP.

More information on CDP can be found [here](#).

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CDP is established as a not-for-profit organization to guide organizations in disclosing their environmental impacts. Initially, carbon emissions were the focus of the CDP Climate Change questionnaire.

2000

CDP releases a new questionnaire focused on forests, targeting commodities linked to deforestation and the risks they pose to businesses and ecosystems.

2011

CDP launches its water disclosure program, asking companies to report on how they manage water-related risks and opportunities across their operations and supply chains.

2010

CDP announces that it will become two separate organizations with a common mission to enable Earth-positive decisions: a commercial entity (CDP) focused on environmental disclosure and insights, and a nonprofit (CDP Foundation) focused on translating science into improved disclosure methods.

2026



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# Sustainable Development Goals

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The United Nations **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)** are part of a global roadmap to achieving a more sustainable world by 2030, known as the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development.

The 2030 Agenda includes 17 Goals and 169 underlying targets covering areas like poverty, health, education, climate, and inequality.

**Advantages:** Aligning corporate strategy and disclosure with the SDGs can lead to better relationships and mutually beneficial partnerships with investors, local governments, communities, and employees. Showcasing a company's SDG-aligned work also helps others learn from its efforts.

More information on the SDGs can be found [here](#).

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SUSTAINABLE  
DEVELOPMENT  
GOALS

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The UN General Assembly adopts the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, including the SDGs. The SDGs succeed the earlier Millennium Development Goals, which ran from 2000–2015.

2015

World leaders convene for the SDG Summit in New York to mark the halfway point of the 2030 Agenda. A UN progress report finds that only about 15% of SDG targets are on track for achievement by 2030, while nearly half were moderately or severely off track, and over a third have stalled or regressed.

2023

The UN Secretary-General calls on all companies to “fully align business models with the SDGs and the 1.5°C target” guiding climate action.

2024

Progress on the SDGs is significantly off track, according to reports prepared for the UN's annual SDG stocktaking event. Only 16% of SDG targets are projected to be achieved by the 2030 deadline, which is now four years away. Goals related to cities, the environment, sustainable agri-food systems, and peace are among the most challenged overall. Positive trends at the global level include expanded electricity access and reductions in adolescent fertility rates and HIV infections.

2026





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# External Assurance

A growing number of companies are choosing to seek **external assurance** for their environmental and/or social disclosures. Providers of external assurance include engineering firms, accountants, and specialized consultancies.

Approaches to external assurance vary for each reporting company based on provider type, scope of assurance (GHG emissions only, another specific topic, or entire sustainability report), and level of assurance (limited, reasonable, etc.).

**Advantages:** Assurance provides increased recognition, transparency, and credibility for a company's ESG disclosures while reducing risk. It is increasingly a component of mandatory reporting, as it provides validation that data is accurate. Seeking external assurance often indicates strong internal reporting and management systems. Overall, assurance improves stakeholder communication and trust.

[Return to Initiatives](#)

External Assurance

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2003

AccountAbility launches the first edition of the AA1000 Assurance Standard, the world's first dedicated sustainability assurance standard.

2024

The International Auditing and Assurance Standards Board (IAASB) publishes the International Standard on Sustainability Assurance (ISSA) 5000, the first comprehensive assurance standard built specifically for sustainability information, set to take effect in December 2026 and become the leading global standard going forward.

2025

Over half of Russell 1000 reporters obtain external assurance.

2026

G&A finds an increase of three percentage points in Russell 1000 reporters obtaining external assurance.

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## External assurance obtained

THEN 2020 ..... 2025 NOW

35%  
of reporters

54%  
of reporters





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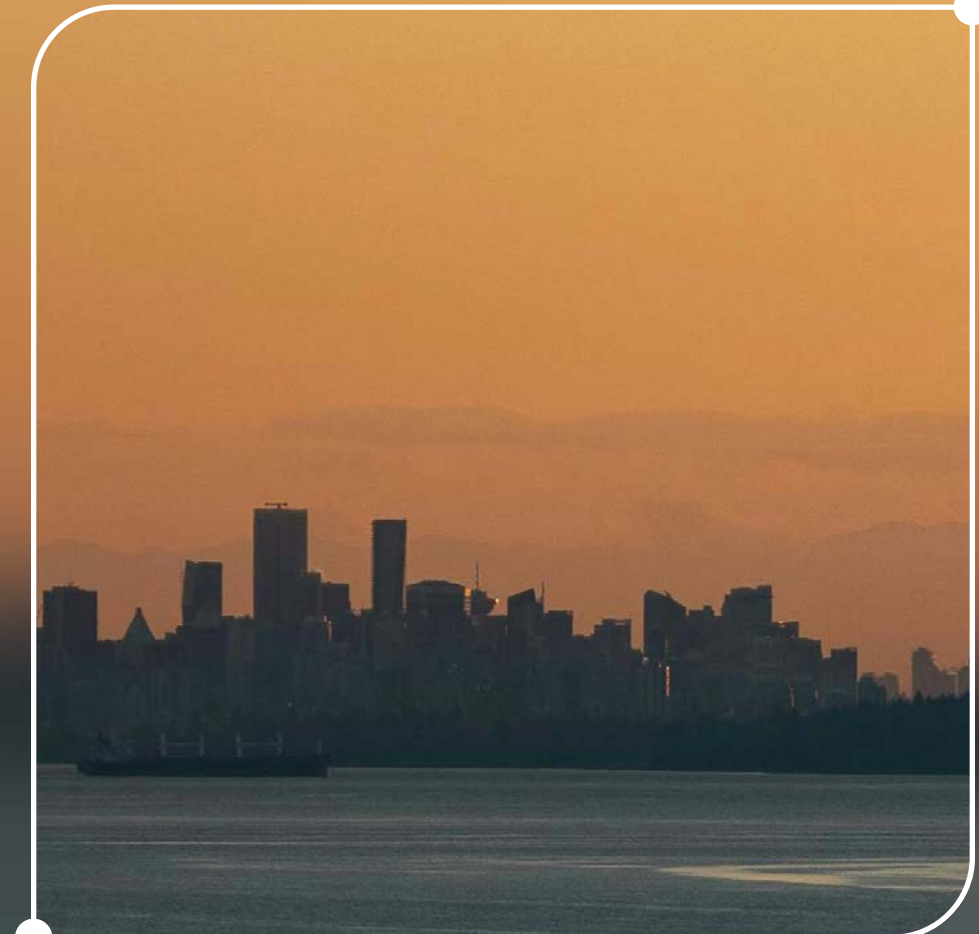
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# Research Methodology

## Companies Examined

For the 2026 edition of our *Sustainability Reporting in Focus* report, G&A researched corporate ESG disclosure and reporting activities of all companies listed in the Russell 1000 Index during the calendar year 2025. We present our findings as follows:

- + As a full index
- + As index "halves" – the largest vs. smaller firms by market cap (the larger of which generally represent the S&P 500 Index)
- + As GICS® sectors

The S&P 500 and Russell 1000 are updated regularly by their owners. Index re-composition leads to the addition and subtraction of companies, which can alter the baseline from year to year, while also producing variance in sector-level data; for example, a single non-reporting company joining the Index may result in the company's sector losing its 100% reporting status.

For the purposes of this year's research, the list of Russell 1000 companies was pulled on December 31, 2025. Due to minor differences in index methodologies between the S&P 500 and the Russell 1000, there were some companies listed in the S&P 500 that were not listed in the Russell 1000. To provide a complete picture of U.S. corporate trends by market cap, these companies were included in our analysis of the larger half of companies.

## About the Indices

The Russell 1000, provided by FTSE Russell (a subsidiary of LSEG), tracks the largest U.S. publicly-traded companies by market cap. The companies listed on the Index represent about 93% of all listed stocks in the U.S. equity market. The S&P 500, owned by S&P Dow Jones Indices (a division of S&P Global), covers roughly 500 large-cap companies representing about 80% of U.S. market cap.

The two segments of the Russell 1000 – the S&P 500 and the remaining, smaller companies – are not necessarily equal halves. In 2025, the Russell 1000 Index included a total of 996 companies. Of these, 495 are listed in the S&P 500 Index, and 501 comprise the smaller "half" of the Russell 1000.

## Companies vs. Reporters

Throughout this report, the collective term "companies" refers to the full set of organizations included in our research, specifically all constituents of the Russell 1000 Index or the S&P 500 Index. "Reporters," by contrast, refers to the subset of those companies that published a sustainability report or otherwise met the criteria outlined at right. Accordingly, reporting levels (e.g., "90% of companies published a report") are calculated as reporters divided by total companies. Findings about reporting practices are often presented with both reference points: as a percentage of total companies and as a percentage of reporters specifically.

## What makes a **company** a **reporter** ?

Companies that met any of the following criteria for the year 2025 were considered reporters:<sup>4</sup>

- ✓ Published a standalone sustainability report
- ✓ Responded to CDP Climate Change questionnaire
- ✓ Disclosed environmental and/or social data, comparable over at least two years, on the company's website

Companies meeting any of the above criteria had their reporting practices further assessed by examining how they:

- ✓ Used reporting standards and frameworks such as GRI, SASB, TCFD, ISSB, ESRS, and/or TNFD
- ✓ Responded to other CDP questionnaires
- ✓ Aligned with the SDGs
- ✓ Obtained third-party assurance on reported data
- ✓ Held SBTi-validated emissions targets

<sup>4</sup>Holding companies not meeting these criteria at the holding company level are considered non-reporters.



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# Then vs. Now

G&A launches our annual research project on the sustainability reporting practices of S&P 500 companies, covering the 2011 reporting year.

2012

For data from the 2018 reporting year, we begin to look at mid-cap companies in addition to the S&P 500, thus including the entire Russell 1000 Index to capture a wider view of corporate sustainability disclosure. We compare reporting behaviors of the larger and smaller “halves” of the Russell 1000 Index to capture differences between companies with different levels of resources available for ESG management and disclosure.

2019

The scope of our research expands again as we begin tracking the use of specific reporting frameworks, namely the TCFD Recommendations and the SASB Standards.

2020

We begin presenting reporting trends specific to each of the 11 sectors of the GICS®. This illuminates another angle on reporting behavior, beyond company size.

2024

We benchmark companies' use of three recent sustainability reporting initiatives: the IFRS Standards, ESRS, and TNFD.

2025

We report on the presence of SBTi-validated targets. We also make an important update to our methodology, transitioning from a two-year time frame for each company's reporting period to a one-year time frame.

2026

## Use of Multiple Standards

G&A continues to track long-standing initiatives like GRI, SASB, and TCFD to record trends in their use year-over-year even as new standards are introduced and, in some cases, intended to replace them – such as the ISSB's IFRS Standards incorporating elements of SASB and TCFD.

## Transition to One-Year Timeframe

Historically, our analysis included reports published in the previous year so as not to exclude biannual reporters. However, in this cycle we shifted to include only those reports published in a single-year time frame.

This approach more accurately reflects the rapid, “on-the-ground” changes occurring in sustainability reporting, and how companies generally issue their disclosures today.

Therefore, throughout this report we present two sets of data: data on corporate reporting practices until the year 2023, which was compiled with our original methodology; and data on practices in 2024 and 2025, which was compiled using our updated methodology.

*For information on the evolution and advantages of each reporting initiative, please see the [Overview of Reporting Initiatives](#) section of this report.*





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# G&A Institute Comments

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# Louis Coppola

## Chief Executive Officer & Co-Founder

For 14 editions of this research, we have been able to report consistent progression: more companies reported this year than last. This is the first year we can't say that. In 2025, 93.9% of the S&P 500 published a sustainability report or comparable disclosure, down from 97.8%, and across the full Russell 1000 the figure fell to 86.0%.

But let's go back to the beginning for a moment. When we first counted, looking at the 2011 reporting year, reporting by the S&P 500 was 20%. Four out of five of the largest companies in America had nothing to show us.

It is worth remembering how little existed in the way of standards and frameworks at that time. GRI had been providing a framework for reporting since 1999; for 12 years afterward, it had the field largely to itself. SASB was not founded until 2011 — the same year for which we first assessed reporting levels. The TCFD and the SBTi followed in 2015. The ISSB and the TNFD emerged in 2021, and the ESRS were not adopted until 2023, nearly a quarter century after GRI began.

For the past decade, amid the rich and spreading ecosystem of corporate reporting standards, frameworks, questionnaires, target-setting initiatives, and other guidance, companies steadily increased their level of sustainability disclosure. It turns out that these practices and commitments don't go away overnight. While we found lower reporting levels in 2025 than a year before, I'd argue that we are now seeing different kinds of growth. I'd like to highlight two of these emerging strengths in our field.

First, looking at the reporting behaviors of Russell 1000 companies in 2025, it seems that many of the companies that continued to disclose did so in a more robust way. For example, they aligned more frequently with GRI Standards, increased their ISSB adoption from 1% of reporters to 5%, and made greater use of the ESRS and TNFD. In addition, the share of reporters holding a validated science-based target rose from 27% to 35%.

I consider external assurance to be an indicator of a maturing disclosure strategy, and this year 54% of reporters obtained external assurance, an increase from 51% in 2024. Obtaining assurance is costly and not required by any U.S. rule. Paying to have a report assured on a voluntary basis reflects the business value of disclosing trustworthy information on climate risk and other sustainability topics.

Among the cohorts of the Russell 1000 that pulled back on reporting, the S&P 500 slipped 3.9 points, while the smaller half of the Russell 1000 fell 6.3. In other words, mid-caps, who likely rely on smaller teams and budgets, were more often the ones to pause.

The second unexpected trend unearthed by our research this year: every Russell 1000 company that applied the TNFD Recommendations also reported under GRI. Similarly, among companies aligning with the ISSB Standards, 79% also used SASB and 73% also used GRI. Among ESRS reporters, 71% used GRI. In other words, none of these frameworks or standards is displacing another. Companies are stacking them, and often it's on the foundation of the GRI Standards, the oldest and most widely used sustainability reporting standard in the world.



“

For the past decade, amid the rich and spreading ecosystem of corporate reporting standards, frameworks, questionnaires, target-setting initiatives, and other guidance, companies steadily increased their level of sustainability disclosure. It turns out that these practices and commitments don't go away overnight.”





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### Louis Coppola Chief Executive Officer & Co-Founder *(Continued)*

The Rosetta Stone is a slab of granite carved in 196 BC bearing the same decree in three scripts; because the content was identical in all three, scholars who could read one were finally able to read the others. A well-governed sustainability data set is the same kind of object — one set of facts, rendered into GRI, the ISSB Standards, the ESRS, and California's climate laws, as each audience requires. A company can make an expensive mistake if it runs a separate program per framework, each with its own owner and its own rush to publish on a separate timeline. We recommend a different approach: build one governed, assurance-ready data layer and treat every standard, framework or questionnaire as a rendering of it. This approach is what G&A has spent over two decades guiding clients through, and GRI has always been an important piece of that puzzle.

Perhaps it should come as no surprise, then, that in a year when overall reporting fell, GRI alignment rose — from 54% to 57% of Russell 1000 reporters, and up in both the smaller and larger halves of the Index. When companies cut back, they didn't remove the

spine of their reporting. After decades of tracking how these and other standards are being implemented, I believe in the value of GRI, and that's why I recently accepted the position as the chair of the GRI Stakeholder Council. The chance to help steward the multistakeholder process that shapes where sustainability reporting standards go next was not one that I could pass up.

Here is my advice, reflecting on our new findings. First, whatever your company decides to publish this year, please keep measuring. Disclosure decisions are reversible; lost data is not. Don't lose the benefits of knowing where you stand, even if you don't make it public. Secondly, beyond collecting data, disclosing material information on a regular basis helps you stay the course and advance on your journey as a resilient business. We will be counting again next year, but more importantly, we're rooting for your company to stand the test of time.

Finally, to the analysts and interns who have read these reports one at a time since 2011: this record exists because of you. Thank you.



Here is my advice, reflecting on our new findings. First, whatever your company decides to publish this year, please keep measuring. **Disclosure decisions are reversible; lost data is not. Don't lose the benefits of knowing where you stand, even if you don't make it public."**



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# Hank Boerner Chairman & Chief Strategist

It may seem that we have been taking two steps forward then one back when it comes to corporate responsibility and related disclosure, but the forward movement in the U.S. and globally has advanced on a steady pace over the past century. A wide universe of stakeholders has benefitted from the information publicly disclosed.

My perspective is based on a career of strategizing and advising on corporate governance matters, especially corporate disclosure and public reporting. I can attest that such activities of publicly-traded large enterprises are a perpetual journey: the best companies are always moving forward to achieve greater excellence in their reporting.

This is not a completely new practice or trend. The 1929 stock market crash was nearly 100 years ago now, and until then disclosure by exchange-listed companies was “bare bones” or almost non-existent. Companies rarely revealed the true condition of the enterprise for stockholders and bondholders. Instead, “Surprise – we are going bust” could be news for investors trusting that their investments were secure.

Dramatic change arrived with the passage of historic 1930s federal securities laws and creation of the U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) and other regulatory agencies. The statutes and operating rules set publicly-traded companies on a new path, with ever-more robust requirements for disclosure and structured reporting for equity and debt issuers over the ensuing decades. Public companies were on a journey toward providing greater transparency into their finances and operations. Risk and opportunity gained higher visibility.

Jumping ahead to 2010, in an advisory to public companies, the SEC set risk and then climate change front and center through mandated Regulation S-K on reporting. In 2011, Lou Coppola and I closely examined the fast-moving trend – fully voluntary at the time – of companies reporting on what today we generally call corporate social responsibility (CSR) and “sustainability.” Company leaders began spelling out their climate strategies, actions, goals, and achievements, efforts intended to protect the environment and humanity. Corporate reporting for stakeholders extended to protection of human rights at home and abroad, conserving energy and increasing the use of renewables, protection of communities, expanded corporate social responsibility, and philanthropy.

This breadth of disclosure marked a logical evolution in traditional corporate governance disclosure. Reporting increased in volume and depth, becoming important to the providers of capital. Shareowners and other stakeholders paid close attention to the growing body of “climate and more” corporate messaging.

We started sharing our analysis of corporate reports on ESG, social responsibility, environment, citizenship, and sustainability on a broad basis in 2012 (focusing on the S&P 500 companies’ disclosures in 2011). By 2023, our analysis showed the practice of ESG reporting had taken hold in just about 100% of the nation’s largest companies (with few exceptions).

Writing in 2026, the SEC has abandoned its temporarily suspended draft rules for universal sustainability reporting. Yet, it is evident that the practice of corporate sustainability reporting is not slowing down to a meaningful degree among the



largest 500 or among the next-largest 500 companies as represented in the Russell 1000 Index. That’s good news for stakeholders.

There are many reasons for the continuance and expansion of corporate sustainability reporting – voluntarily in the U.S. and on a global basis as reporting mandates evolve. Our talented team of analysts spells out many aspects of the sustainability disclosure journey in this year’s report. We invite your close reading.



**Bare-bones disclosure was normal before the stock market crash of 1929 – nearly 100 years ago now. Federal regulations then set public companies on a new path, and a wide universe of stakeholders has benefited.”**





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# Alex Cohen

## SVP, Sustainability Consulting

The most important trend I see when looking at the 2025 results is the continued rise in the quality of sustainability data. We see this most clearly in the increased number of reporters obtaining assurance for their sustainability data, with a majority now obtaining assurance. The largest increase came from the bottom half of the Russell 1000, indicating that companies of all sizes are responding to pressure to report high-quality sustainability data.

Underscoring the theme of high-quality data, the practices we identified for 2025 also include a rise in the number of companies with validated science-based targets from the SBTi. This indicates to me that companies are still taking climate change seriously enough to seek external validation of their targets. Companies want and need to show investors and other stakeholders that they understand their current standing with regard to climate-related impacts and management, as well as the progress they make over time. Good data and validated targets are two major pieces of this puzzle.

An emphasis on the quality of sustainability data is not limited to climate, as we see in the 2025 level of responses to the CDP Water Security questionnaire. Despite the decline in responses to CDP's Climate Change questionnaire, more companies of all sizes are disclosing information on their water-related risks and impacts, pointing to the growing importance of this issue for companies and their stakeholders.

Among the many trends that shifted in 2025, the move towards better sustainability data signals a positive direction for corporate governance and sustainability reporting. Strong data makes a better guide for decision-making, putting investors, companies, and the sustainability field as a whole on firmer footing.



“

Among the many trends that shifted in 2025, the move towards better sustainability data signals a strong direction for corporate governance and sustainability reporting.”



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# Annie Roberts

## SVP, Climate Consulting

The year 2025 was an uncertain one for climate disclosure regulation in the U.S., marked by the bumpy rollout and ultimately a pause of California's Climate-related Financial Risk Act (SB 261). The U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) also voted to stop defense of the climate-related disclosures rules approved during the Biden administration, culminating in a proposal to fully rescind the rules in March 2026.

Despite these setbacks, we did not observe a meaningful drop in climate-related disclosure rates by companies on the Russell 1000. In particular, TCFD reporting rates held relatively steady from 2024 to 2025. Amongst the smaller half of the Russell 1000, TCFD alignment increased slightly. We saw a modest decline in TCFD alignment by larger companies on the Russell 1000; however, that decline did not necessarily reflect a pullback, as these companies may have shifted toward the ISSB Standards or other mandatory reporting. ISSB adoption jumped six percentage points in one year, a shift may be driven by new climate regulations around the world, such as Australia's AASB S2, which is based on ISSB's IFRS S2 standards.

The continued momentum in science-based target adoption was encouraging. Setting a science-based target is voluntary, making SBTi an adoption a meaningful signal that companies are choosing to move forward with decarbonization commitments even without regulatory mandates.

Taken together, the trends we observe in TCFD reporting and science-based target adoption suggest that articulating a clear climate strategy remained an essential part of corporate reporting in 2025, particularly for multinational organizations who may be leveraging their sustainability reports to satisfy new regulations and expectations abroad, even as the U.S. retreats.

Two changes on the horizon could affect these trends in future reporting cycles. First, adoption of ISSB IFRS standards is on the rise around the world, which could catalyze a further shift away from TCFD to ISSB. Second, SBTi released the Corporate Net-Zero Standard Version 2.0, which increases flexibility for companies to set and achieve long-term emissions reduction targets, potentially alleviating barriers that have hindered adoption.

The real-world use-case for corporate climate disclosure is only strengthening. As climate-related hazards like wildfires, heatwaves, and floods have ever-stronger effects on business continuity, climate-related disclosures will be in greater demand to ensure investors and boards can assess the resiliency of companies' operational strategies in a warming world.

The 2025 reporting cycle tested whether companies would continue to report on climate without specific regulatory mandates. Thus far, the trend is clear: communicating on climate still matters.



Articulating a clear climate strategy remained an essential part of corporate reporting in 2025, particularly for multinational organizations who may be leveraging their sustainability reports to satisfy new regulations and expectations abroad."





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# Kirstie Dabbs

## Director, Client Sustainability Solutions

When I review our research on sustainability reporting in 2025 and consider the economic and political uncertainty faced by U.S. companies throughout that year, I'm reminded of a panel I moderated at Reuters' Sustainability Reporting USA conference last year titled, "When Everything Changes, What Stays the Same?"

This is a question that is likely top of mind for many companies in the Russell 1000 – and beyond – and as our data shows, a small but notable portion of Russell 1000 companies appears to have pulled back on sustainability reporting in this time of competing pressures. Perhaps these companies judged reporting to be too controversial, or no longer a business priority. Perhaps it was difficult for them to decide what to report with so many variables up in the air, or the advent of mandatory reporting led to a paring back of voluntary disclosure. No matter the reason, I'd like to share G&A's perspective on sustainability reporting in a changing landscape.

We have always considered a sustainability report to be not just a communication tool, but a management tool. Producing a report helps to keep a company and its stakeholders aware and up-to-date on the sustainability issues that contribute to or threaten its success. In a company with awareness of these connections and dependencies, the annual sustainability report can serve as an accountability

mechanism – a progress report on how effectively its priorities, risks, and opportunities are embedded into daily business. This is how companies build resilience.

Whether or not a company chooses to issue a sustainability report publicly, its sustainability-related risks and opportunities remain; it should therefore continue to methodically take stock of performance on a range of environmental, social, and governance matters to inform which programs and investments to maintain, and what to shift, in the midst of a changing political and regulatory environment. In short, when everything changes, the internal tracking, reviewing, and steering of sustainability priorities needs to continue consistently year-over-year to inform a resilient strategy.

Much of the work we do at G&A builds our clients' internal capacity and creates the conditions for a strategy that can be used year after year, based on the standards, frameworks, and other types of reporting initiatives reflected in this report. We are honored to support our clients in turning their efforts into rewarding impacts.

Though the external work of sustainability reporting ebbed this year, it is our hope that companies will hold onto their focus on the efforts that position them to weather the next shift, and thrive long into the future.



When everything in the external landscape changes, the internal tracking, reviewing, and steering of sustainability priorities needs to continue consistently in order to inform a resilient strategy."



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# Trends by Reporting Initiative

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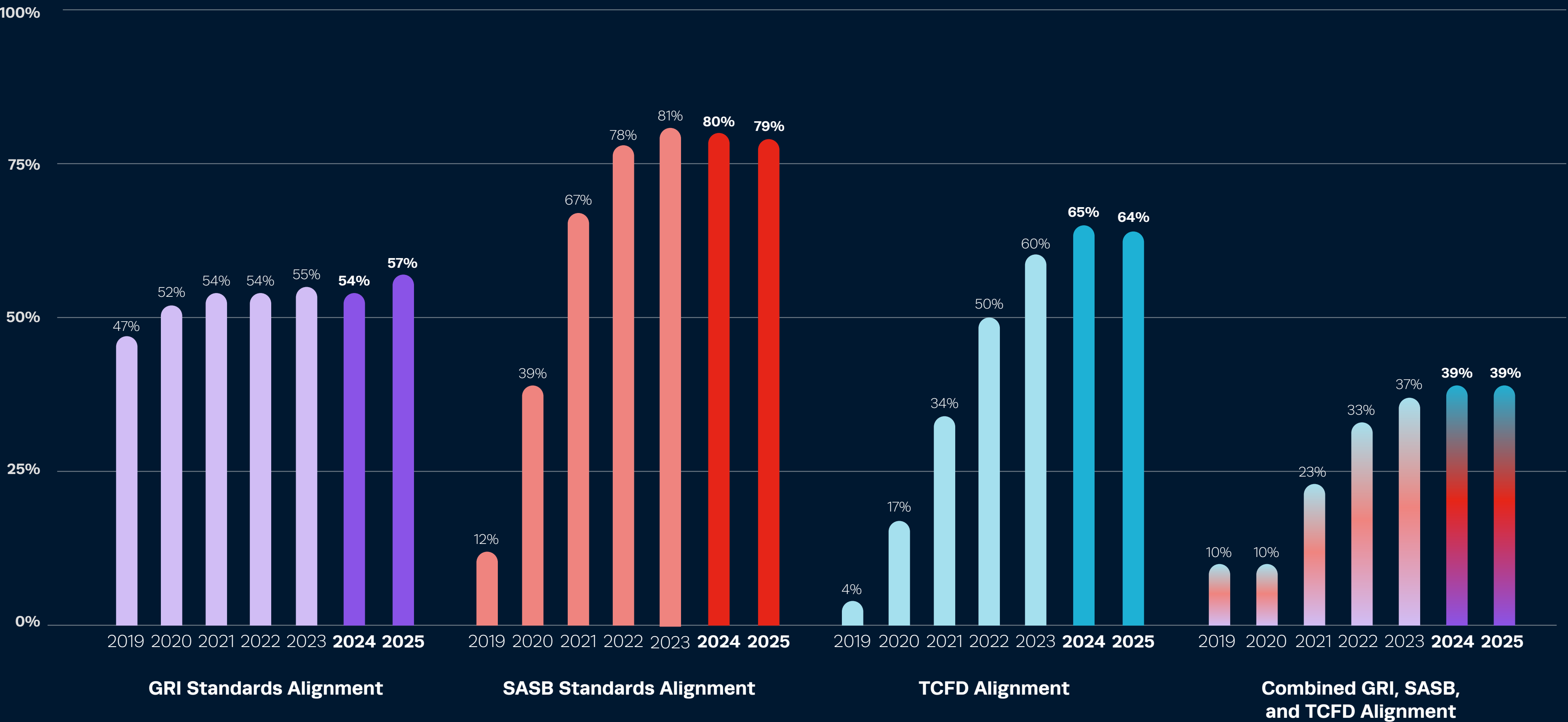
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In 2025, 86.0% of the companies in the Russell 1000 Index published sustainability reports or comparable disclosures, a fall of 5.1 percentage points since 2024.

GRI alignment rose slightly among reporters in both halves of the Index, while reporters' alignment with SASB and TCFD declined overall across the Russell 1000 and S&P 500. However, TCFD increased in use among the Index's smaller companies, and SASB remained the most-used standard in the Russell 1000.<sup>5</sup>



<sup>5</sup>Unless otherwise noted, all 2024 and 2025 figures on reporters' alignment with frameworks and standards reflect G&A's updated research approach, outlined in the [Methodology](#) section of this report.



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# Global Reporting Initiative (GRI)

Looking to improve your company's GRI reporting? G&A can help! [Learn more](#)

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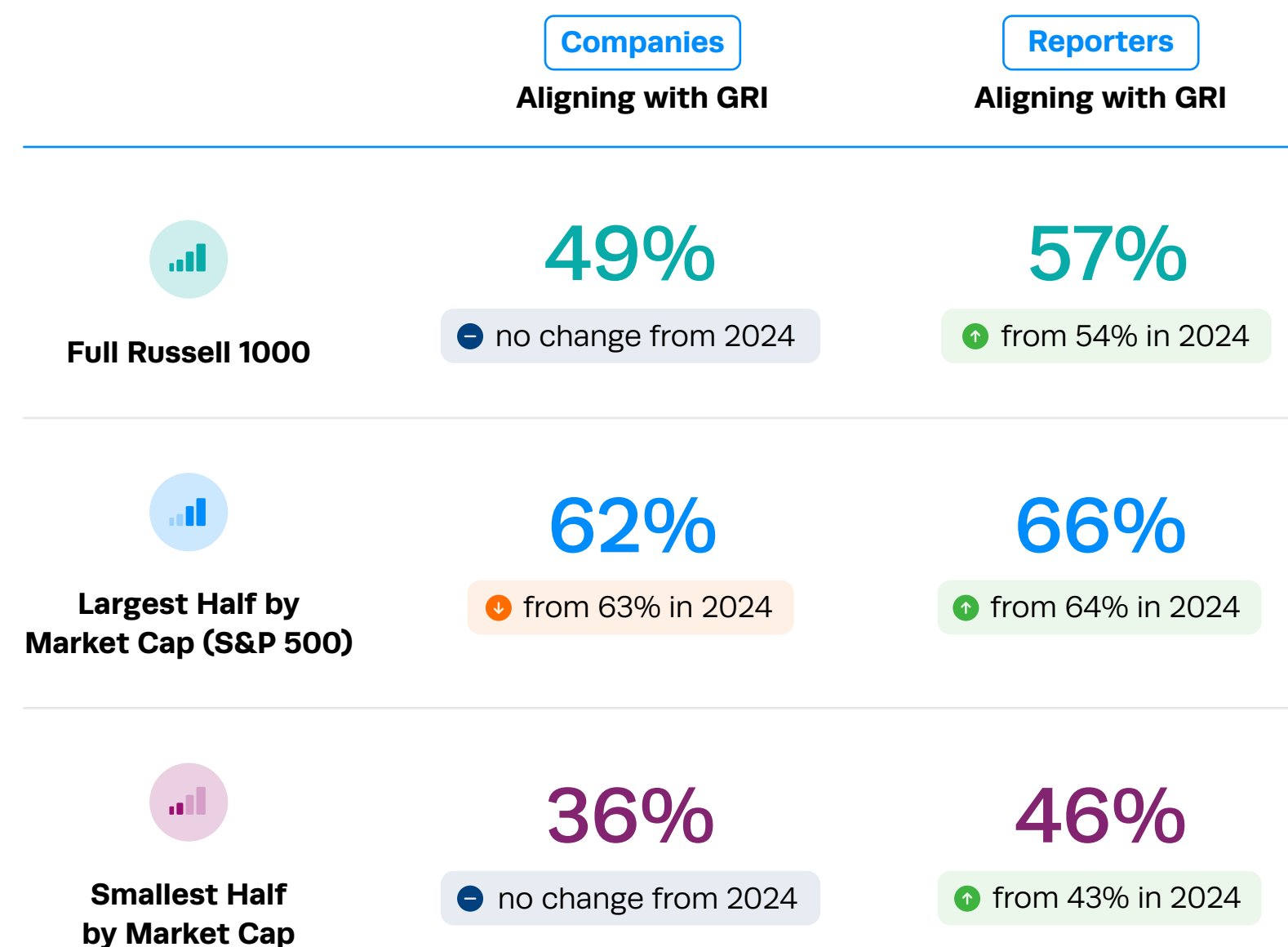
More sustainability reporters aligned with the GRI Standards than in previous years. Though the overall percentage of companies in the Russell 1000 aligning with GRI did not change, the percentage of reporters aligning with GRI increased within both halves of the Index.

Want to learn more about the evolution and benefits of the GRI Standards?

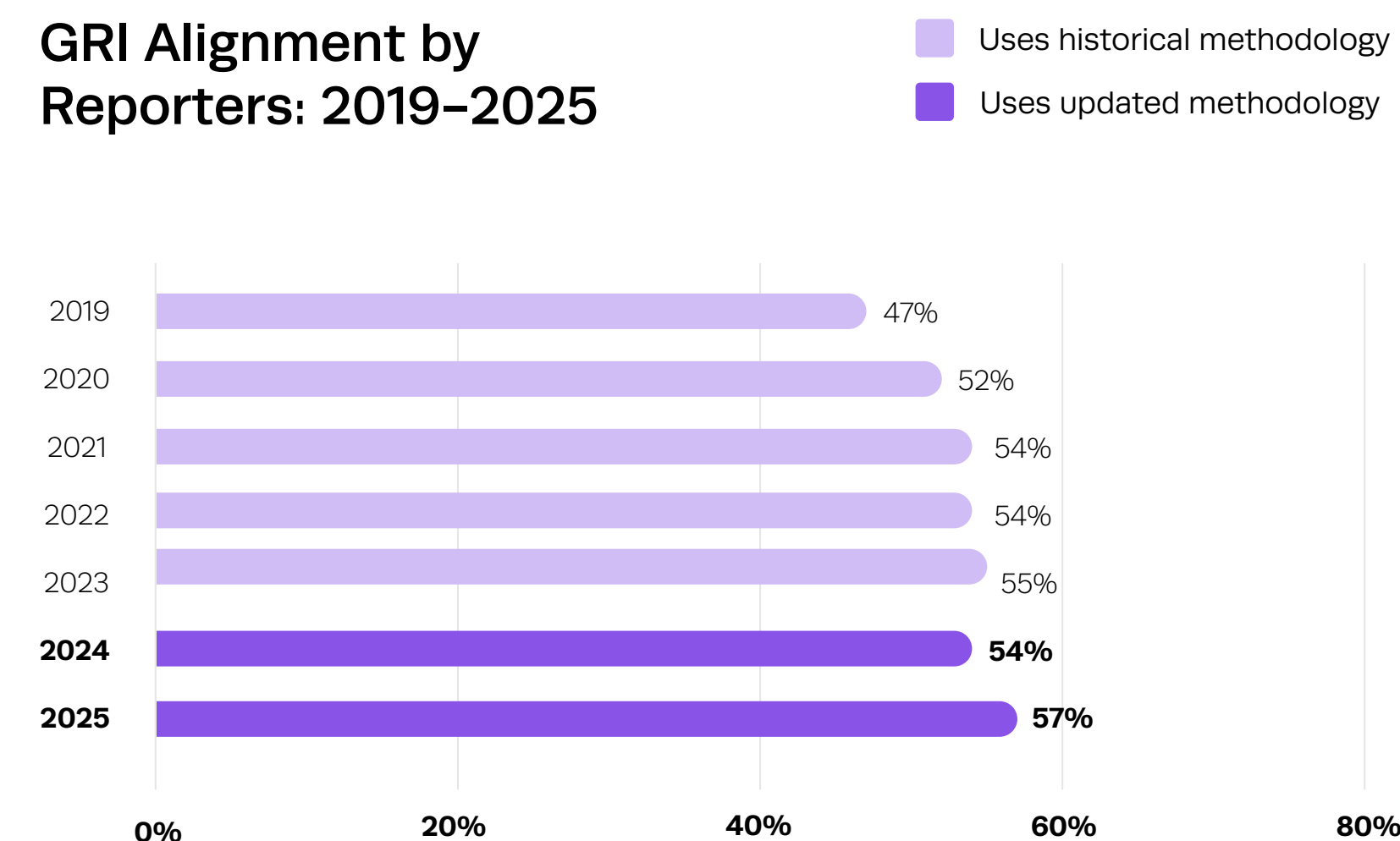
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### GRI Alignment: 2025



### GRI Alignment by Reporters: 2019–2025



The GRI Standards continued to be used by over half of Russell 1000 reporters in 2025.





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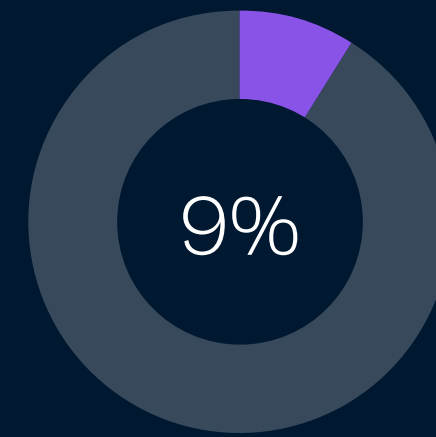
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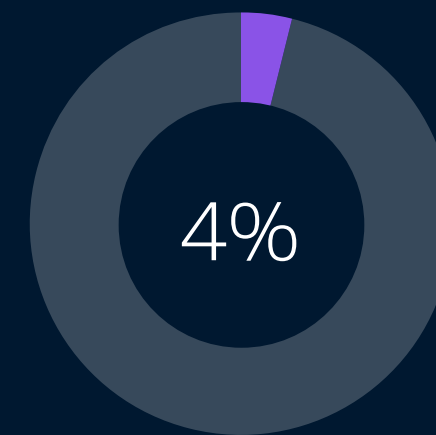
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## GRI Reporters Aligning with ISSB, TNFD, ESRS: 2025

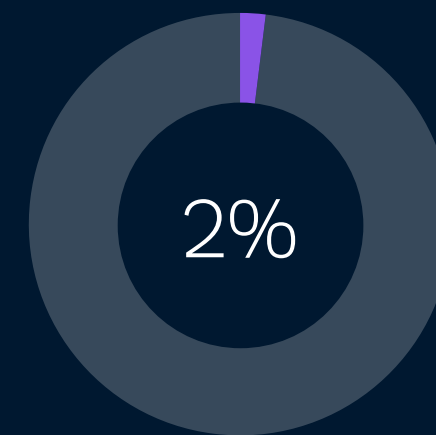
Of all companies reporting in alignment with GRI:



also fully aligned with **ISSB**



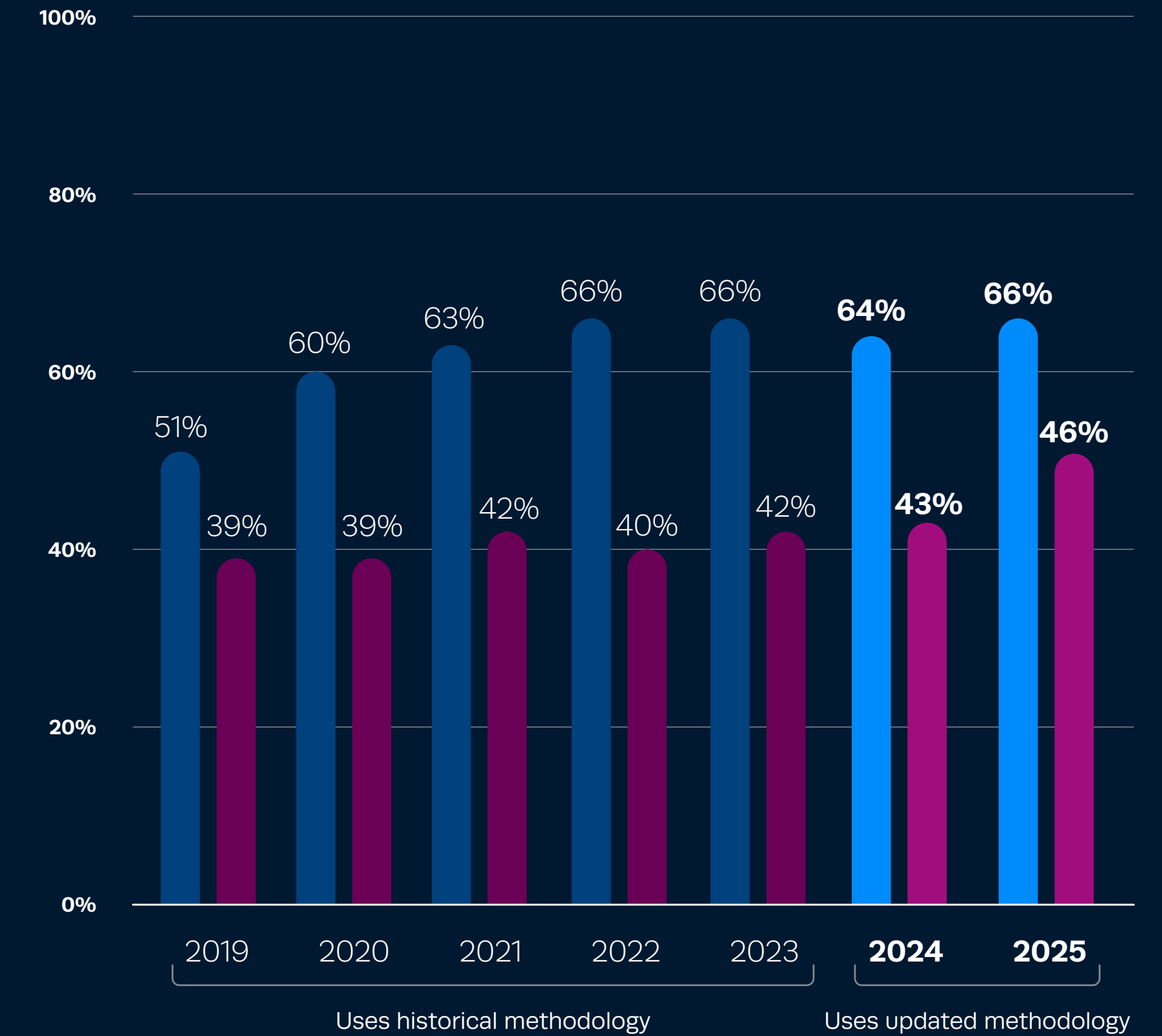
also fully aligned with **TNFD**



also fully aligned with **ESRS**

## GRI Alignment by Reporters: 2019–2025

■ Largest Half of Russell 1000   ■ Smallest Half of Russell 1000





## GRI Accordance Levels Among Reporters

The graphics on this page depict the current adoption of the GRI Standards among Russell 1000 reporters, the use of each version of the Standards, and the level of accordance to each version. Our findings indicate that almost all GRI reporters in the Russell 1000 have transitioned to using the GRI Universal Standards 2021, instead of the GRI Standards 2016 or older version.

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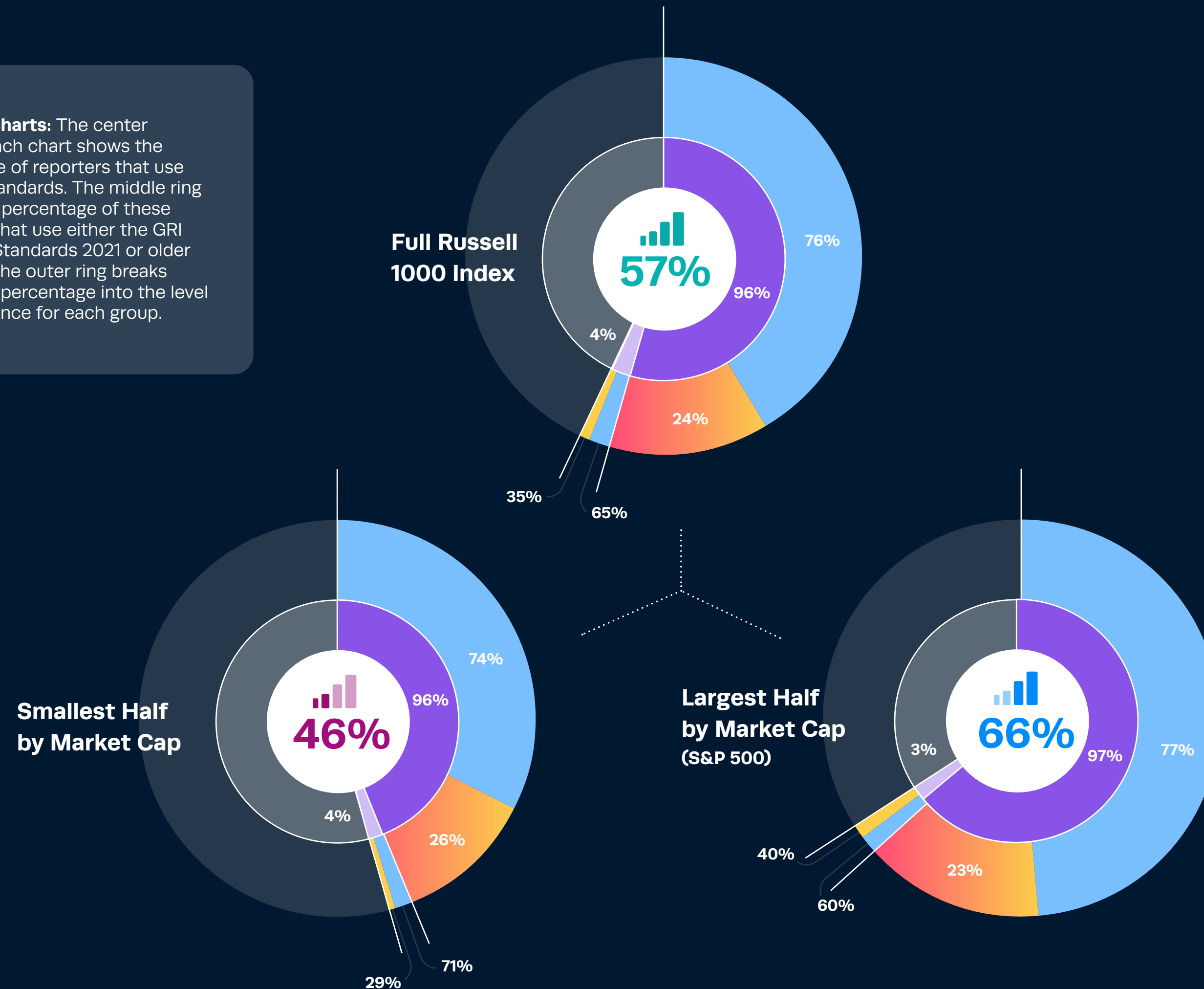
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**Guide to charts:** The center circle of each chart shows the percentage of reporters that use the GRI Standards. The middle ring shows the percentage of these reporters that use either the GRI Universal Standards 2021 or older versions. The outer ring breaks down that percentage into the level of accordance for each group.



### Legend

- GRI Universal Standards 2021
- In Accordance
- GRI-Referenced<sup>6</sup>
- GRI Standards 2016 or older
- In Accordance – Comprehensive
- In Accordance – Core
- GRI-Referenced<sup>6</sup>



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# Sustainability Accounting Standards Board (SASB)

Looking to improve your company's SASB reporting? G&A can help! [Learn more](#)

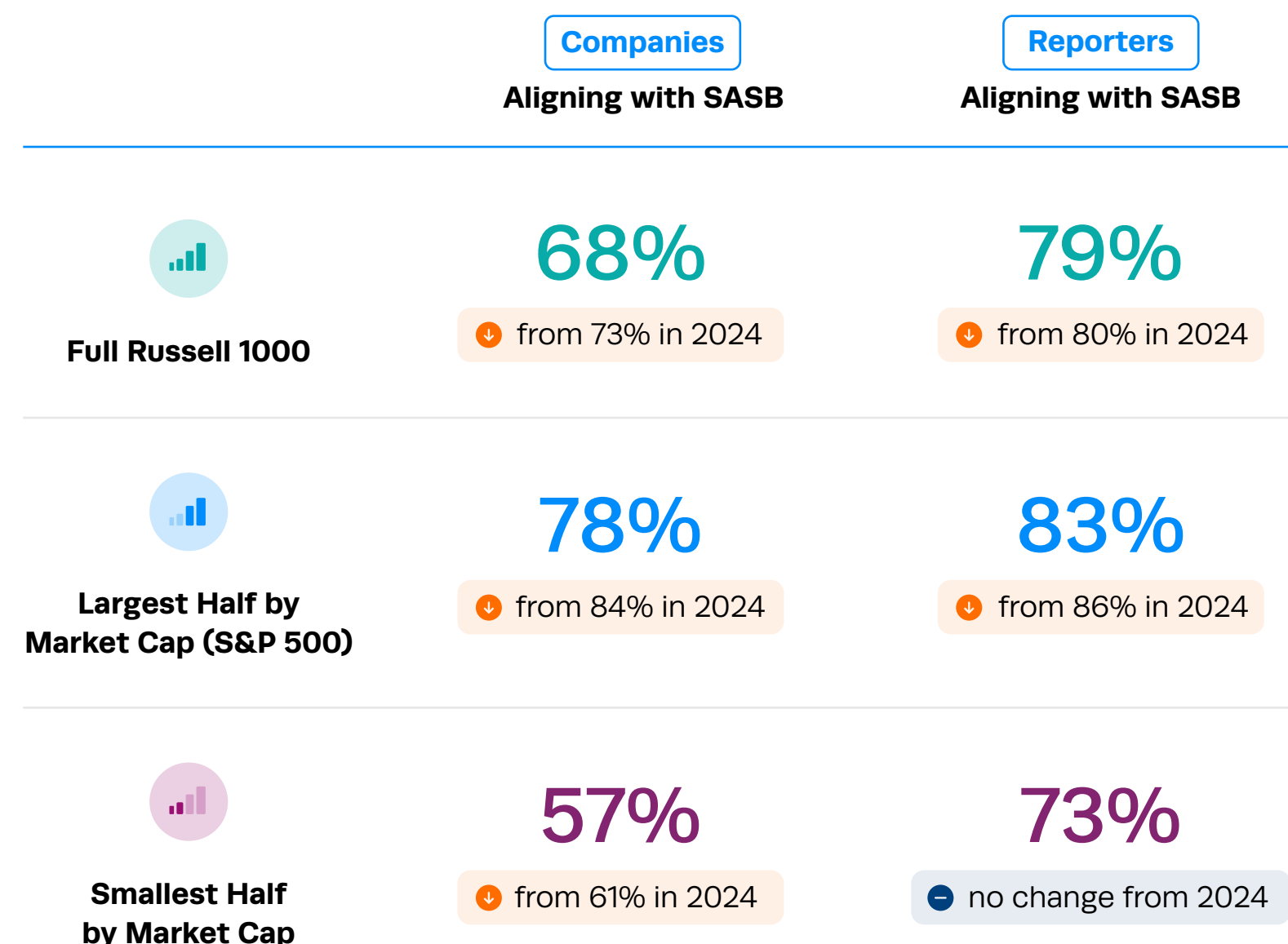
The SASB Standards, which are now under the ISSB's oversight and integrated with IFRS S1, remained the most widely used set of Standards among Russell 1000 companies, despite a slight decline.

Want to learn more about the evolution and benefits of the SASB Standards?

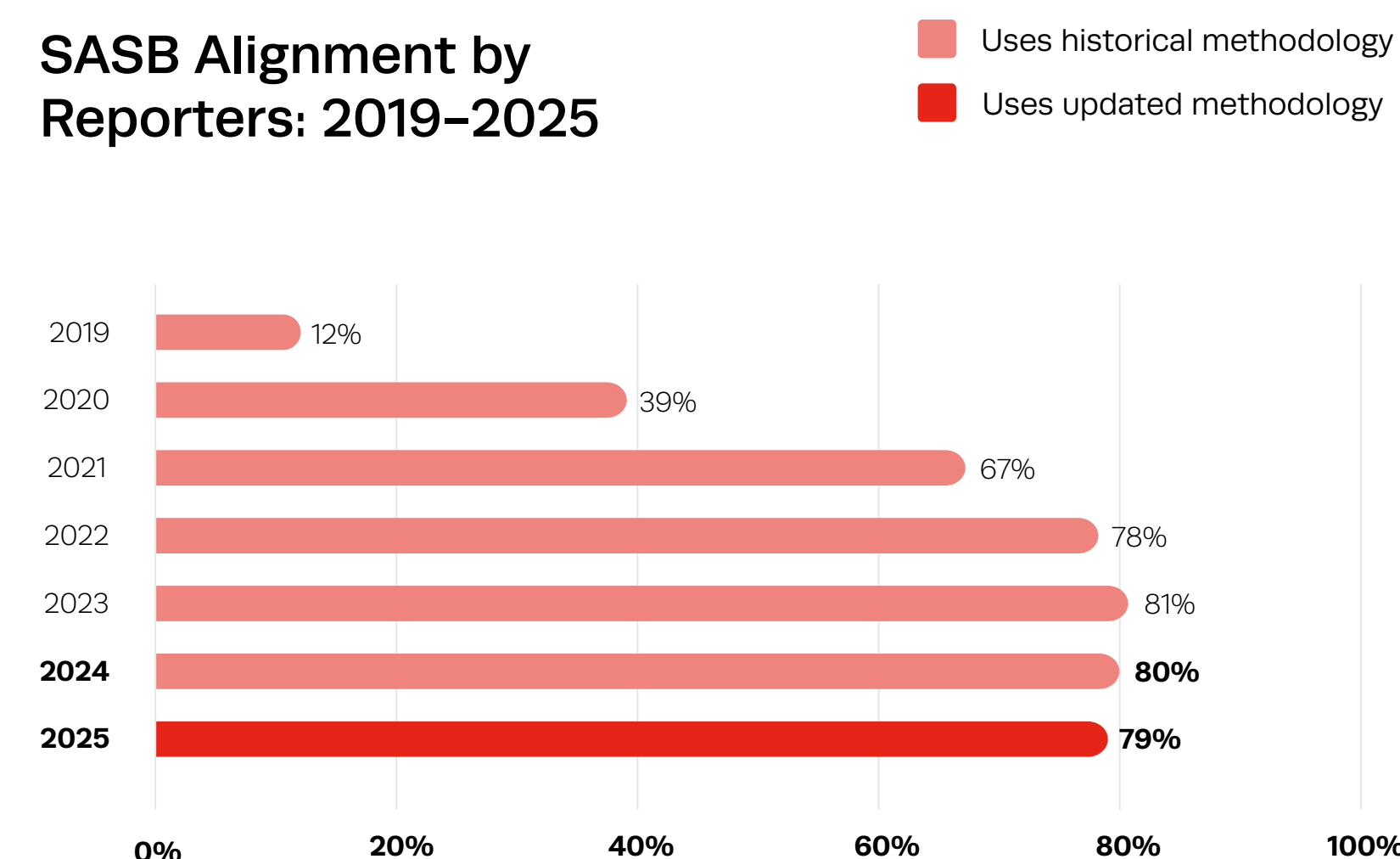
Explore



## SASB Alignment: 2025



## SASB Alignment by Reporters: 2019–2025



SASB remains the most-used standard of our research.



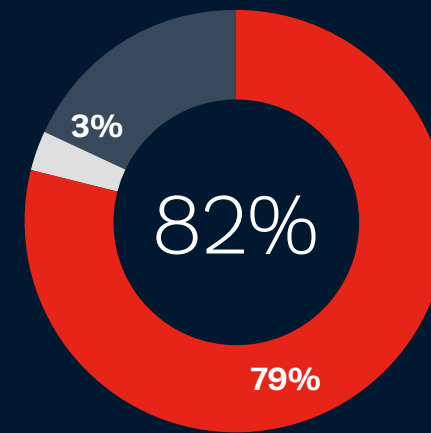
**15** YEARS  
Sustainability  
Reporting in Focus

## SASB Mentions and Alignment by Reporters: 2025

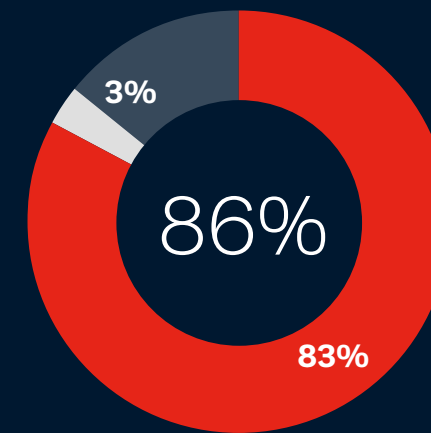
Reporters that align with SASB   Reporters that only mention SASB



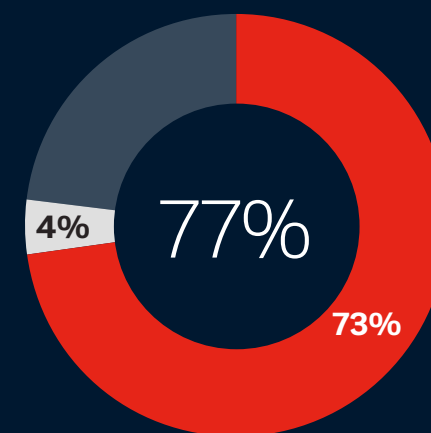
Full Russell 1000



Largest Half by  
Market Cap (S&P 500)

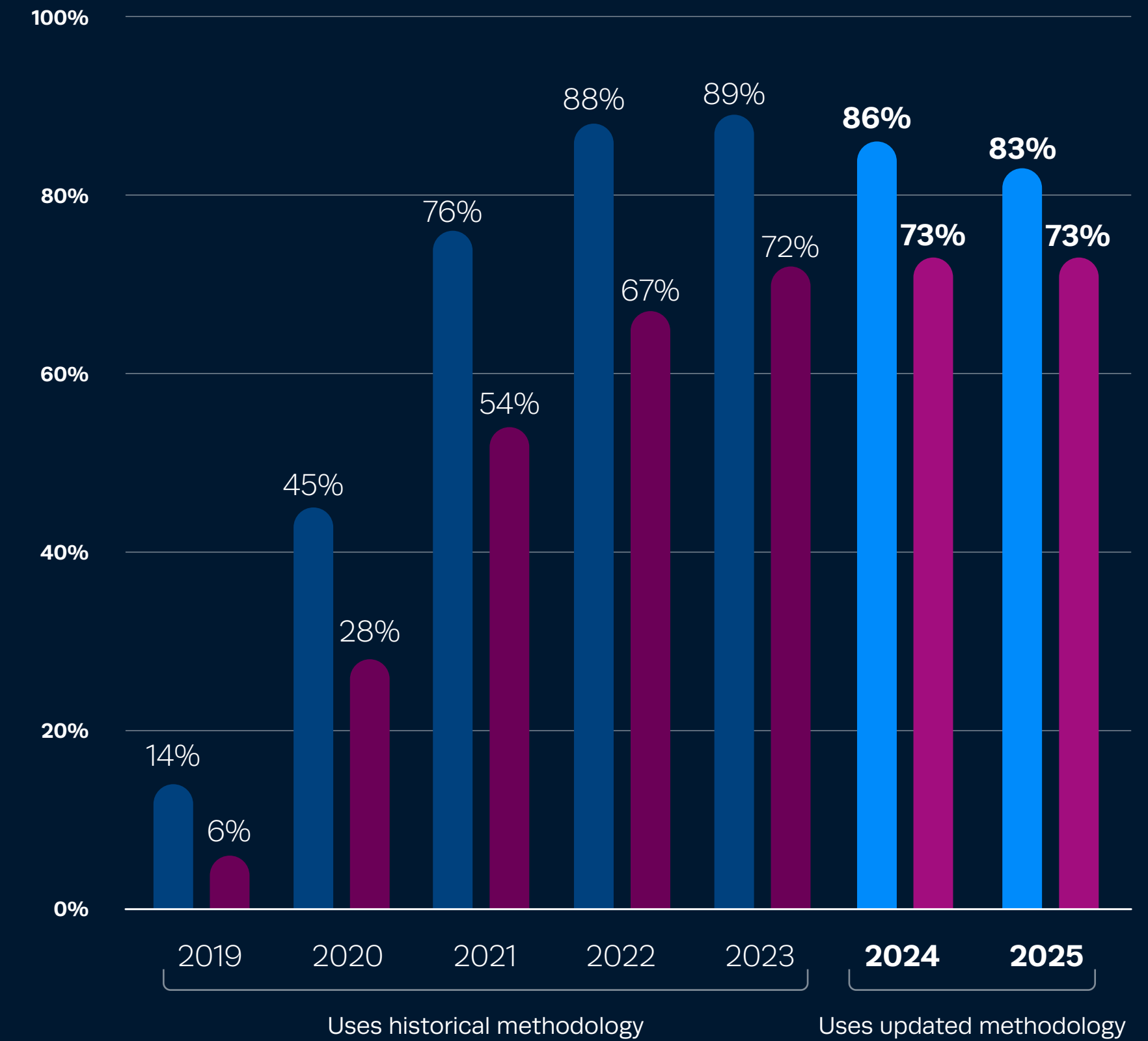


Smallest Half  
by Market Cap



## SASB Alignment by Reporters: 2019–2025

Largest Half of Russell 1000   Smallest Half of Russell 1000





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# Task Force on Climate-related Financial Disclosures (TCFD)

Looking to improve your company's TCFD reporting? G&A can help! [Learn more](#)

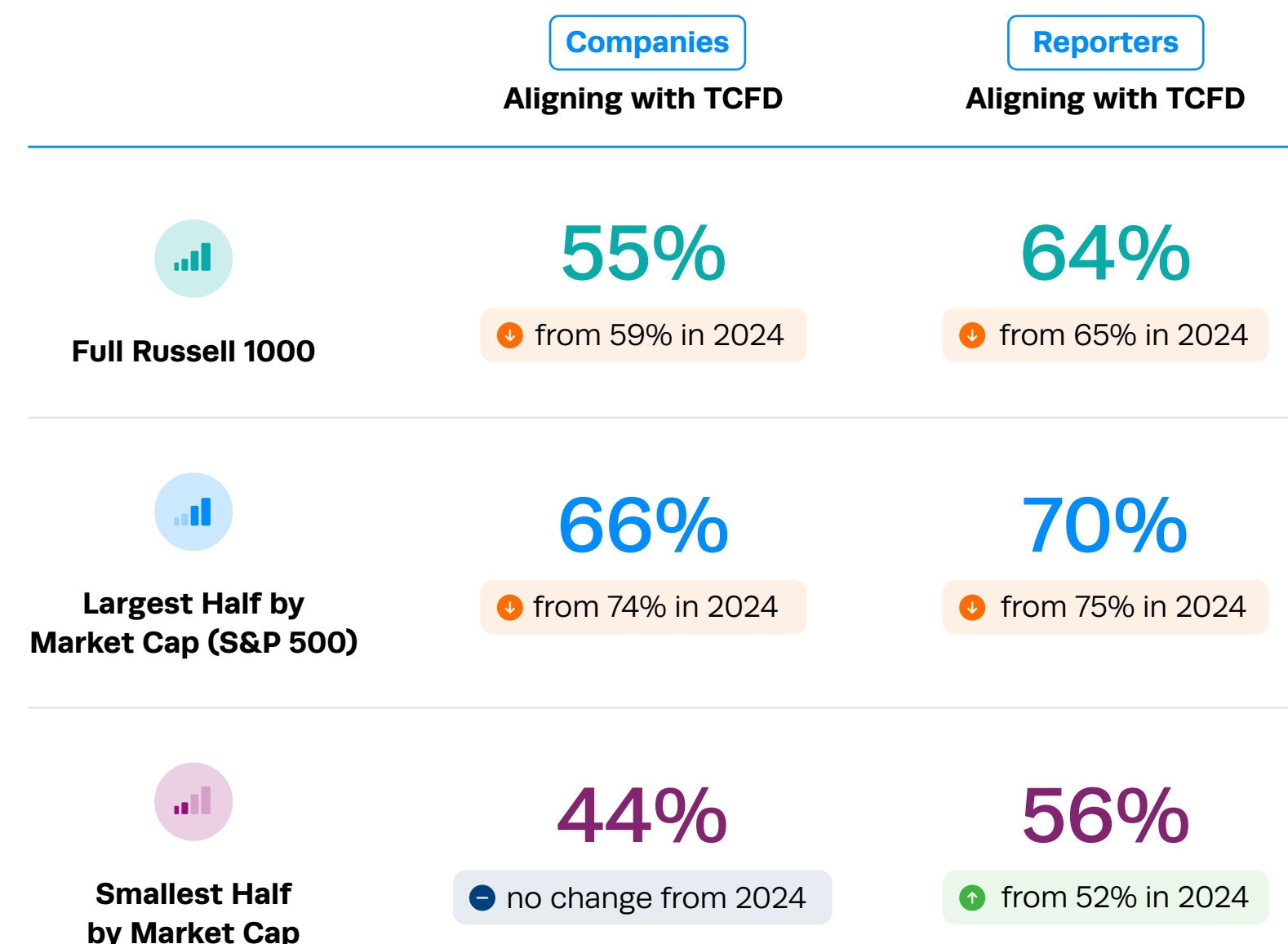
In 2025, we saw a slight decrease in TCFD alignment among Russell 1000 reporters: 64% of Russell 1000 reporters aligned with TCFD, down from 65% in 2024. However, TCFD use increased among the Index's smaller companies.

Want to learn more about the evolution and benefits of the TCFD Standards?

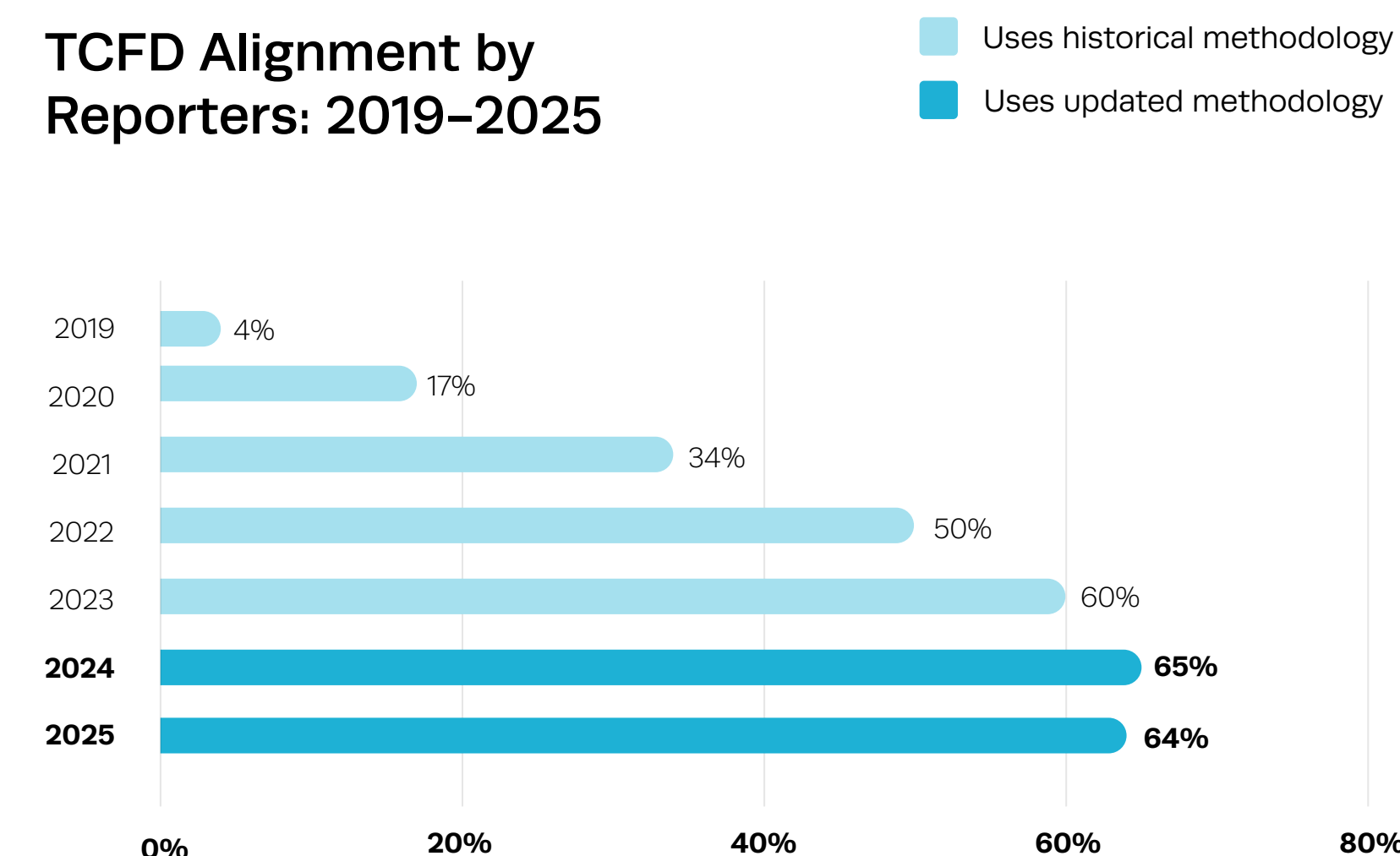
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## TCFD Alignment: 2025



## TCFD Alignment by Reporters: 2019–2025



TCFD alignment decreased among reporters overall but increased among the smaller companies on the Index.



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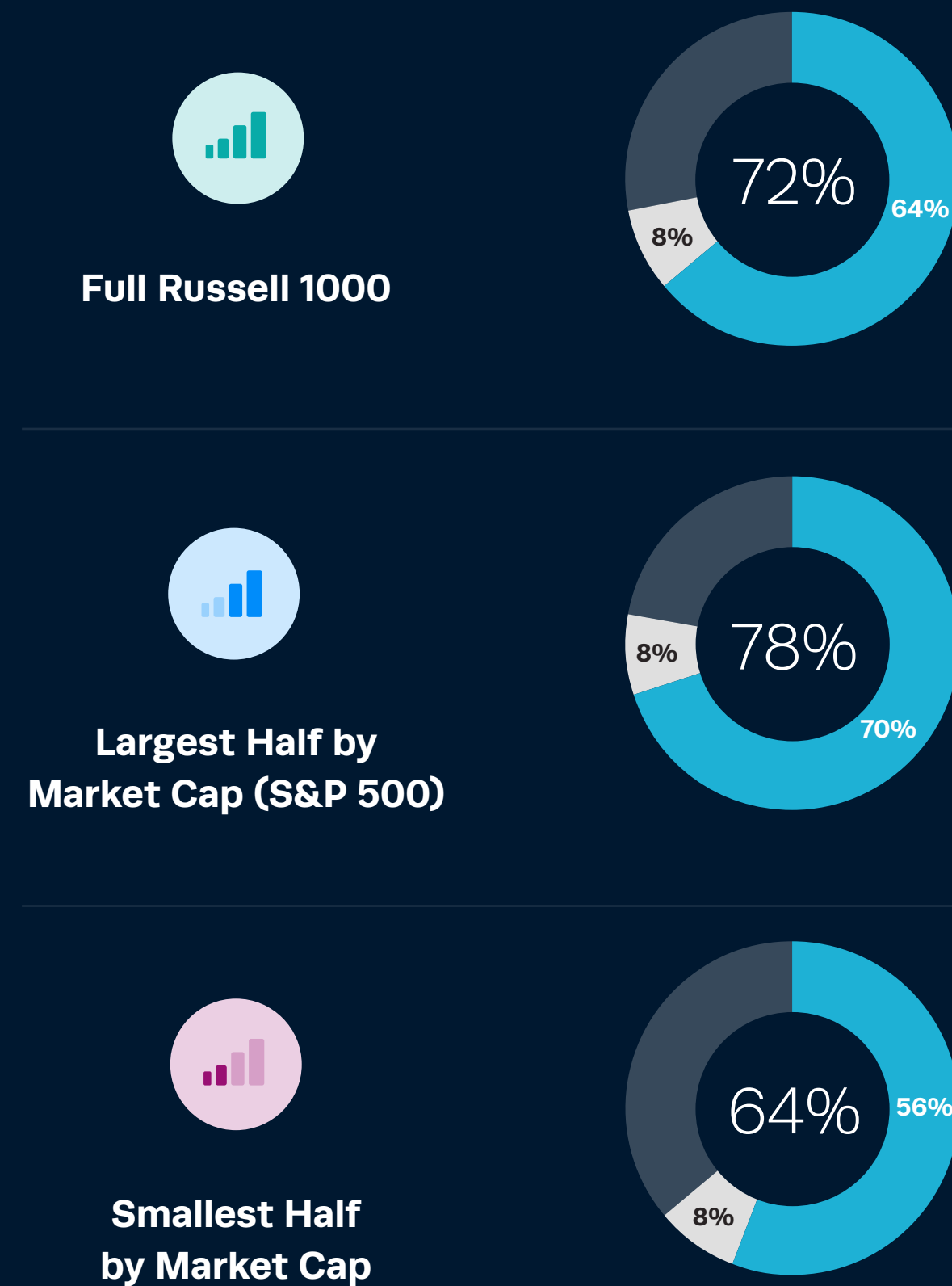
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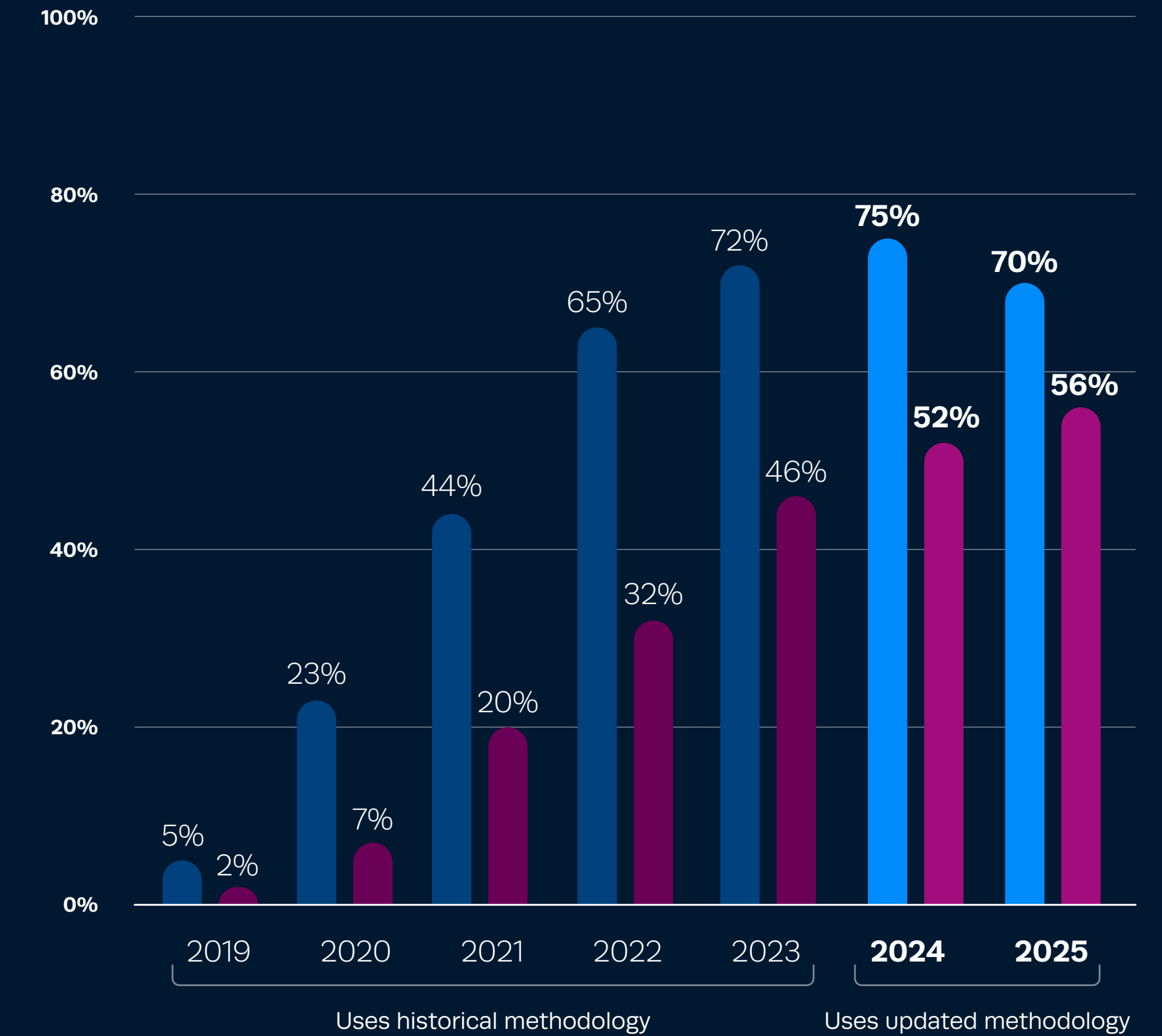
### TCFD Mentions and Alignment by Reporters: 2025

Reporters that align with TCFD   Reporters that only mention TCFD



### TCFD Alignment by Reporters: 2019–2025

Largest Half of Russell 1000   Smallest Half of Russell 1000





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# International Sustainability Standards Board (ISSB)



Looking to transition to ISSB reporting from SASB or TCFD? G&A can help! [Learn more](#)

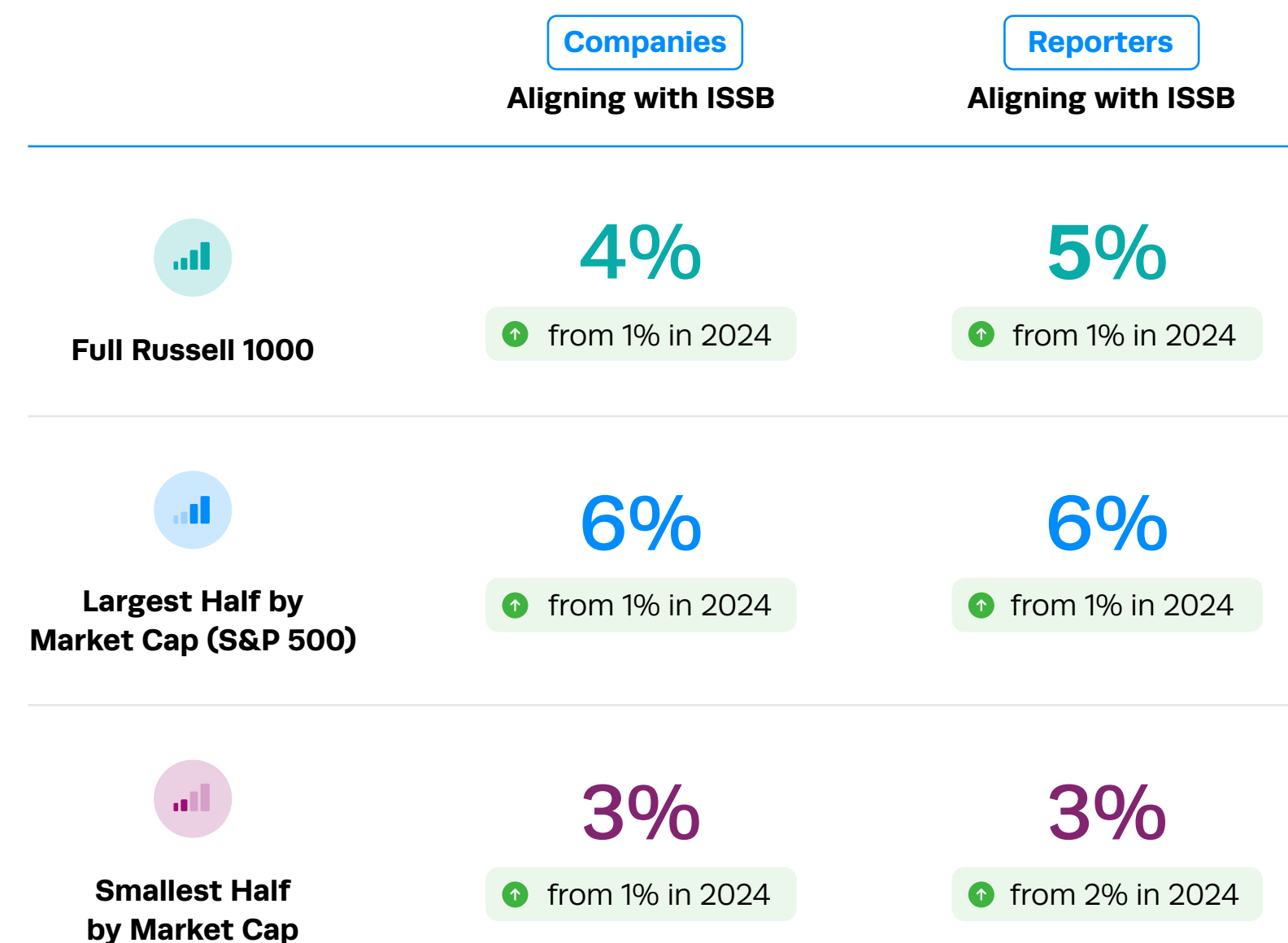
The percentage of Russell 1000 reporters that either mentioned or aligned with the ISSB Standards in their sustainability reports was 30%, reflecting a growing acknowledgement by companies of the transition to ISSB from SASB and TCFD, even if adoption of the ISSB Standards remained low.

Want to learn more about the evolution and benefits of the ISSB Standards?

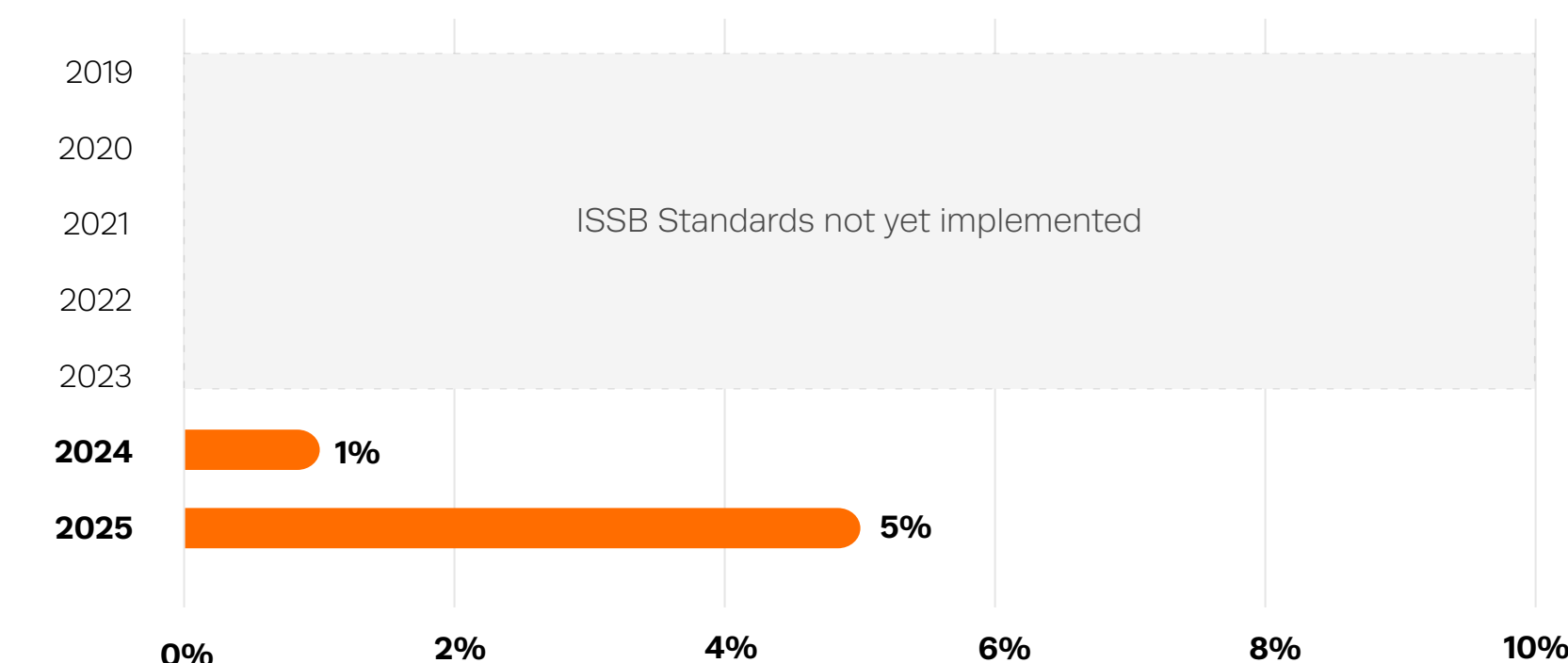
Explore



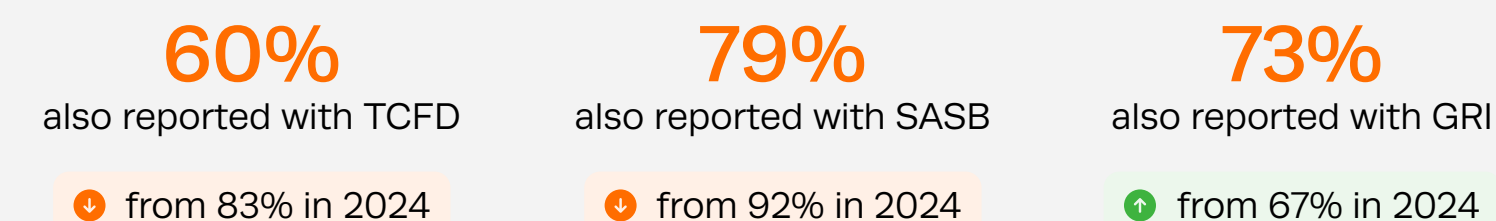
### ISSB Alignment:<sup>7</sup> 2025



### ISSB Alignment by Reporters:<sup>7</sup> 2024–2025



Of the companies that aligned with IFRS S2:





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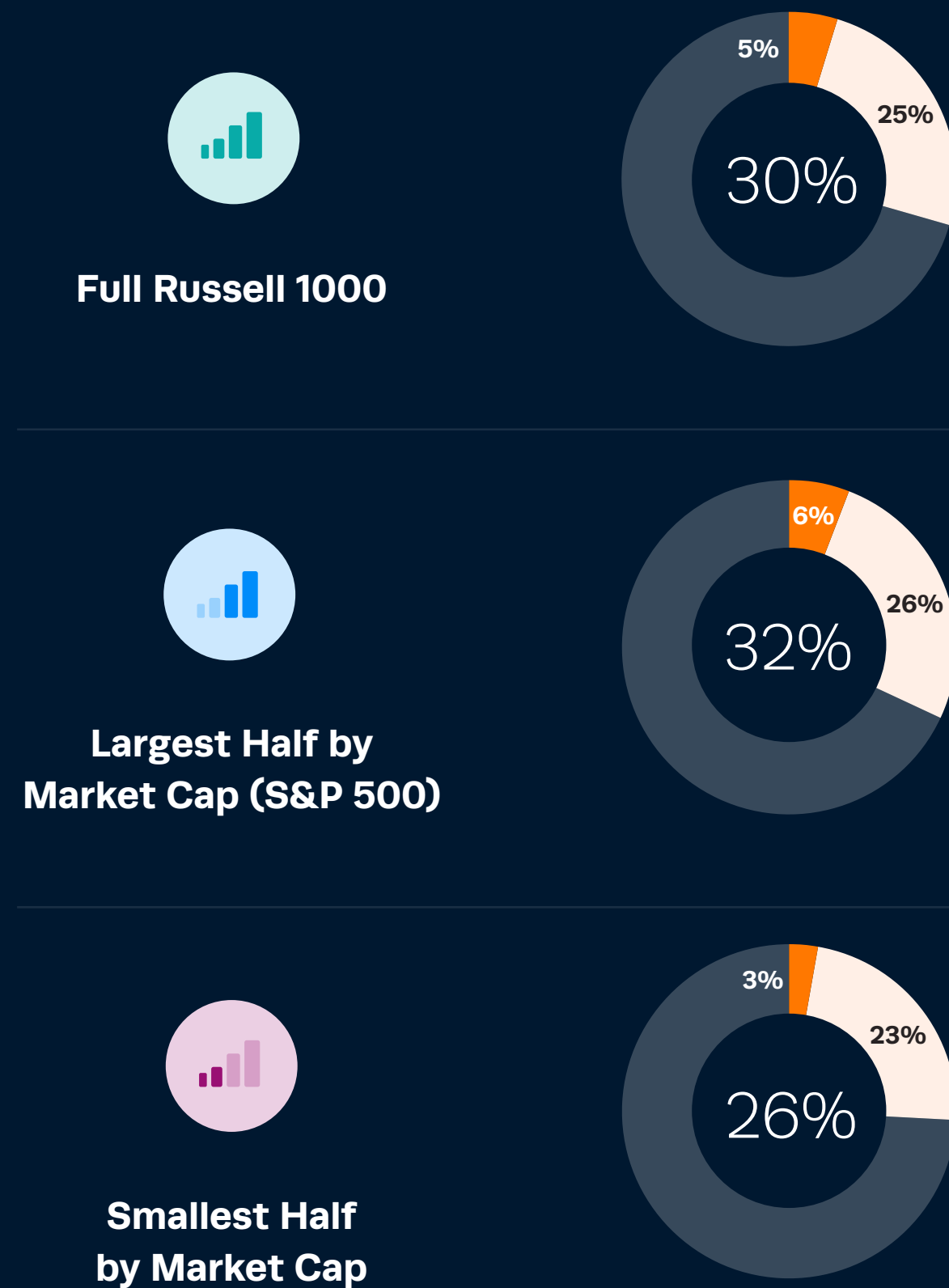
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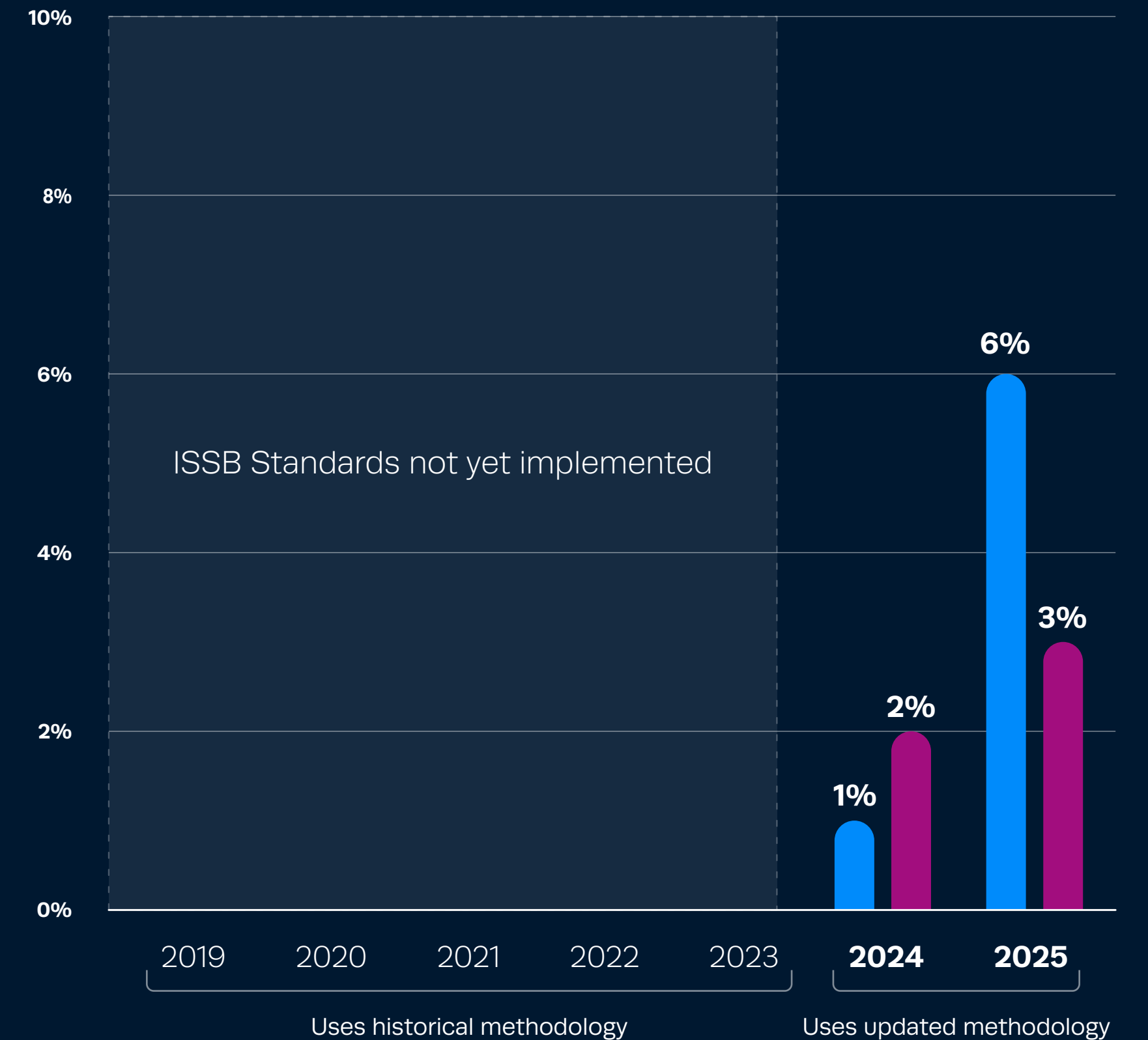
### ISSB Mentions and Alignment by Reporters: 2025

Reporters that align with ISSB   Reporters that only mention ISSB



### ISSB Alignment by Reporters: 2024–2025

Largest Half of Russell 1000   Smallest Half of Russell 1000







# European Sustainability Reporting Standards (ESRS)

Looking to improve your company's ESRS reporting? G&A can help! [Learn more](#)

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After being adopted in 2023, the ESRS were used by reporting companies more than three times as much in 2025 as in 2024. The majority of reporters that aligned with ESRS also reported with TCFD, SASB, and/or GRI.

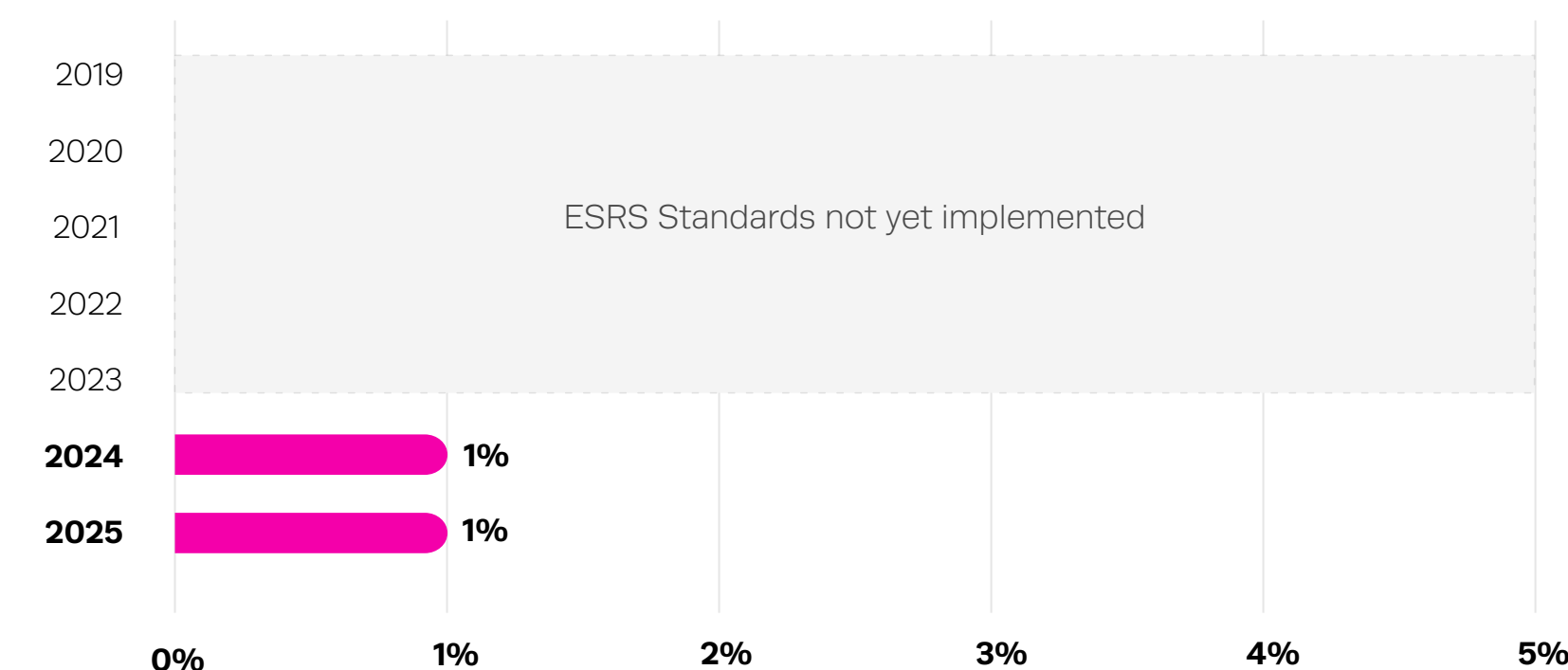
Want to learn more about the evolution and benefits of the ESRS Standards?

[Explore](#) →

### ESRS Alignment:<sup>8</sup> 2025

|                                                                                                                                         | Companies                        | Reporters                        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|
|                                                                                                                                         | Aligning with ESRS               | Aligning with ESRS               |
| <br><b>Full Russell 1000</b>                        | <b>1%</b><br>no change from 2024 | <b>1%</b><br>no change from 2024 |
| <br><b>Largest Half by Market Cap (S&amp;P 500)</b> | <b>1%</b><br>no change from 2024 | <b>1%</b><br>no change from 2024 |
| <br><b>Smallest Half by Market Cap</b>              | <b>2%</b><br>from 0.2% in 2024   | <b>2%</b><br>from 0.2% in 2024   |

### ESRS Alignment by Reporters:<sup>8</sup> 2024–2025



Of the companies that aligned with ESRS:

**57%**

also reported with TCFD

**71%**

also reported with SASB

**71%**

also reported with GRI



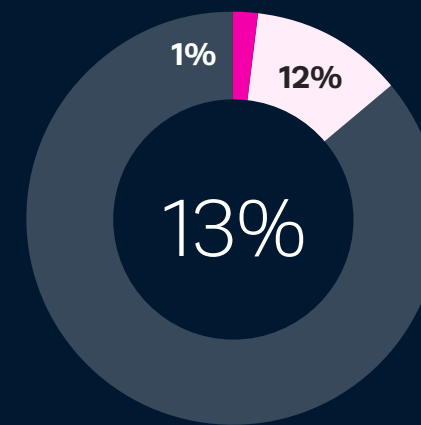
**15 YEARS**  
Sustainability  
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## ESRS Mentions and Alignment by Reporters: 2025

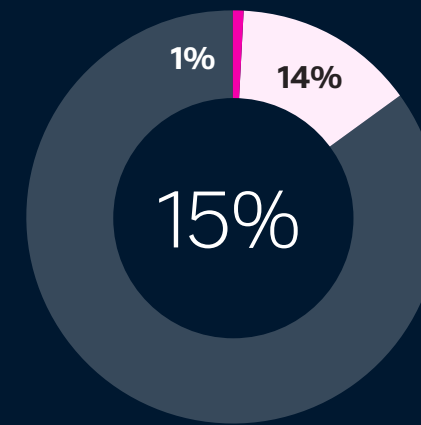
■ Reporters that align with ESRS   ■ Reporters that only mention ESRS



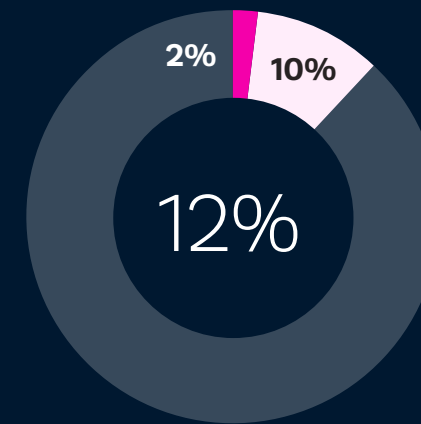
Full Russell 1000



Largest Half by  
Market Cap (S&P 500)

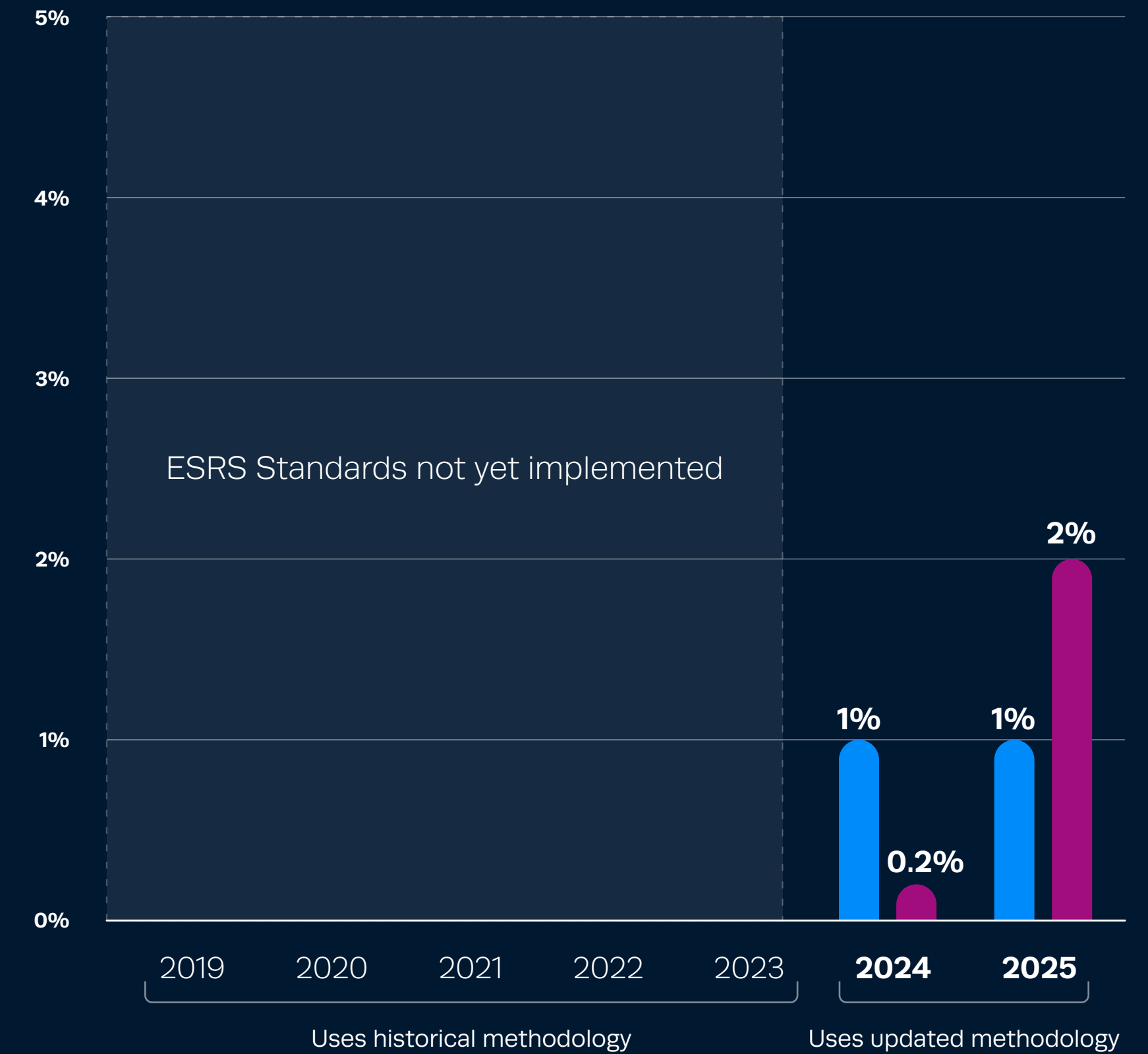


Smallest Half  
by Market Cap



## ESRS Alignment by Reporters: 2024-2025

■ Largest Half of Russell 1000   ■ Smallest Half of Russell 1000



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★ NEW!

# Science Based Targets initiative

Looking to improve your company's SBTi target setting? G&A can help! [Learn more](#)

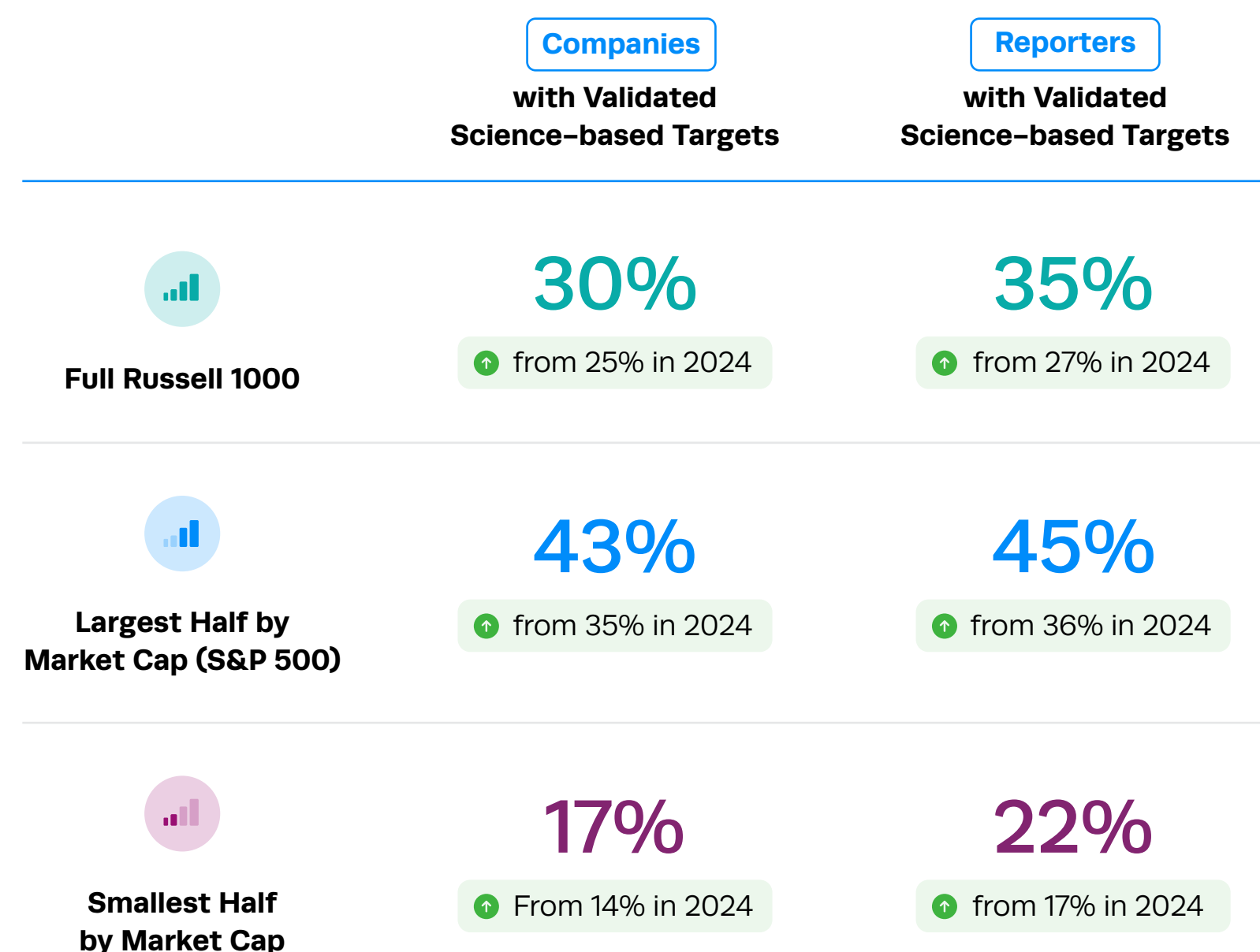
Setting a validated science-based target reflects a company's public-facing commitment and serves as an indicator of corporate sustainability maturity, alongside data disclosures and broader sustainability reporting. Target-setting continued a steady rise in 2025 among both larger and smaller companies on the Russell 1000. In particular, target-setting increased by nine percentage points in one year among the largest reporters, 45% of which now have validated targets (whether near-term or long-term).

Want to learn more about the evolution and benefits of SBTi?

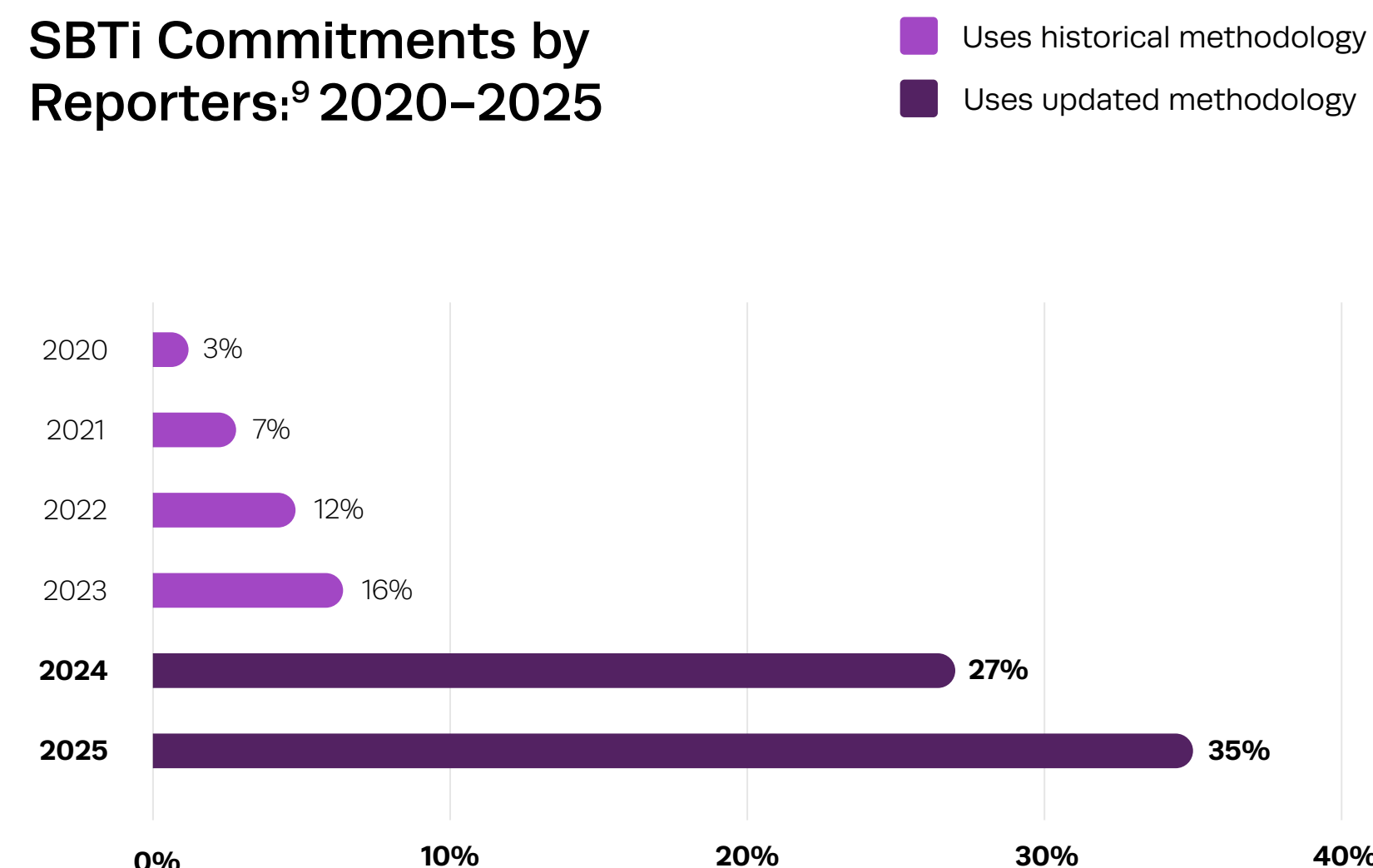
Explore



### SBTi Commitments:<sup>9</sup> 2025



### SBTi Commitments by Reporters:<sup>9</sup> 2020–2025



The percentage of companies committing to science-based targets continued to grow.



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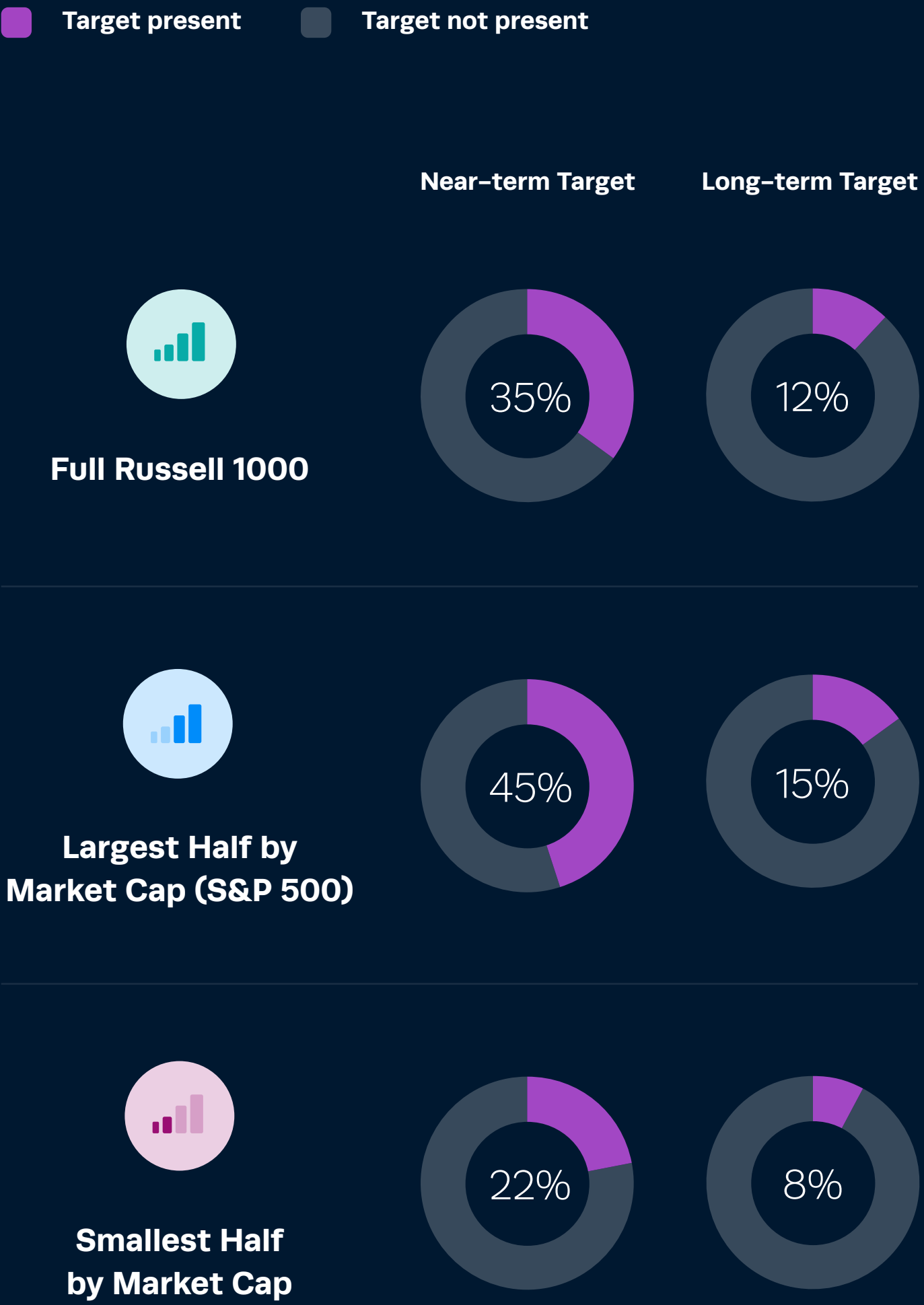
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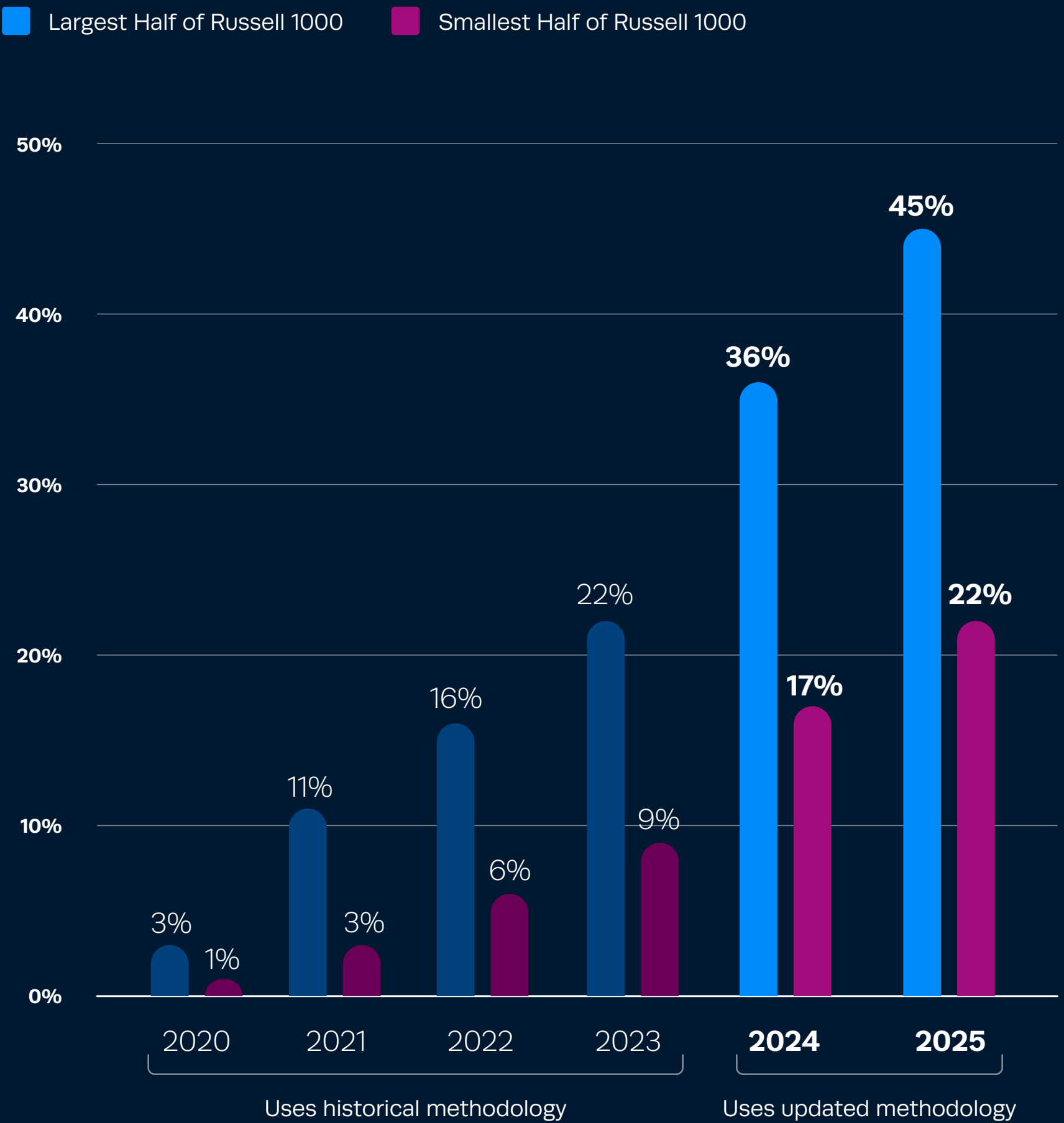
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SBTi Near- and Long-term Targets by Reporters: 2025



SBTi Commitments by Reporters:<sup>10</sup> 2020–2025



<sup>10</sup>This data reflects percentages of companies and reporters setting either near-term or long-term targets.

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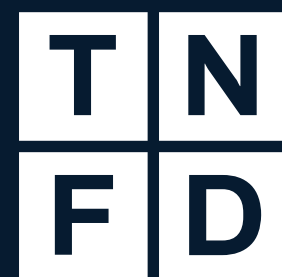
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# Taskforce on Nature-related Financial Disclosures (TNFD)



Looking to improve your company's TNFD reporting? G&A can help! [Learn more](#)

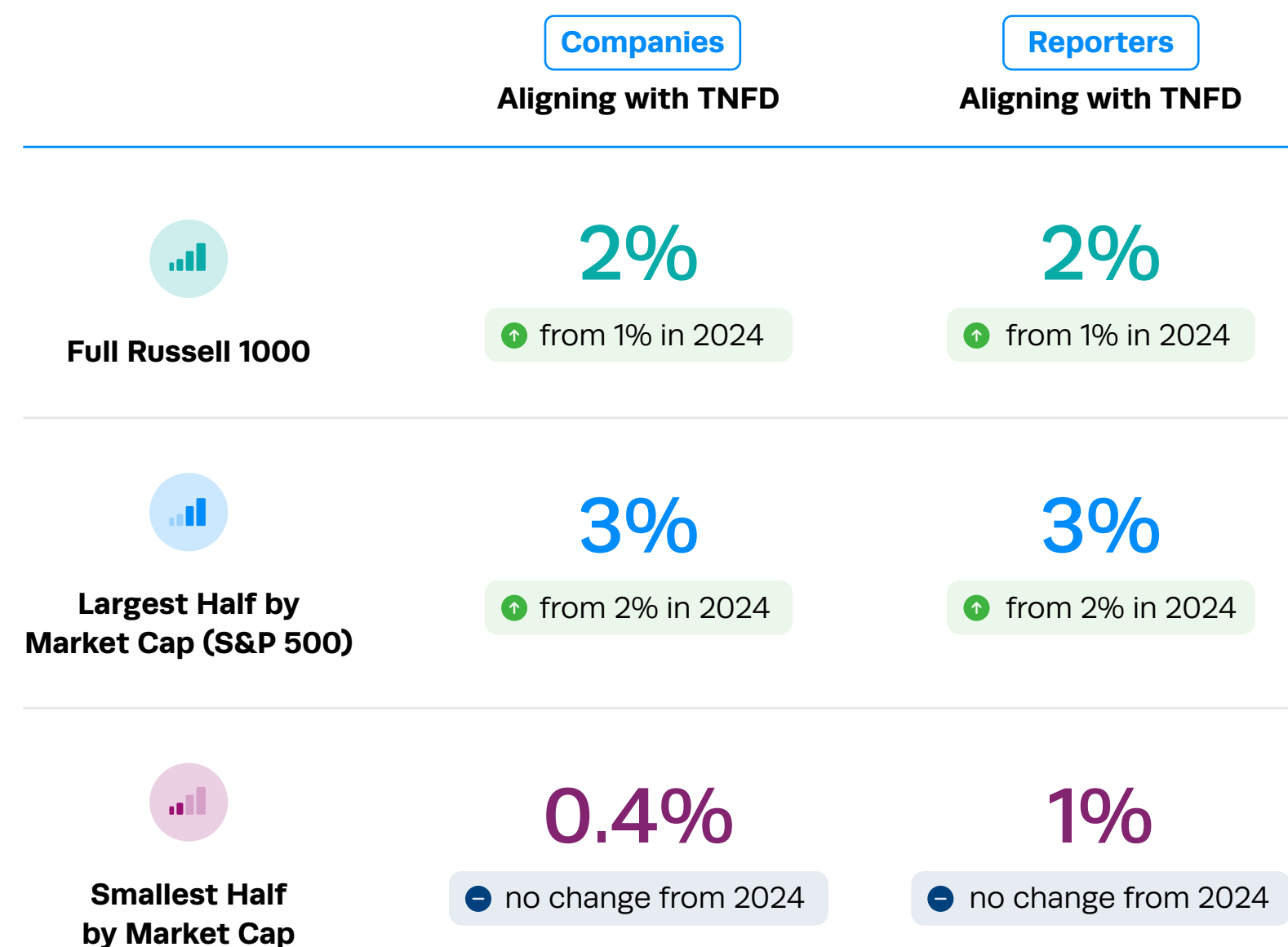
In 2025, only 2% of the Russell 1000 applied the TNFD Recommendations in their sustainability reporting. The reporters represent seven business sectors: Financials, Materials, Consumer Staples, Industrials, Real Estate, Consumer Discretionary, and Energy.

Want to learn more about the evolution and benefits of the TNFD Standards?

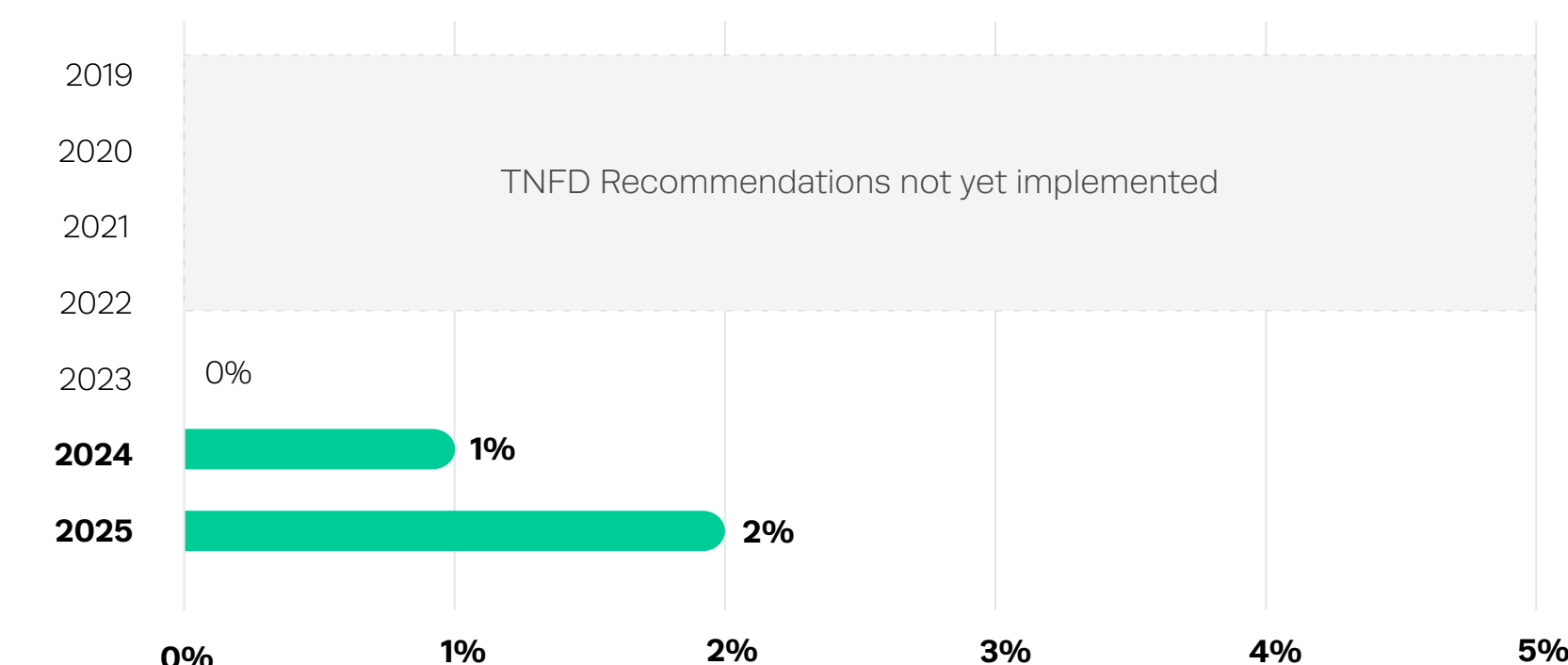
Explore



## TNFD Alignment: 2025



## TNFD Alignment by Reporters: 2023–2025



Of the companies that aligned with TNFD:

81%

also aligned with TCFD

81%

also aligned with SASB

100%

also aligned with GRI



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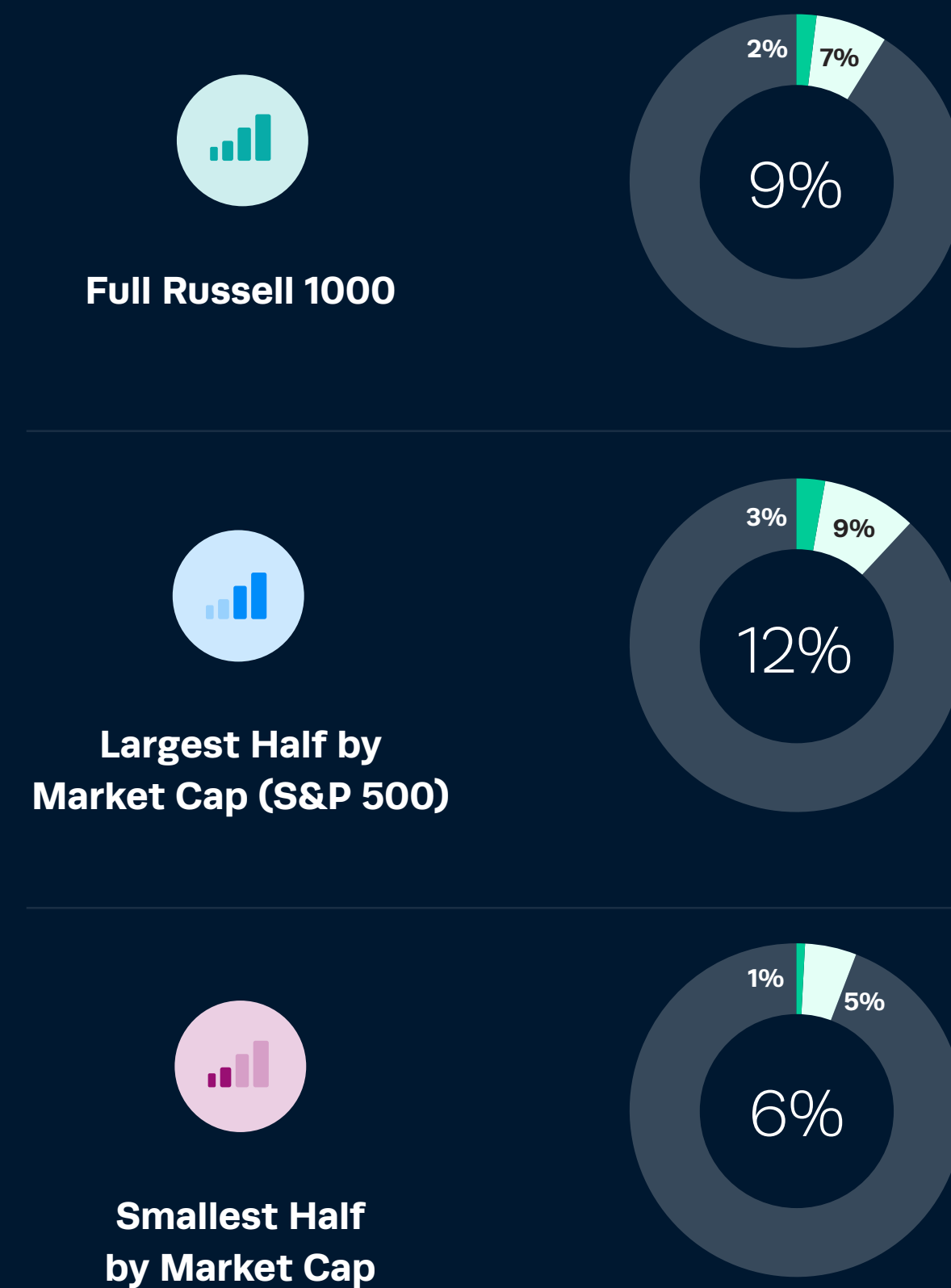
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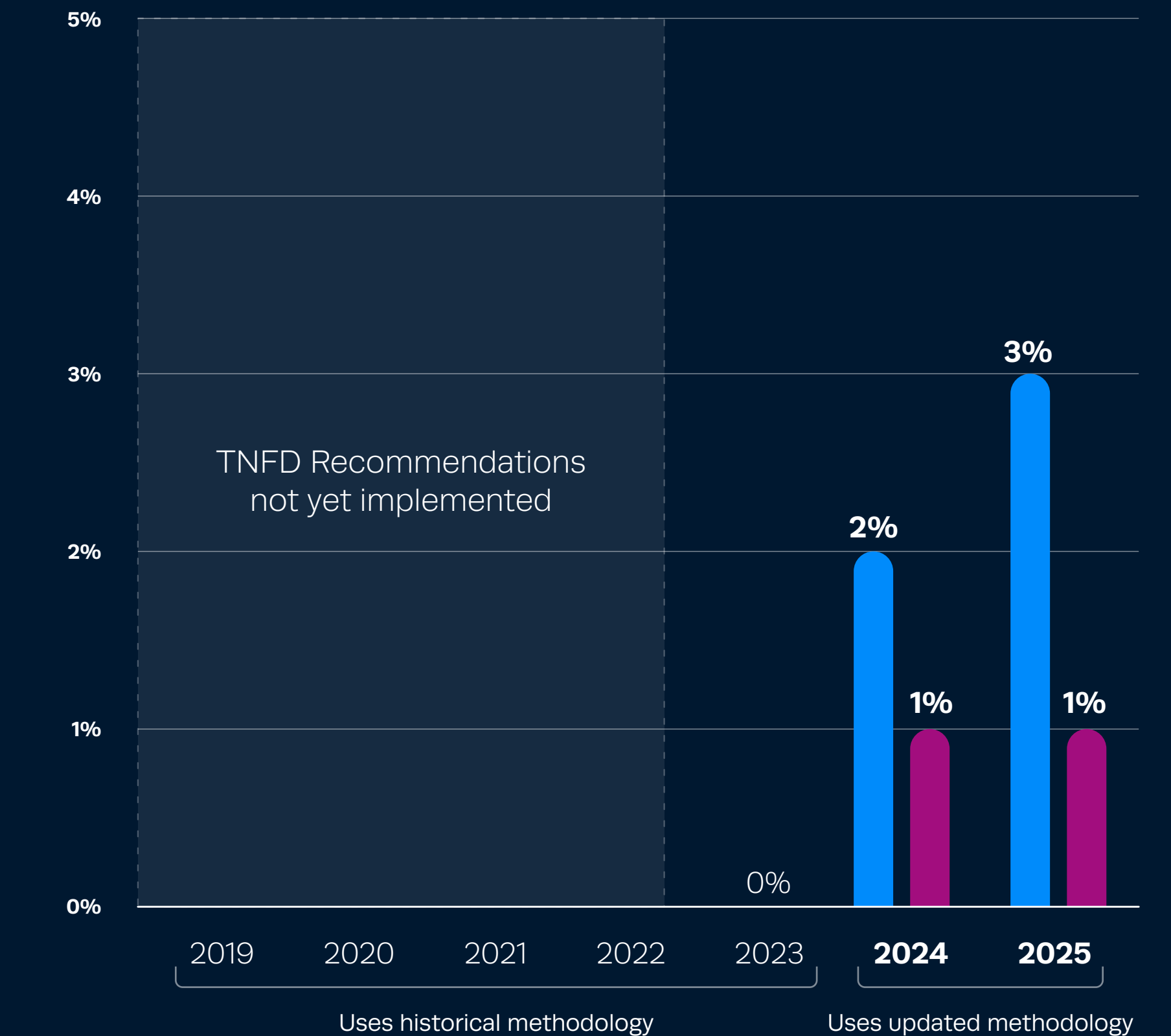
## TNFD Mentions and Alignment by Reporters: 2025

Reporters that align with TNFD   Reporters that only mention TNFD



## TNFD Alignment by Reporters: 2023–2025

Largest Half of Russell 1000   Smallest Half of Russell 1000







**15** YEARS  
Sustainability  
Reporting in Focus

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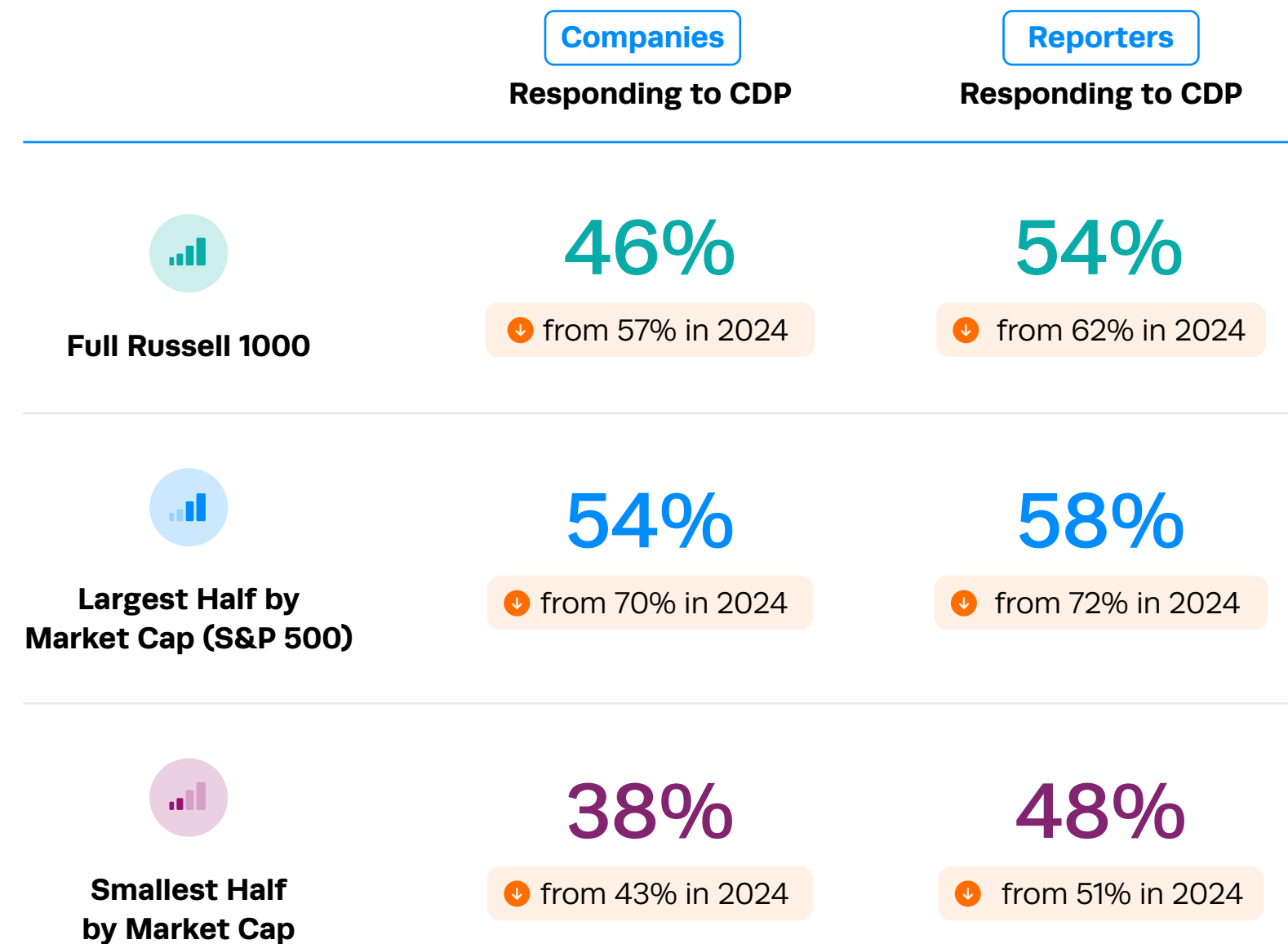
Looking to improve your  
company's CDP reporting?  
G&A can help! [Learn more](#)

Fewer Russell 1000 reporters responded to the CDP Climate Change questionnaire in 2025 than in 2024. The eight-percentage-point drop brings reporting closer to the 2021 level than to any other year since. The Forests questionnaire also had fewer responders, making Water Security the only CDP module with increased responses by Russell 1000 companies in 2025.

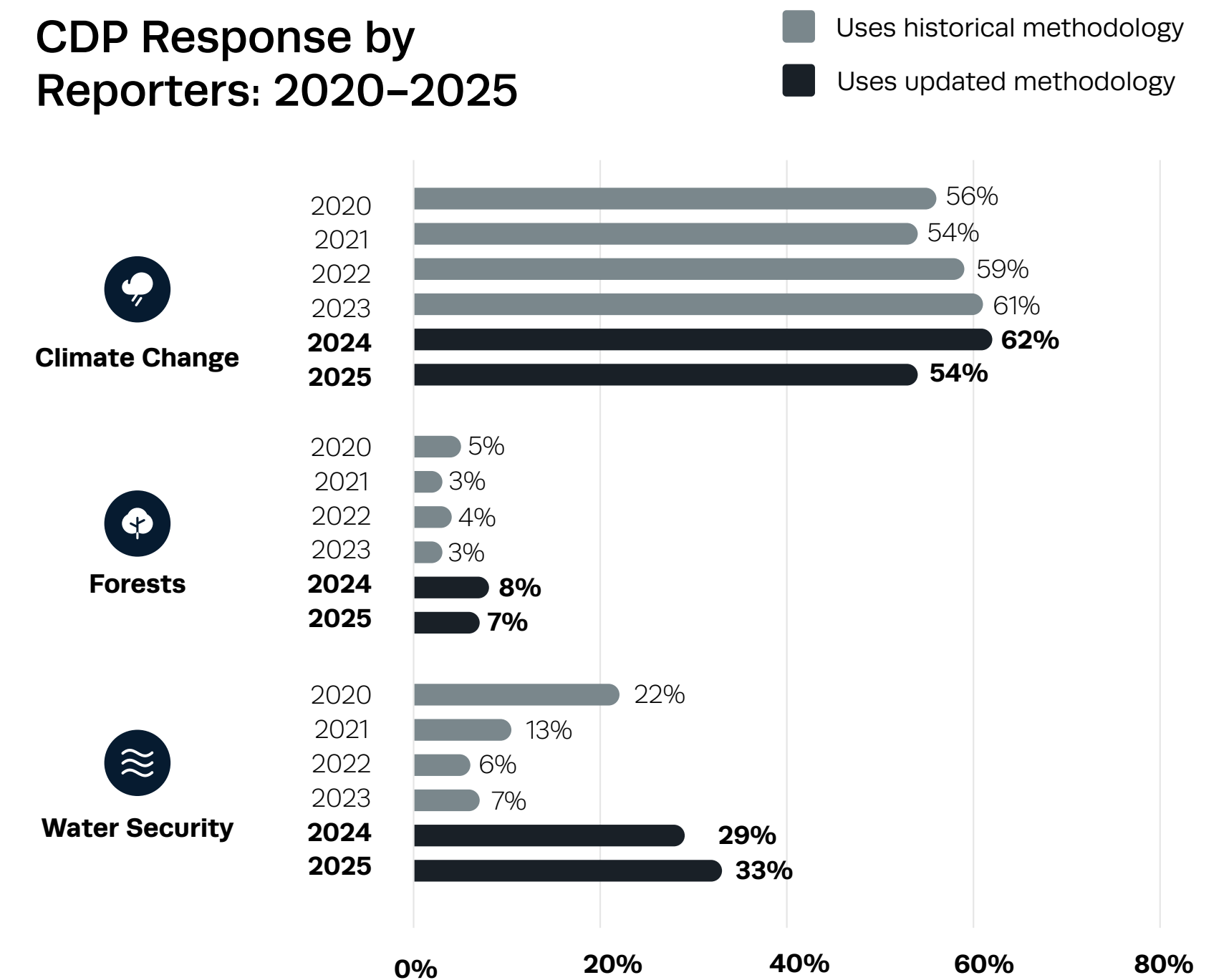
Want to learn more about the  
evolution and benefits of CDP?

Explore →

### CDP Climate Change Responders: 2025



### CDP Response by Reporters: 2020–2025





**15** YEARS  
Sustainability  
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## CDP Response by Reporters: 2020–2025

■ Largest Half of Russell 1000 ■ Smallest Half of Russell 1000

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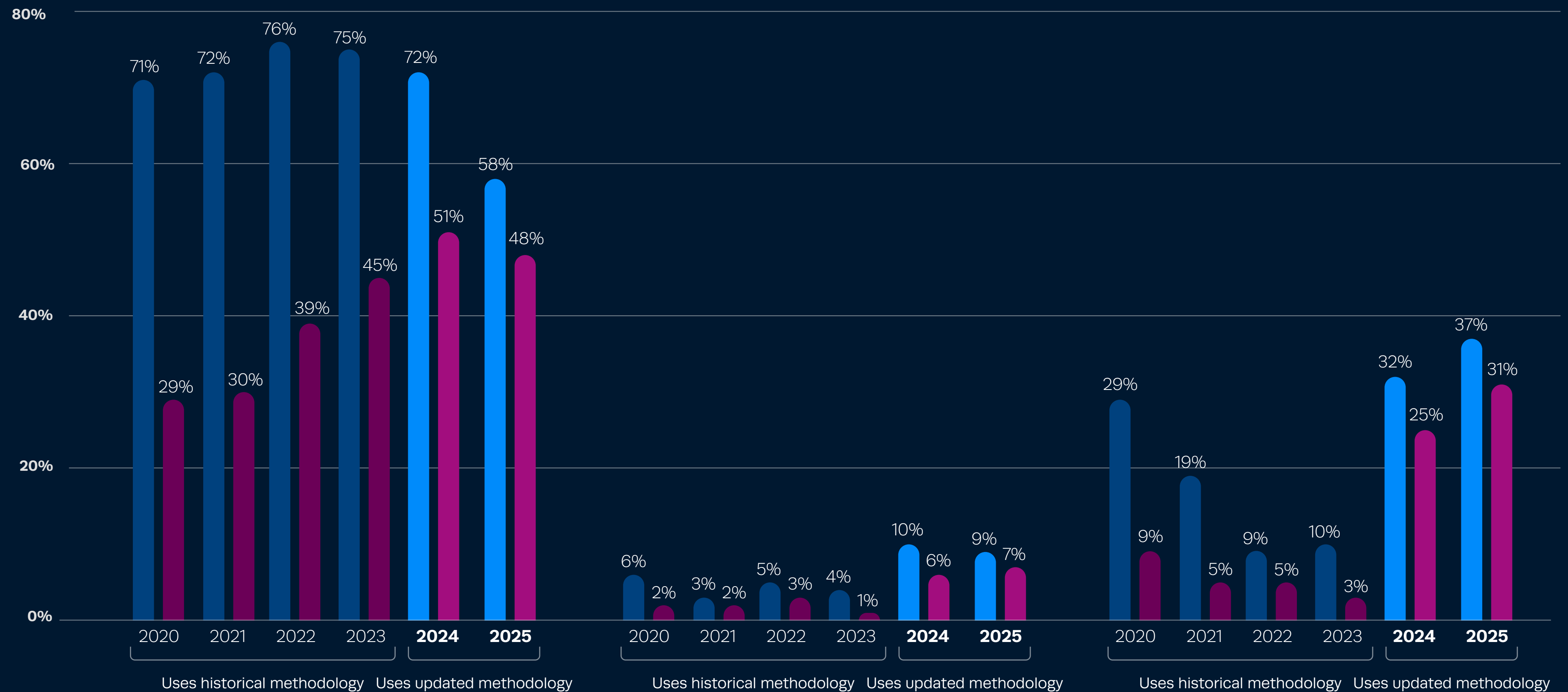
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Climate Change



Forests



Water Security



# Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)

Looking to align your strategies or reporting with the SDGs? G&A can help! [Learn more](#)

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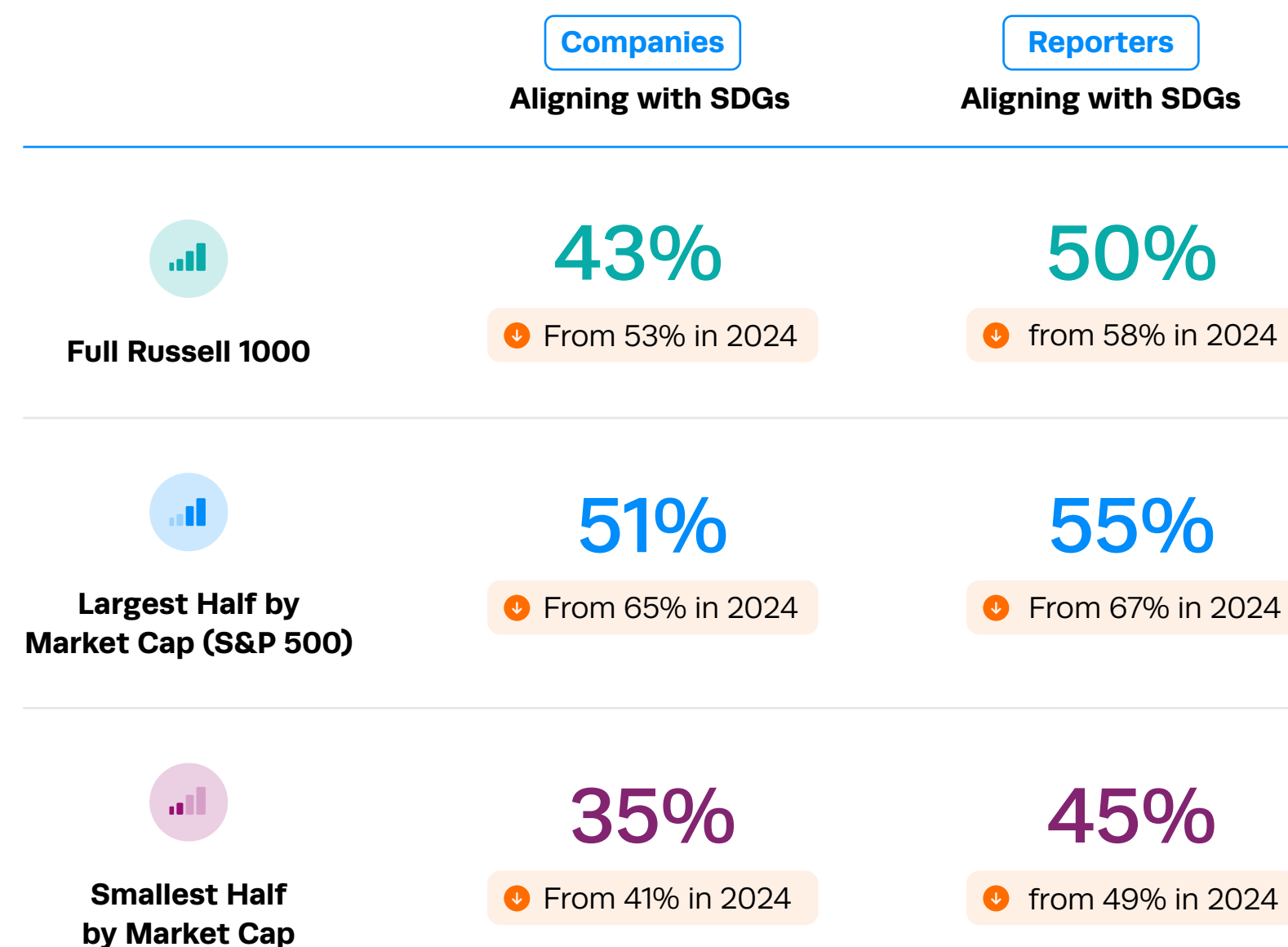
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Many Russell 1000 reporters use the SDGs to indicate the social and environmental benefits of their efforts in a globally comparable way. SDG alignments and mentions fell across both halves of the Russell 1000 in 2025 disclosures, leading to a total drop of eight percentage points from the 2024 level.

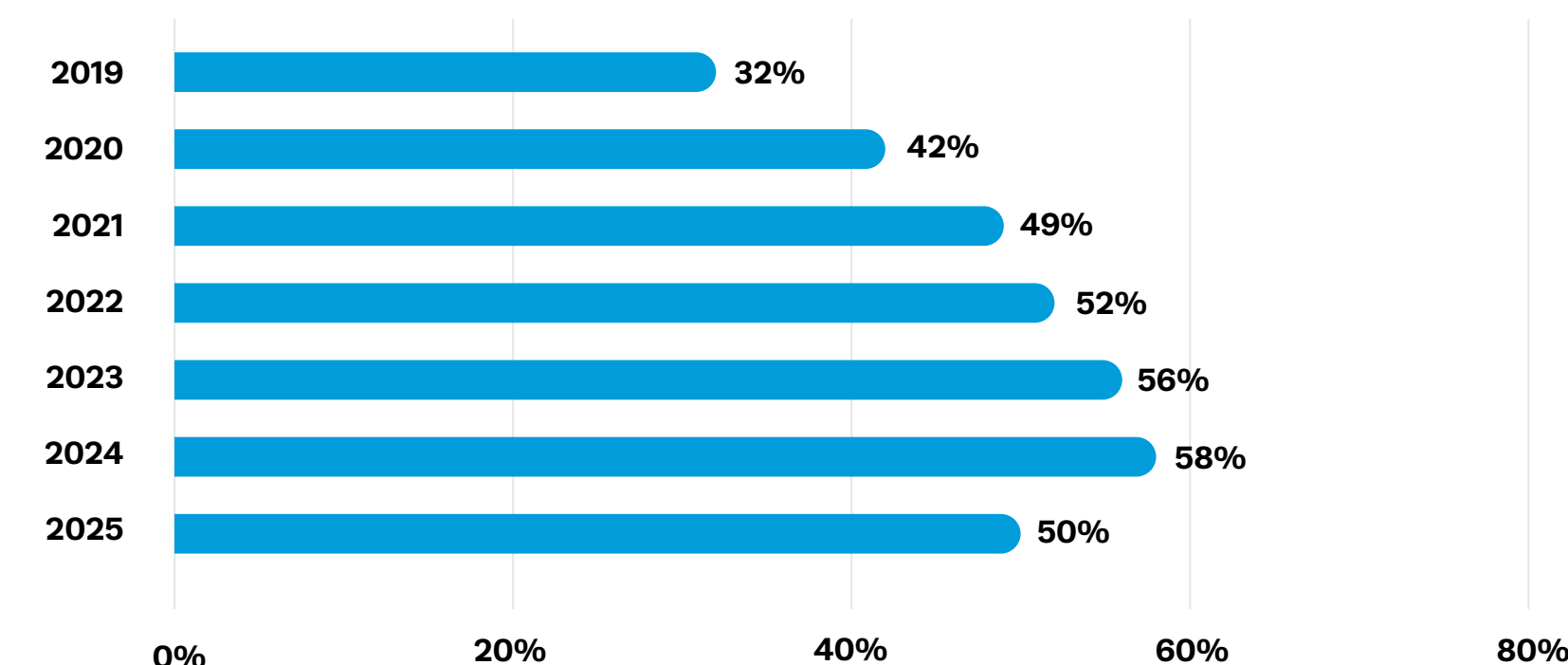
Want to learn more about the evolution and benefits of the SDGs?

[Explore now](#) →

### SDG Alignment and Mentions:<sup>11</sup> 2025



### SDG Alignment and Mentions by Reporters:<sup>11</sup> 2019–2025



Reporters decreased their alignment and mentions of the SDGs for the first time in our research.





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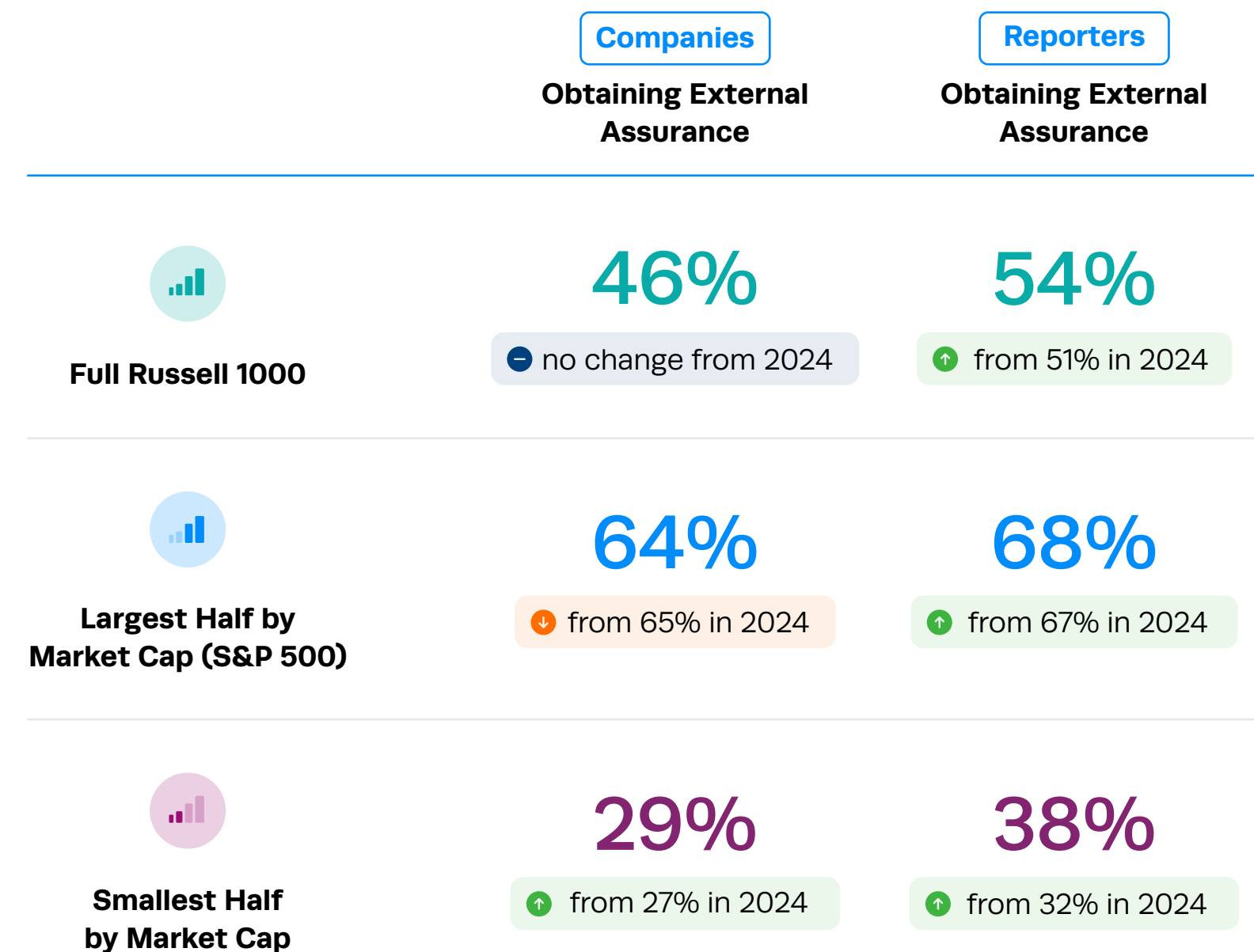
# External Assurance

Approaches to external assurance vary for each reporter based on provider type, scope of assurance, and level of assurance. This section presents the details of assurance obtained by reporters.

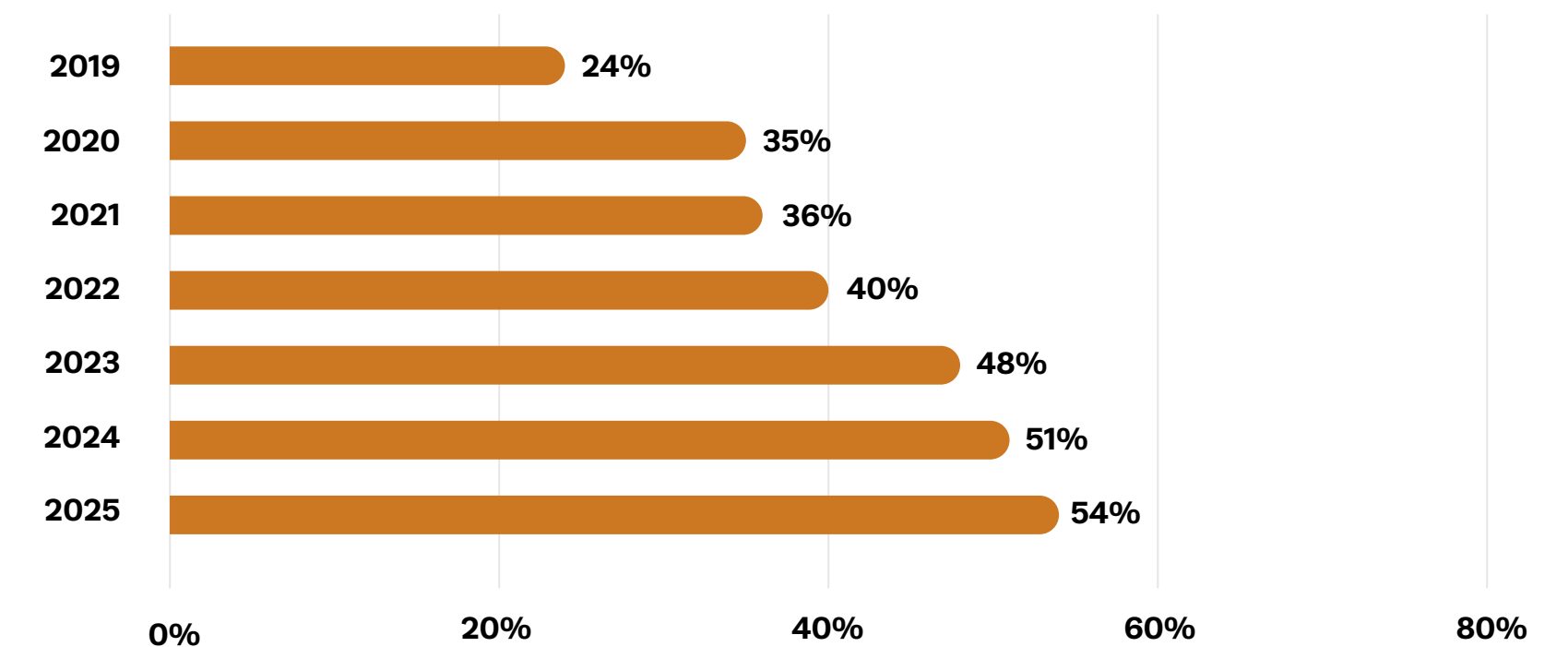
Want to learn more about the evolution and benefits of external assurance?

[Explore now](#) →

## External Assurance Obtained:<sup>12</sup> 2025



## External Assurance Obtained by Reporters:<sup>12</sup> 2019–2025



The percentage of reporters obtaining external assurance continued to increase in 2025.

# Assurance Scope, Level, and Provider Details Among Reporters

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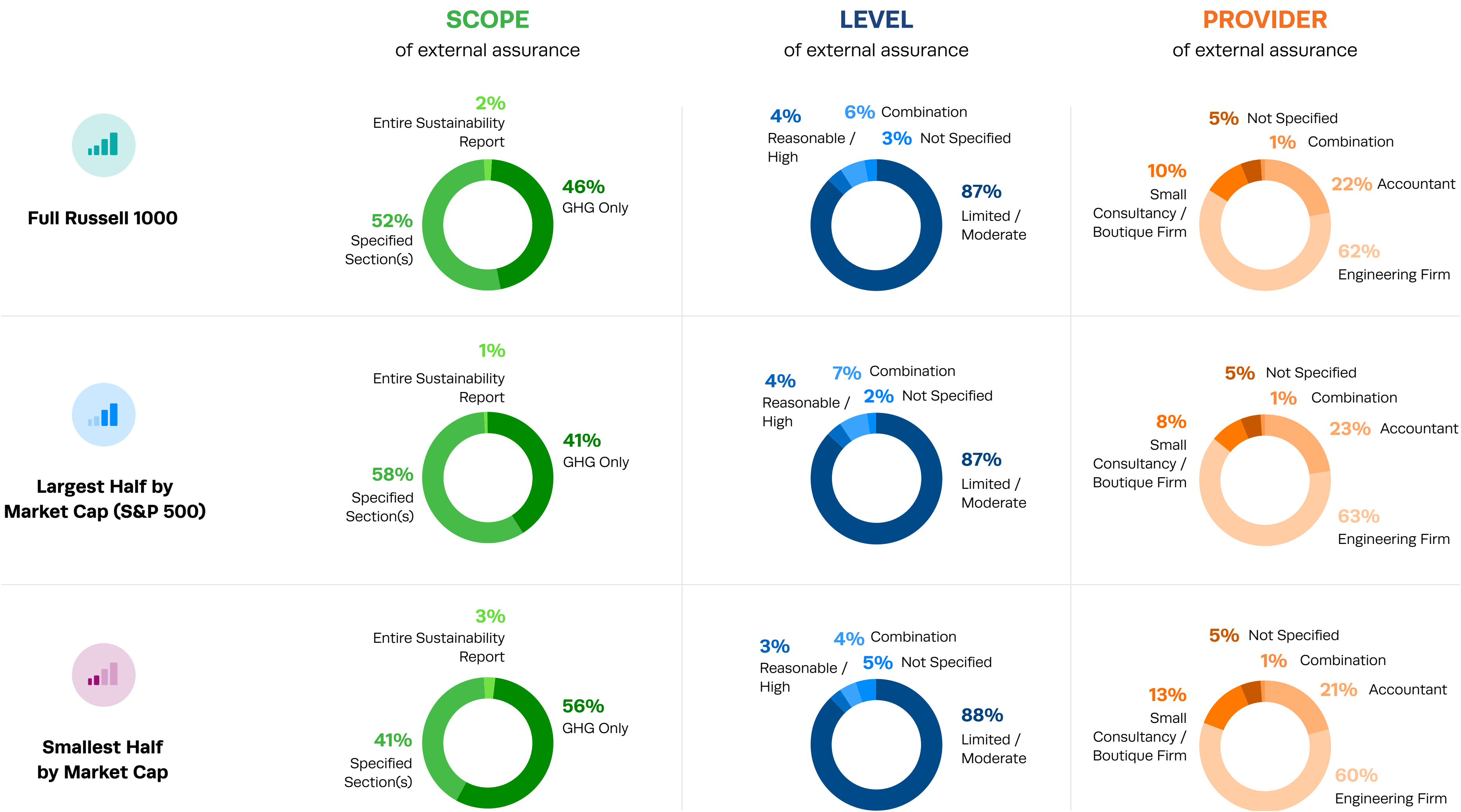
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# Trends by Sector

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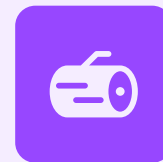
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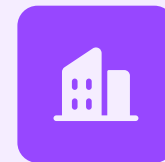
The Russell 1000 Index includes companies from every GICS sector.<sup>13</sup> We have examined the reporting practices of each sector to facilitate comparison among sectors. Looking at trends over time, we have found greater shifts in some sectors' practices than in others, as detailed on the following pages.<sup>14</sup>

### Sectors with Strongest Framework Alignment 2025<sup>15</sup>

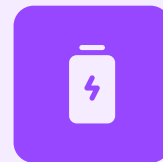
#### Greatest Alignment with GRI



Materials



Real Estate



Energy

#### Greatest Alignment with TCFD



Energy



Materials



Real Estate

#### Greatest Alignment with SASB



Utilities



Energy



Materials

### Leading and Lagging: Russell 1000

#### Leading Sectors



Materials



Energy

Materials and Energy were the sectors with the highest levels of reporting. Each saw a 2% decrease in the share of companies reporting since 2024.

#### Lagging Sector



**36%**

non-reporters in the  
Communications sector

↑ Non-reporters up from 21% in 2024

The sectors that dropped below 100% reporting between 2024 and 2025 are: Materials and Utilities.

### Leading and Lagging: S&P 500

**100%**

reporting in two sectors



Materials



Real Estate

**From Five to Two:** Within the S&P 500, two of 11 sectors achieved 100% reporting in 2025. This is a notable change from last year, when five sectors reached 100% reporting.

<sup>13</sup>More information on GICS sector categories is available [here](#).

<sup>14</sup>Unless otherwise noted, the figures in the sector-specific analysis section reflect G&A's updated research approach, outlined in the [Methodology](#) section of this report.

<sup>15</sup>The sectors shown had the highest proportion of companies that aligned with the respective framework, compared to the proportion in other sectors, in 2025.





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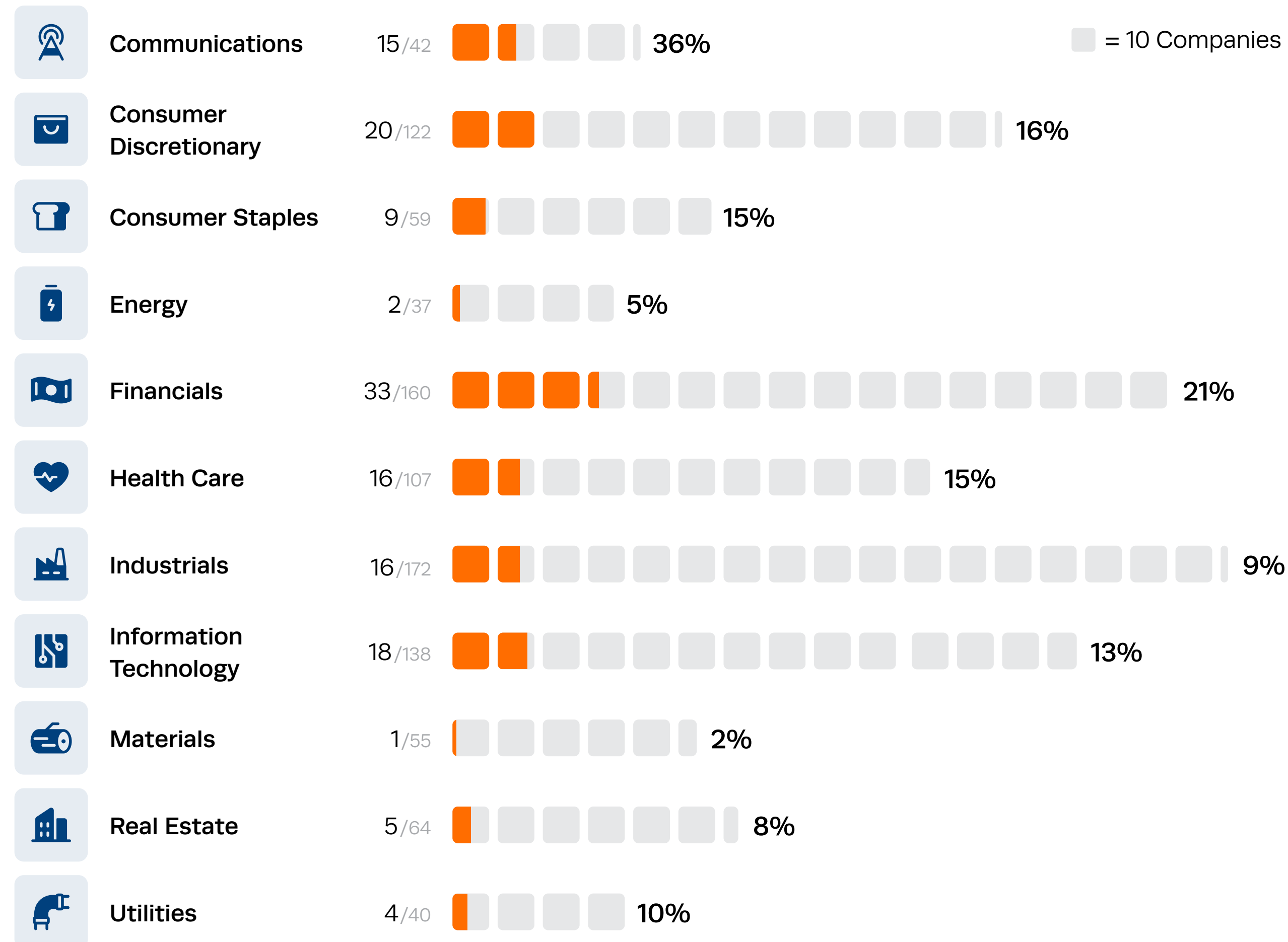
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# Non-Reporters in Russell 1000® Index

We researched the number of companies from each GICS sector that did not publish a sustainability report in 2025, as defined in the [Methodology](#) section. Of the 996 companies in the Russell 1000 Index, Communications and Financials had the highest share of non-reporters in 2025.



## Non-reporters in the Russell 1000

THEN 2018 ..... 2025 NOW

388

Non-reporters

139

Non-reporters

In 2025, the  
Communications and  
Utilities sectors saw the  
**largest percentage-  
point increases in non-  
reporters** since 2024.



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## Trends in Non-Reporters 2020-2025

This page presents the number of companies from each GICS sector that did not publish a sustainability report between the years 2020 and 2025, highlighting increases and decreases in the number of non-reporters by sector.

### Legend

- Increase in Reporting
- Decrease in Reporting
- No Change

|                |                        |                  |        |            |             |             |                        |           |             |           |              |
|----------------|------------------------|------------------|--------|------------|-------------|-------------|------------------------|-----------|-------------|-----------|--------------|
|                |                        |                  |        |            |             |             |                        |           |             |           | <b>TOTAL</b> |
| Communications | Consumer Discretionary | Consumer Staples | Energy | Financials | Health Care | Industrials | Information Technology | Materials | Real Estate | Utilities |              |

| Russell 1000 Index                   |    |     |    |    |     |     |     |     |    |    |    |     |
|--------------------------------------|----|-----|----|----|-----|-----|-----|-----|----|----|----|-----|
| 2020 Non-Reporters                   | 23 | 30  | 7  | 2  | 48  | 54  | 31  | 83  | 7  | 15 | 0  | 300 |
| 2021 Non-Reporters                   | 19 | 24  | 5  | 2  | 21  | 38  | 17  | 53  | 3  | 7  | 0  | 189 |
| 2022 Non-Reporters                   | 17 | 9   | 4  | 0  | 20  | 14  | 11  | 21  | 1  | 4  | 0  | 101 |
| 2023 Non-Reporters                   | 10 | 12  | 6  | 1  | 16  | 12  | 8   | 8   | 0  | 1  | 0  | 74  |
| 2024 Non-Reporters                   | 8  | 13  | 3  | 1  | 23  | 15  | 14  | 9   | 0  | 2  | 0  | 88  |
| 2025 Non-Reporters                   | 15 | 20  | 9  | 2  | 33  | 16  | 16  | 18  | 1  | 5  | 4  | 139 |
| YOY Change in Non-Reporters          | +7 | +7  | +6 | +1 | +10 | +1  | +2  | +9  | +1 | +3 | +4 | +51 |
| Total Companies in Russell 1000      | 42 | 122 | 59 | 37 | 160 | 107 | 172 | 138 | 55 | 64 | 40 | 996 |
| Smallest Half by Market Cap          |    |     |    |    |     |     |     |     |    |    |    |     |
| 2020 Non-Reporters                   | 18 | 22  | 6  | 2  | 44  | 46  | 25  | 75  | 6  | 14 | 0  | 258 |
| 2021 Non-Reporters                   | 16 | 18  | 5  | 1  | 20  | 34  | 15  | 49  | 3  | 7  | 0  | 168 |
| 2022 Non-Reporters                   | 14 | 8   | 4  | 0  | 18  | 13  | 11  | 20  | 1  | 3  | 0  | 92  |
| 2023 Non-Reporters                   | 8  | 11  | 5  | 1  | 14  | 11  | 8   | 8   | 0  | 1  | 0  | 67  |
| 2024 Non-Reporters                   | 7  | 12  | 3  | 1  | 20  | 13  | 11  | 8   | 0  | 2  | 0  | 77  |
| 2025 Non-Reporters                   | 12 | 14  | 5  | 1  | 28  | 15  | 15  | 12  | 1  | 5  | 1  | 109 |
| YOY Change in Non-Reporters          | +5 | +2  | +2 | 0  | +8  | +2  | +4  | +4  | +1 | +3 | +1 | +32 |
| Total Companies in Smallest Half     | 23 | 74  | 23 | 15 | 85  | 47  | 92  | 71  | 29 | 33 | 9  | 501 |
| Largest Half by Market Cap (S&P 500) |    |     |    |    |     |     |     |     |    |    |    |     |
| 2020 Non-Reporters                   | 5  | 8   | 1  | 0  | 4   | 8   | 6   | 8   | 1  | 1  | 0  | 42  |
| 2021 Non-Reporters                   | 3  | 6   | 0  | 1  | 1   | 4   | 2   | 4   | 0  | 0  | 0  | 21  |
| 2022 Non-Reporters                   | 3  | 1   | 0  | 0  | 2   | 1   | 0   | 1   | 0  | 1  | 0  | 9   |
| 2023 Non-Reporters                   | 2  | 1   | 1  | 0  | 2   | 1   | 0   | 0   | 0  | 0  | 0  | 7   |
| 2024 Non-Reporters                   | 1  | 1   | 0  | 0  | 3   | 2   | 3   | 1   | 0  | 0  | 0  | 11  |
| 2025 Non-Reporters                   | 3  | 6   | 4  | 1  | 5   | 1   | 1   | 6   | 0  | 0  | 3  | 30  |
| YOY Change in Non-Reporters          | +2 | +5  | +4 | +1 | +2  | -1  | -2  | +5  | 0  | 0  | +3 | +19 |
| Total Companies in S&P 500           | 19 | 48  | 36 | 22 | 75  | 60  | 80  | 67  | 26 | 31 | 31 | 495 |



**Data Consideration:** The total number of companies in a given sector is subject to increase or decrease year-over-year as companies are removed or added to the Russell 1000 Index.

# SDG Alignment by Sector

This page presents the sectors with the highest number of companies that reported in alignment with specific SDGs in 2025.<sup>16</sup> We also indicate the individual SDGs that were most commonly referenced in each sector's reports.

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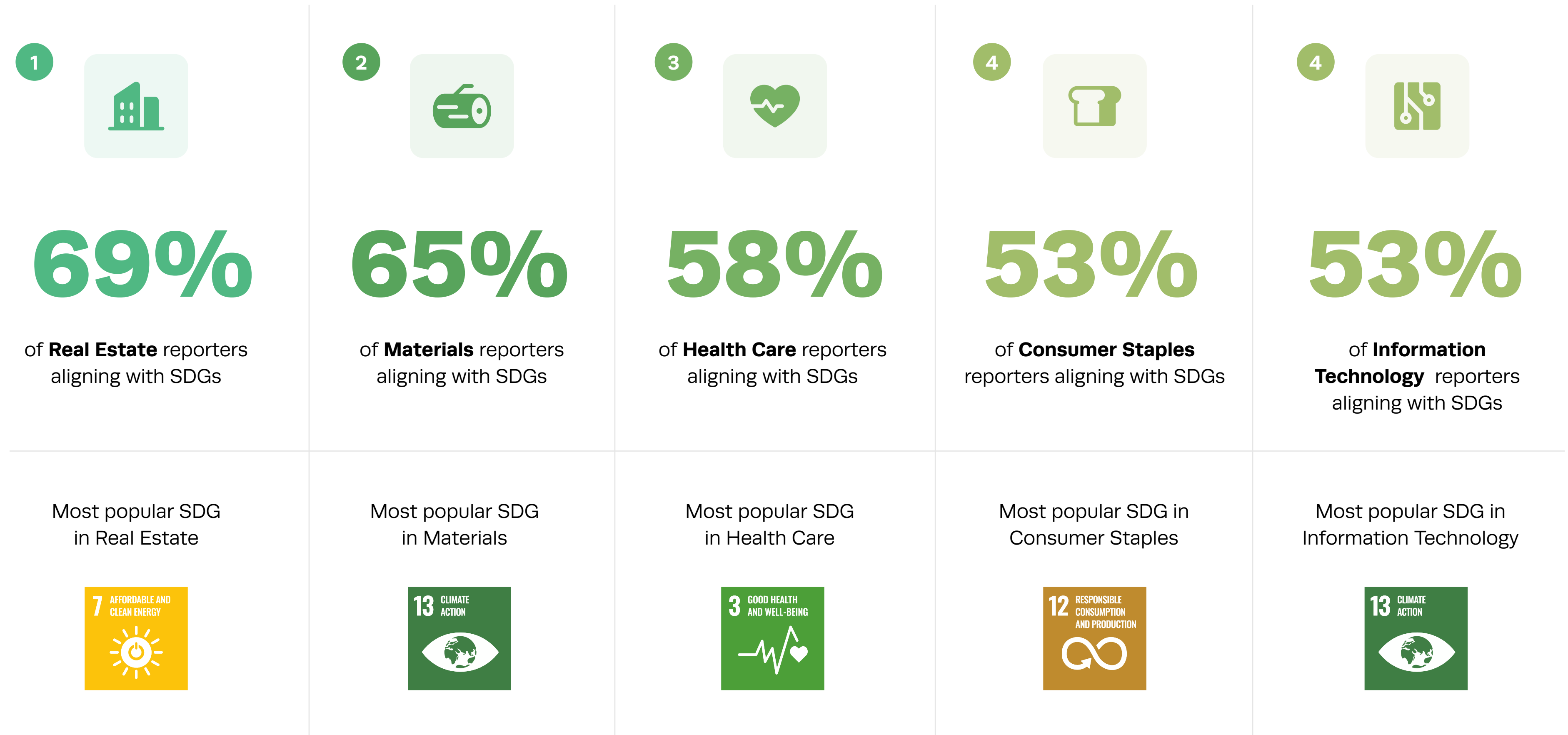
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<sup>16</sup>SDG data was not calculated using our updated methodology, but rather reflects companies' most recent disclosures (whether 2025 or 2024).





## SDG Alignment by Sector

Read this heatmap from top to bottom for each sector to determine the SDGs that are reported most frequently in each sector.<sup>17</sup> For example, companies in the Communications sector mentioned SDG 5 (Gender Equality) and SDG 13 (Climate Action) more than other SDGs. The total percentage of reporters in each sector aligning with SDGs is shown along the bottom. For example, 21% of reporters in the Communications sector aligned with an SDG.

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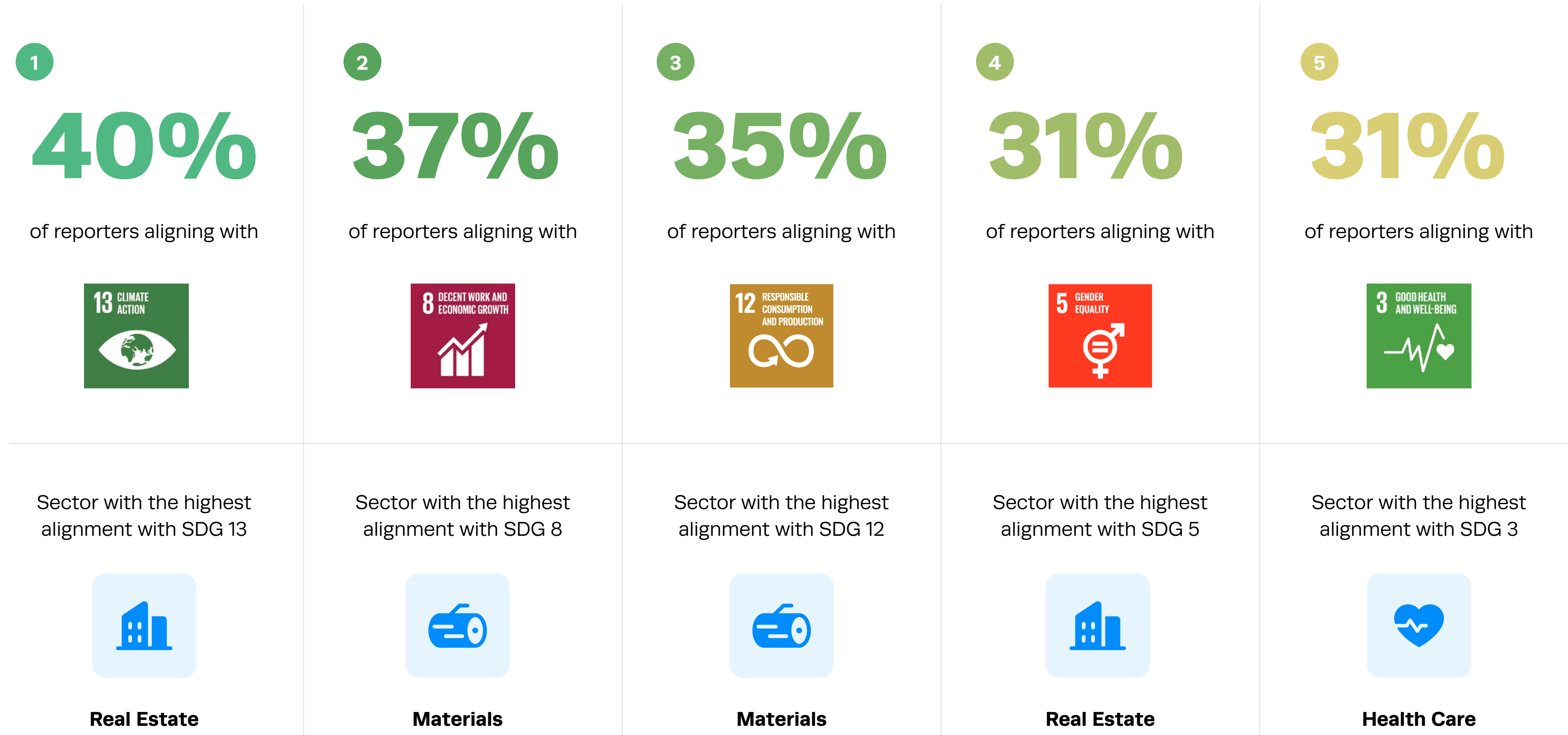
|       |                                        |  Communications |  Consumer Discretionary |  Consumer Staples |  Energy |  Financials |  Health Care |  Industrials |  Information Technology |  Materials |  Real Estate |  Utilities |
|-------|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1     | No Poverty                             | 0%                                                                                                 | 8%                                                                                                         | 13%                                                                                                  | 17%                                                                                        | 17%                                                                                            | 8%                                                                                              | 8%                                                                                              | 11%                                                                                                        | 13%                                                                                           | 5%                                                                                              | 5%                                                                                            |
| 2     | Zero Hunger                            | 6%                                                                                                 | 8%                                                                                                         | 35%                                                                                                  | 11%                                                                                        | 12%                                                                                            | 8%                                                                                              | 10%                                                                                             | 7%                                                                                                         | 24%                                                                                           | 0%                                                                                              | 5%                                                                                            |
| 3     | Good Health and Well-Being             | 15%                                                                                                | 24%                                                                                                        | 36%                                                                                                  | 25%                                                                                        | 17%                                                                                            | 56%                                                                                             | 30%                                                                                             | 25%                                                                                                        | 49%                                                                                           | 48%                                                                                             | 21%                                                                                           |
| 4     | Quality Education                      | 12%                                                                                                | 20%                                                                                                        | 24%                                                                                                  | 19%                                                                                        | 17%                                                                                            | 28%                                                                                             | 26%                                                                                             | 28%                                                                                                        | 27%                                                                                           | 16%                                                                                             | 13%                                                                                           |
| 5     | Gender Equality                        | 18%                                                                                                | 27%                                                                                                        | 33%                                                                                                  | 14%                                                                                        | 23%                                                                                            | 41%                                                                                             | 29%                                                                                             | 36%                                                                                                        | 38%                                                                                           | 48%                                                                                             | 21%                                                                                           |
| 6     | Clean Water & Sanitation               | 3%                                                                                                 | 20%                                                                                                        | 42%                                                                                                  | 22%                                                                                        | 10%                                                                                            | 19%                                                                                             | 18%                                                                                             | 20%                                                                                                        | 51%                                                                                           | 36%                                                                                             | 26%                                                                                           |
| 7     | Affordable & Clean Energy              | 12%                                                                                                | 25%                                                                                                        | 36%                                                                                                  | 31%                                                                                        | 17%                                                                                            | 20%                                                                                             | 26%                                                                                             | 33%                                                                                                        | 40%                                                                                           | 61%                                                                                             | 49%                                                                                           |
| 8     | Decent Work & Economic Growth          | 12%                                                                                                | 31%                                                                                                        | 44%                                                                                                  | 31%                                                                                        | 29%                                                                                            | 41%                                                                                             | 35%                                                                                             | 44%                                                                                                        | 51%                                                                                           | 49%                                                                                             | 36%                                                                                           |
| 9     | Industry, Innovation & Infrastructure  | 6%                                                                                                 | 13%                                                                                                        | 18%                                                                                                  | 28%                                                                                        | 18%                                                                                            | 28%                                                                                             | 31%                                                                                             | 37%                                                                                                        | 36%                                                                                           | 39%                                                                                             | 41%                                                                                           |
| 10    | Reduced Inequalities                   | 15%                                                                                                | 24%                                                                                                        | 31%                                                                                                  | 14%                                                                                        | 24%                                                                                            | 32%                                                                                             | 25%                                                                                             | 29%                                                                                                        | 35%                                                                                           | 33%                                                                                             | 21%                                                                                           |
| 11    | Sustainable Cities & Communities       | 6%                                                                                                 | 18%                                                                                                        | 15%                                                                                                  | 19%                                                                                        | 19%                                                                                            | 7%                                                                                              | 23%                                                                                             | 20%                                                                                                        | 25%                                                                                           | 56%                                                                                             | 36%                                                                                           |
| 12    | Responsible Consumption & Production   | 12%                                                                                                | 33%                                                                                                        | 47%                                                                                                  | 22%                                                                                        | 19%                                                                                            | 49%                                                                                             | 35%                                                                                             | 37%                                                                                                        | 56%                                                                                           | 43%                                                                                             | 26%                                                                                           |
| 13    | Climate Action                         | 18%                                                                                                | 35%                                                                                                        | 45%                                                                                                  | 25%                                                                                        | 28%                                                                                            | 46%                                                                                             | 35%                                                                                             | 46%                                                                                                        | 58%                                                                                           | 59%                                                                                             | 44%                                                                                           |
| 14    | Life Below Water                       | 3%                                                                                                 | 13%                                                                                                        | 24%                                                                                                  | 11%                                                                                        | 6%                                                                                             | 9%                                                                                              | 8%                                                                                              | 5%                                                                                                         | 24%                                                                                           | 3%                                                                                              | 15%                                                                                           |
| 15    | Life on Land                           | 9%                                                                                                 | 18%                                                                                                        | 36%                                                                                                  | 19%                                                                                        | 7%                                                                                             | 11%                                                                                             | 12%                                                                                             | 9%                                                                                                         | 44%                                                                                           | 11%                                                                                             | 26%                                                                                           |
| 16    | Peace, Justice and Strong Institutions | 12%                                                                                                | 12%                                                                                                        | 16%                                                                                                  | 17%                                                                                        | 16%                                                                                            | 18%                                                                                             | 17%                                                                                             | 26%                                                                                                        | 25%                                                                                           | 13%                                                                                             | 10%                                                                                           |
| 17    | Partnerships for the Goals             | 6%                                                                                                 | 13%                                                                                                        | 22%                                                                                                  | 19%                                                                                        | 12%                                                                                            | 24%                                                                                             | 14%                                                                                             | 20%                                                                                                        | 25%                                                                                           | 8%                                                                                              | 8%                                                                                            |
| TOTAL |                                        | 21%                                                                                                | 38%                                                                                                        | 53%                                                                                                  | 31%                                                                                        | 35%                                                                                            | 58%                                                                                             | 43%                                                                                             | 53%                                                                                                        | 65%                                                                                           | 69%                                                                                             | 51%                                                                                           |

Read from top to bottom

<sup>17</sup>SDG data was not calculated using our updated methodology, but rather reflects companies' most recent disclosures (whether 2025 or 2024).

# Sector Reporting by SDG

We research the specific SDGs with which reporters aligned, and how SDG alignment differs by business sector. For the second year in a row, SDG 13 (Climate Action) was the most frequently mentioned SDG among Russell 1000 reporters' disclosures, followed by SDG 8 (Decent Work and Economic Growth), and SDG 12 (Responsible Consumption and Production).<sup>18</sup>



<sup>18</sup>SDG data was not calculated using our updated methodology, but rather reflects companies' most recent disclosures (whether 2025 or 2024).

## Sector Reporting by SDG

Read this heatmap from left to right to determine which sectors aligned most frequently with each SDG.<sup>19</sup> For example, alignment with SDG 1 (No Poverty) was most frequent in reports from the Energy and Financial sectors, and 10% of all reporters aligned with SDG 1.

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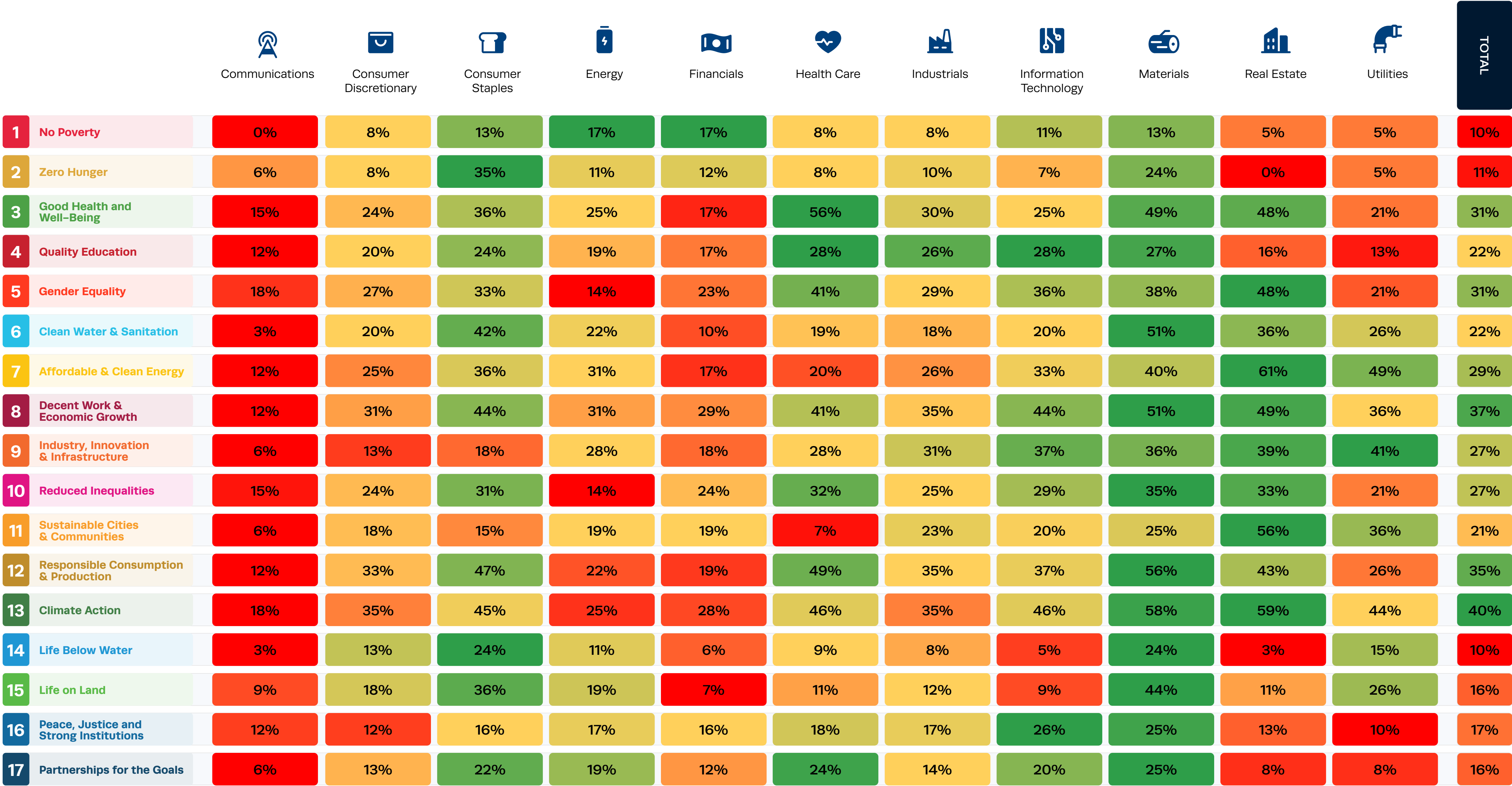
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Read from left to right

<sup>19</sup>SDG data was not calculated using our updated methodology, but rather reflects companies' most recent disclosures (whether 2025 or 2024).





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## Communications

Total Companies in Russell 1000

2024

39

2025

42

### 2025 Key Statistics

15

Non-reporters  
remaining

**+7** from 2024

64%

Reporting **down**  
from 79% in 2024

### Top SDGs

5

Gender Equality

13

Climate Action

SDGs 5 and 13 tied for most mentioned, followed by a six-way tie for second place among SDGs 3, 4, 7, 8, 10, and 12.

### 2025 Assurance Details



of Communications  
**reporters** sought  
external assurance

**+8** percentage points  
from prior year

#### Scope

0%

Sustainability  
Report

53%

GHG Only

47%

Specified  
Section(s)

#### Level

93%

Limited /  
Moderate

0%

Reasonable /  
High

7%

Combination

0%

Not  
Specified

#### Provider

13%

Consulting  
Firm

47%

Accountant

40%

Engineering  
Firm

0%

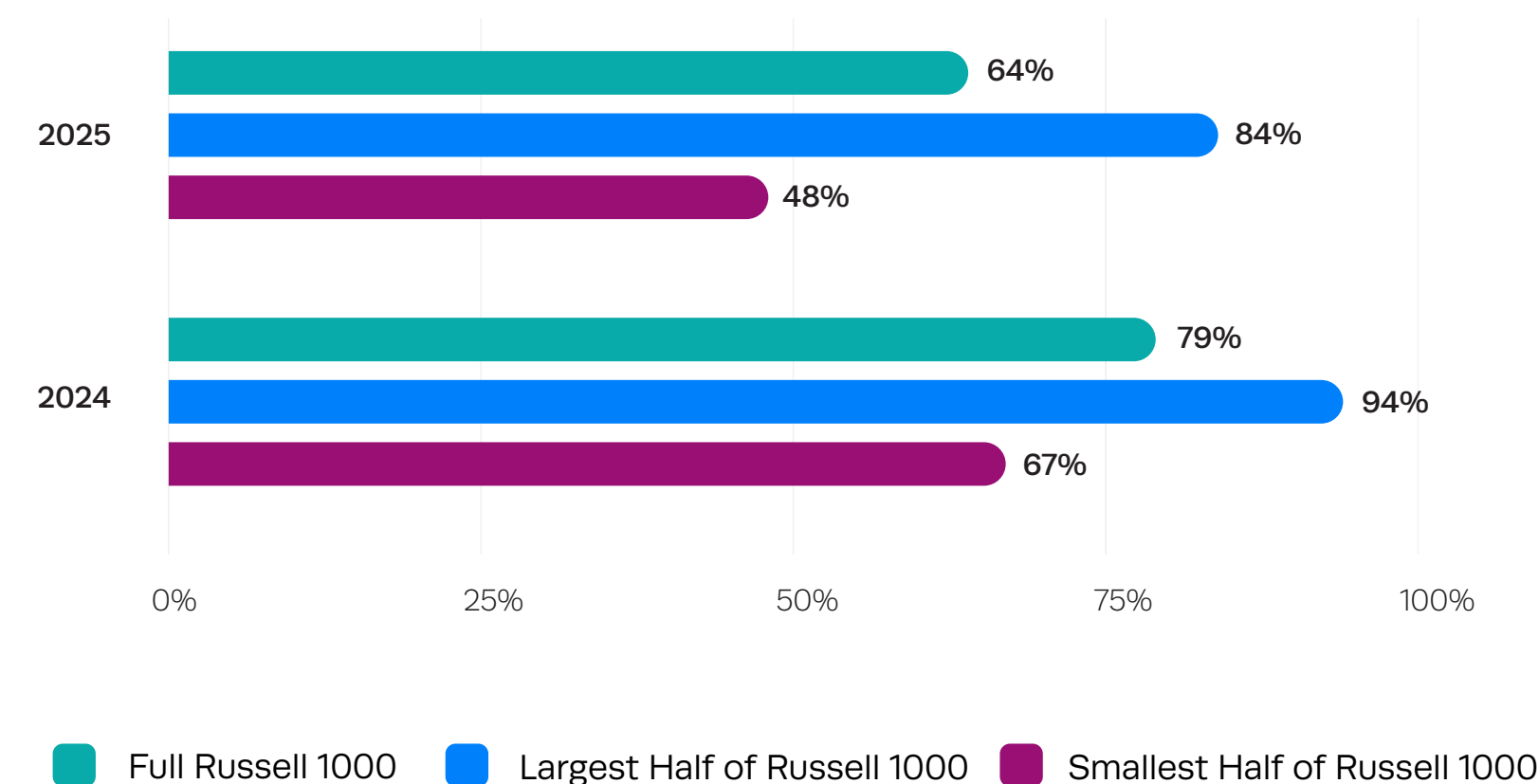
Not  
Specified

0%

Combination

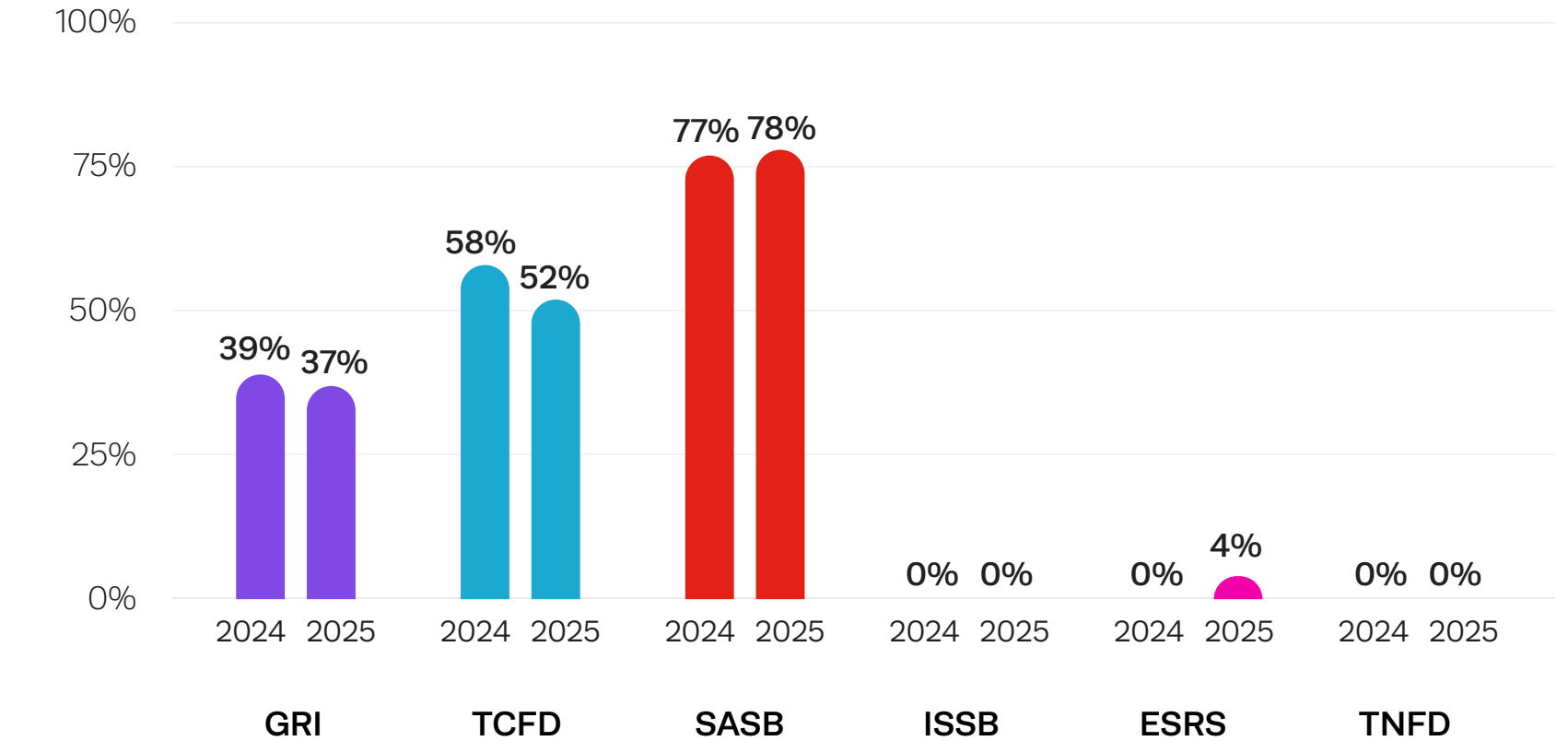
### Reporting Overview: 2-Year Trend

Percentage of Communications Sector Companies Publishing Sustainability Reports



### Frameworks & Standards: 2-Year Trend

Percentage of Communications Sector Reporters Aligning with GRI, TCFD, SASB, ISSB, ESRS, TNFD





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## Consumer Discretionary

Total Companies in Russell 1000

2024

127

2025

122

### 2025 Key Statistics

20

Non-reporters  
remaining

+7 from 2024

84%

Reporting **down**  
from 90% in 2024

### Top SDGs

13

Climate Action

12

Responsible Consumption  
& Production

8

Decent Work &  
Economic Growth

5

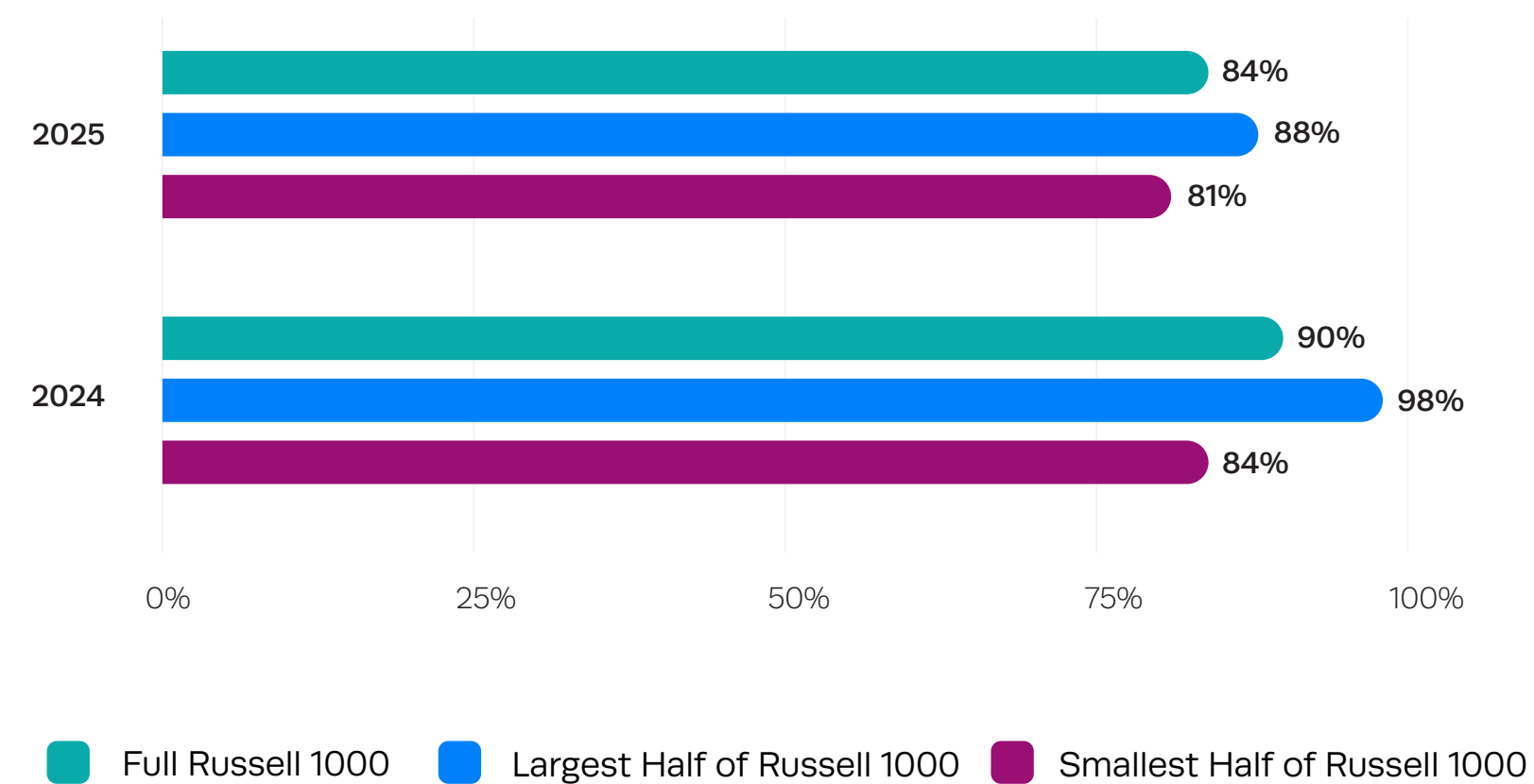
Gender Equality

7

Affordable & Clean Energy

### Reporting Overview: 2-Year Trend

Percentage of Consumer Discretionary Sector Companies Publishing Sustainability Reports



### 2025 Assurance Details



of Consumer  
Discretionary **reporters**  
sought external assurance

+2 percentage points  
from prior year

#### Scope

0%

Sustainability  
Report

41%

GHG Only

59%

Specified  
Section(s)

#### Level

93%

Limited /  
Moderate

0%

Reasonable /  
High

2%

Combination

5%

Not  
Specified

#### Provider

11%

Consulting  
Firm

27%

Accountant

55%

Engineering  
Firm

5%

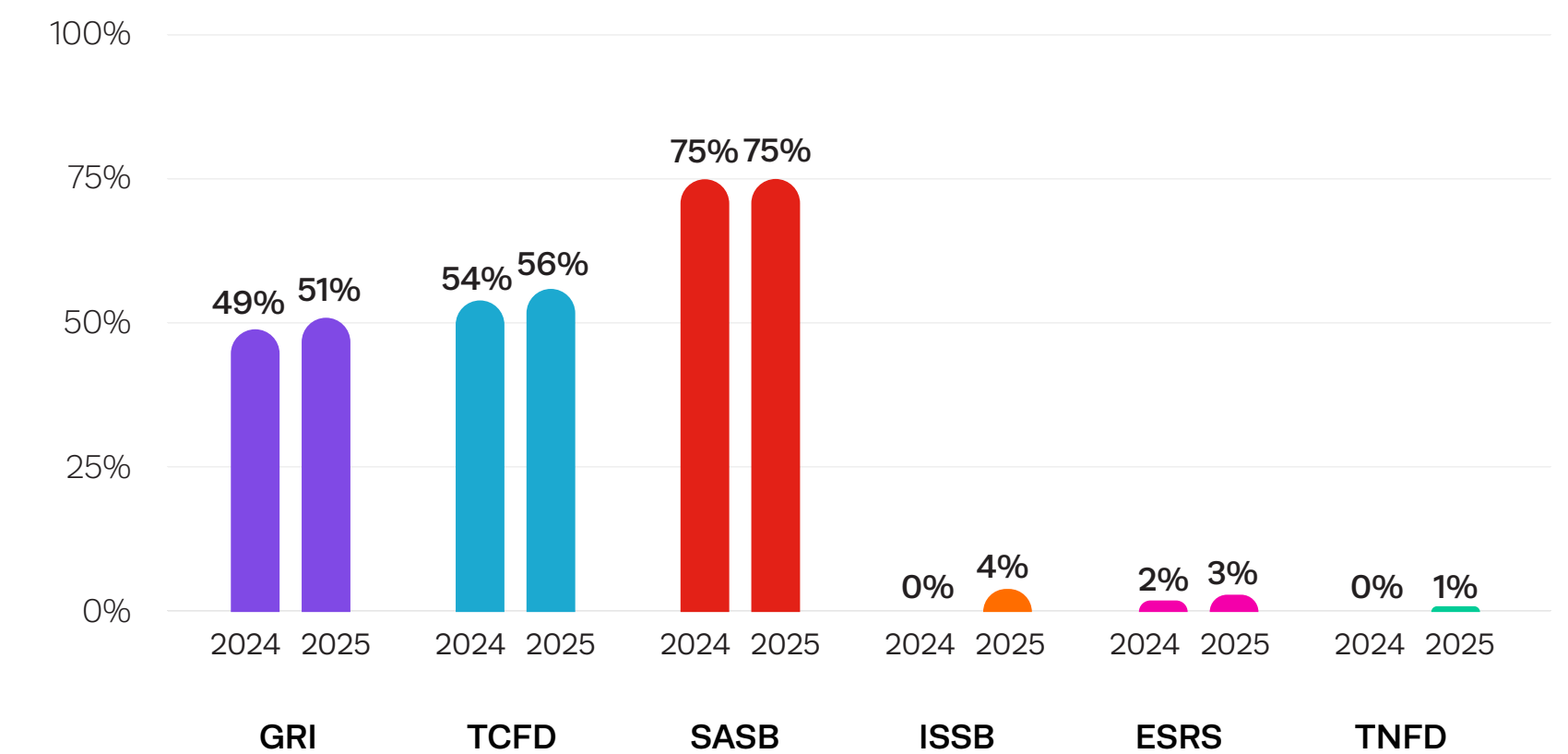
Not  
Specified

2%

Combination

### Frameworks & Standards: 2-Year Trend

Percentage of Consumer Discretionary Sector Reporters Aligning with GRI, TCFD, SASB, ISSB, ESRs, TNFD





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## Consumer Staples

Total Companies in Russell 1000

2024

60

2025

59

### 2025 Key Statistics

9

Non-reporters  
remaining

**+6** from 2024

85%

Reporting **down**  
from 95% in 2024

### Top SDGs

12

Responsible Consumption  
& Production

13

Climate Action

8

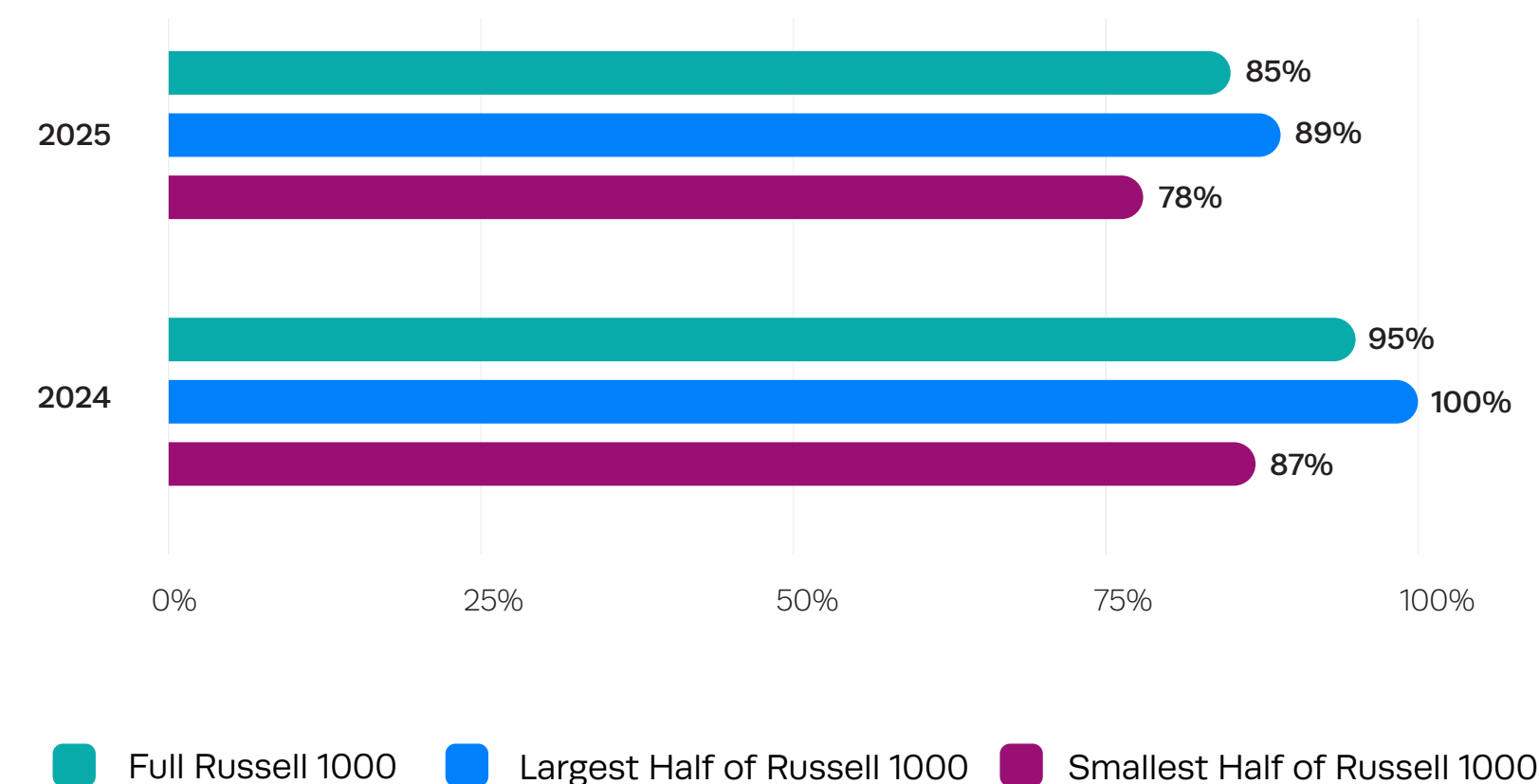
Decent Work &  
Economic Growth

6

Clean Water & Sanitation

### Reporting Overview: 2-Year Trend

Percentage of Consumer Staples Sector Companies Publishing Sustainability Reports



### 2025 Assurance Details



of Consumer Staples  
**reporters** sought  
external assurance

**+3** percentage points  
from prior year

#### Scope

0%

Sustainability  
Report

19%

GHG Only

81%

Specified  
Section(s)

#### Level

93%

Limited /  
Moderate

0%

Reasonable /  
High

7%

Combination

0%

Not  
Specified

#### Provider

7%

Consulting  
Firm

22%

Accountant

63%

Engineering  
Firm

4%

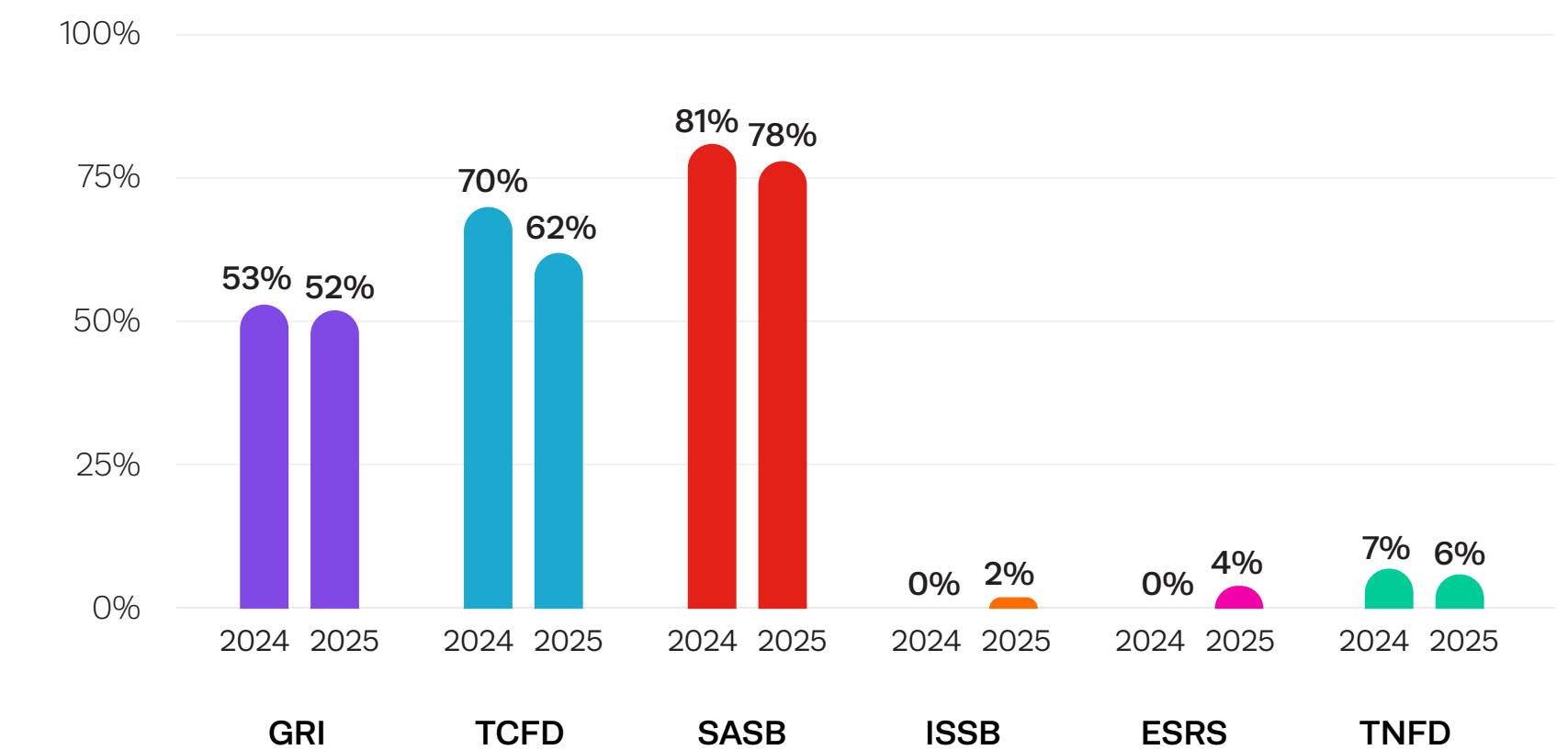
Not  
Specified

4%

Combination

### Frameworks & Standards: 2-Year Trend

Percentage of Consumer Staples Sector Reporters Aligning with GRI, TCFD, SASB, ISSB, ESRS, TNFD







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## Energy

Total Companies in Russell 1000

2024

39

2025

37

### 2025 Key Statistics

2

Non-reporters  
remaining

+1 from 2024

95%

Reporting **down**  
from 97% in 2024

### Top SDGs



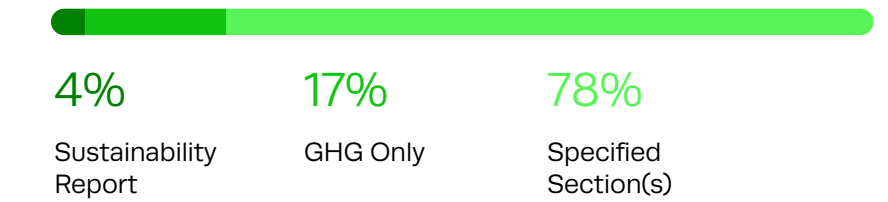
## 2025 Assurance Details



of Energy **reporters**  
sought external assurance

+8 percentage points  
from prior year

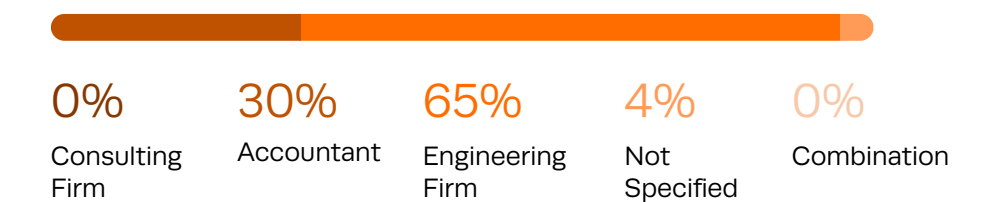
### Scope



### Level

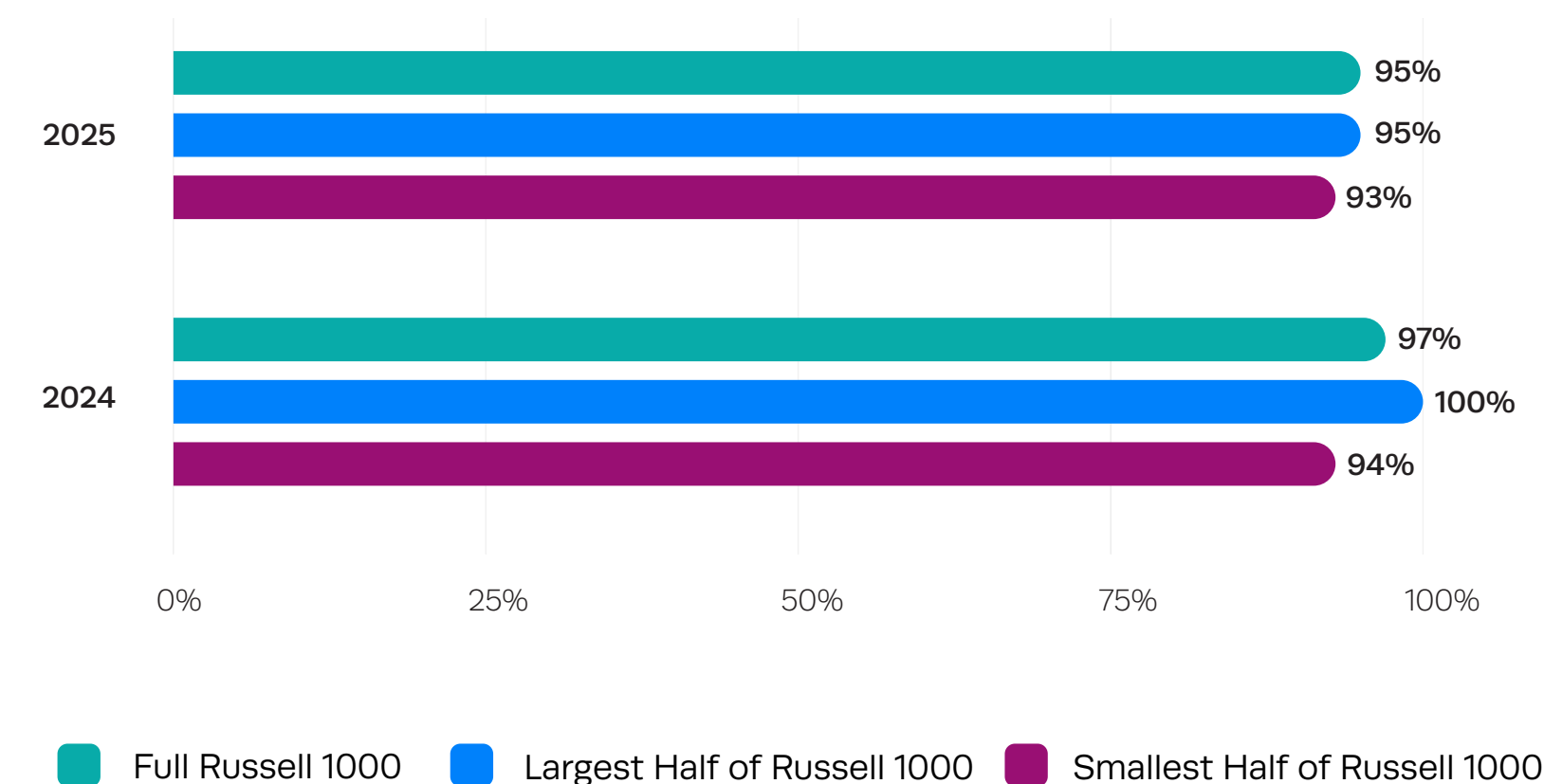


### Provider



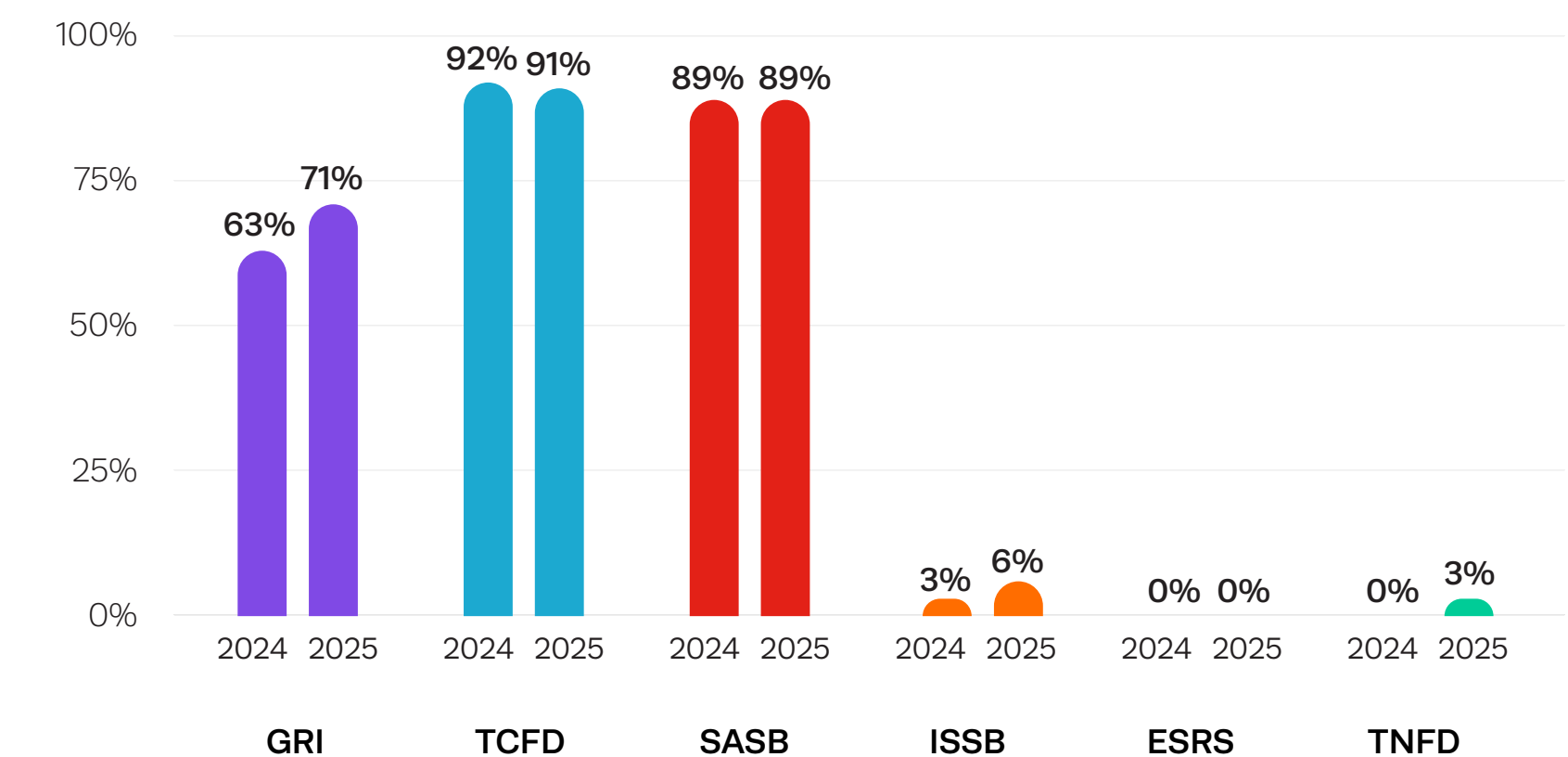
## Reporting Overview: 2-Year Trend

Percentage of Energy Sector Companies Publishing Sustainability Reports



## Frameworks & Standards: 2-Year Trend

Percentage of Energy Sector Reporters Aligning with GRI, TCFD, SASB, ISSB, ESRS, TNFD





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## Financials

Total Companies in Russell 1000

2024

154

2025

160

### 2025 Key Statistics

33

Non-reporters  
remaining

**+10** from 2024

79%

Reporting **down**  
from 85% in 2024

### Top SDGs

**13** Climate Action

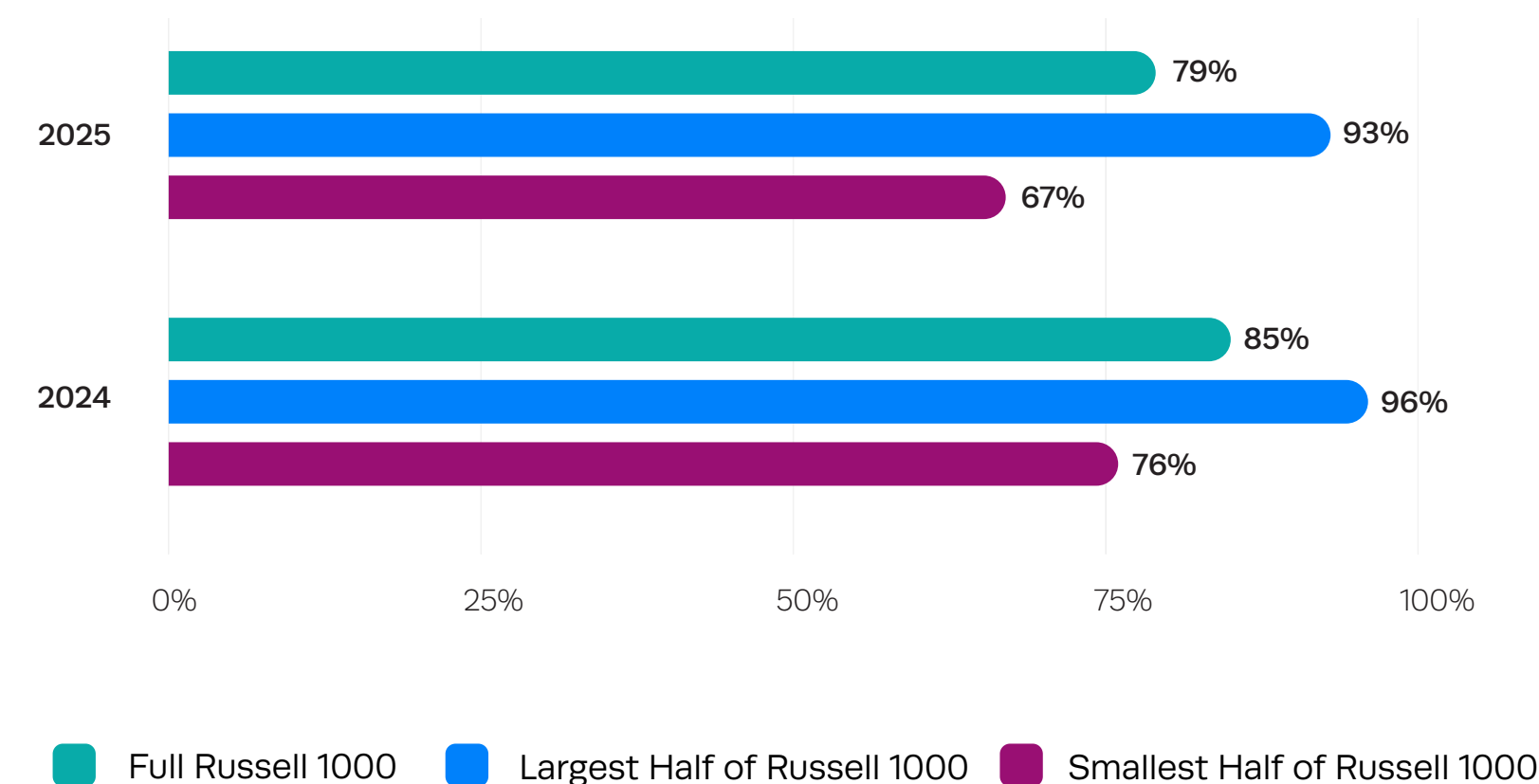
**8** Decent Work &  
Economic Growth

**10** Reduced Inequalities

**5** Gender Equality

### Reporting Overview: 2-Year Trend

Percentage of Financials Sector Companies Publishing Sustainability Reports



### 2025 Assurance Details



of Financials **reporters**  
sought external assurance

**+4** percentage points  
from prior year

#### Scope

0%

Sustainability  
Report

73%

GHG Only

27%

Specified  
Section(s)

#### Level

90%

Limited /  
Moderate

2%

Reasonable /  
High

2%

Combination

6%

Not  
Specified

#### Provider

5%

Consulting  
Firm

37%

Accountant

52%

Engineering  
Firm

6%

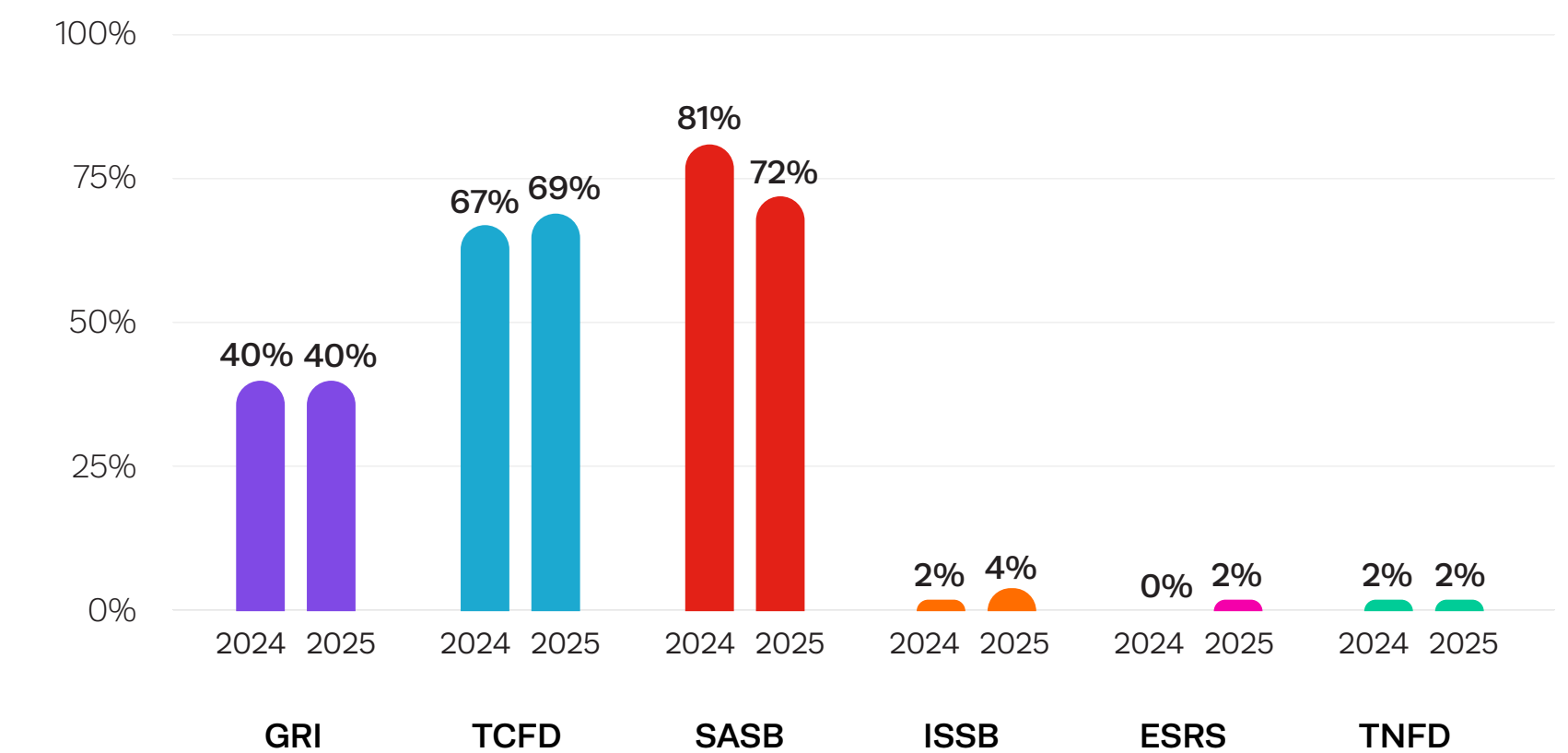
Not  
Specified

0%

Combination

### Frameworks & Standards: 2-Year Trend

Percentage of Financials Sector Reporters Aligning with GRI, TCFD, SASB, ISSB, ESRS, TNFD





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## Health Care

Total Companies in Russell 1000

2024  
109

2025  
107

### 2025 Key Statistics

16

Non-reporters  
remaining

+1 from 2024

85%

Reporting **down**  
from 86% in 2024

### Top SDGs

- 3 Good Health & Well-Being
- 12 Responsible Consumption & Production
- 13 Climate Action
- 8 Decent Work & Economic Growth

## 2025 Assurance Details



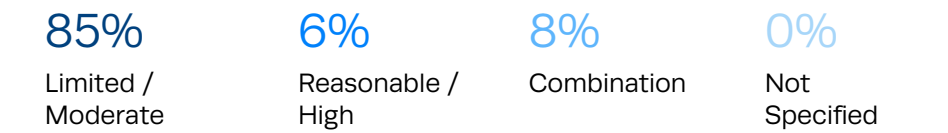
of Health Care **reporters**  
sought external assurance

+4 percentage points  
from prior year

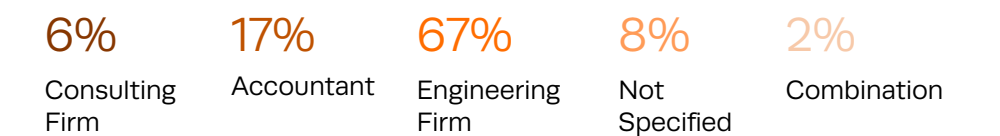
### Scope



### Level

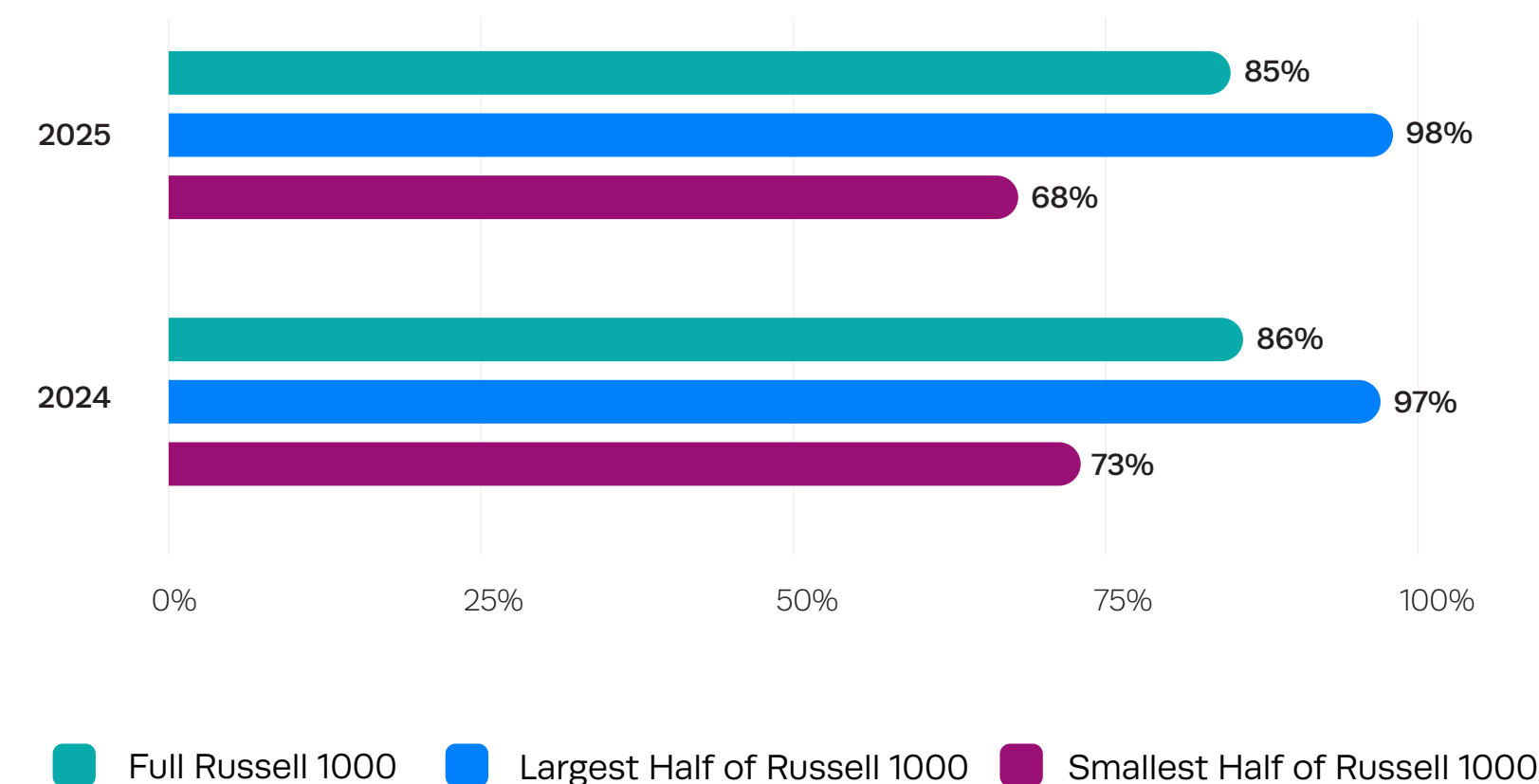


### Provider



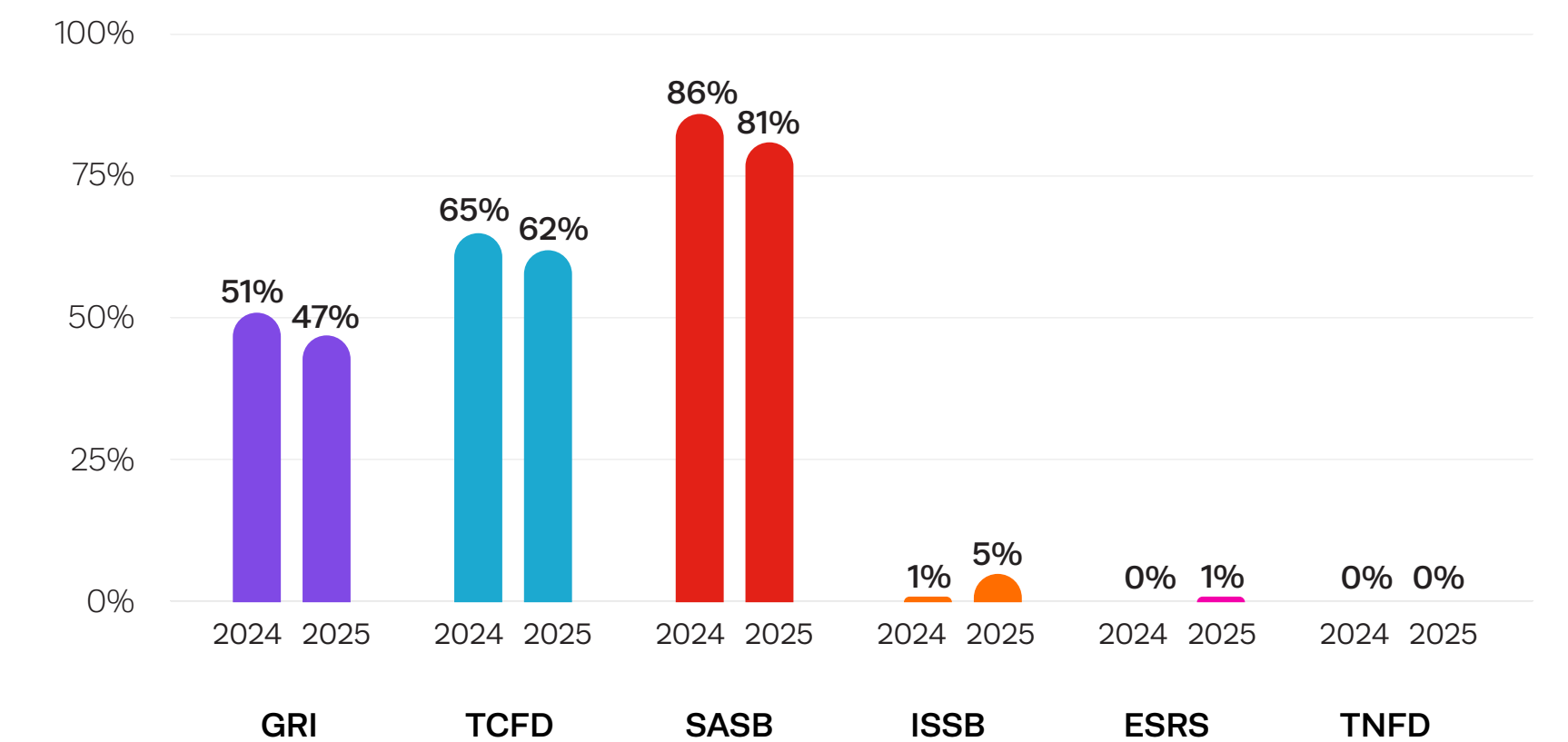
## Reporting Overview: 2-Year Trend

Percentage of Health Care Sector Companies Publishing Sustainability Reports



## Frameworks & Standards: 2-Year Trend

Percentage of Health Care Sector Reporters Aligning with GRI, TCFD, SASB, ISSB, ESRS, TNFD







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## Industrials

Total Companies in Russell 1000

2024

167

2025

172

### 2025 Key Statistics

16

Non-reporters  
remaining

+2 from 2024

91%

Reporting **down**  
from 92% in 2024

### Top SDGs

13 Climate Action

8 Decent Work &  
Economic Growth

12 Responsible Consumption  
& Production

9 Industry, Innovation  
& Infrastructure

### 2025 Assurance Details



of Industrials **reporters**  
sought external assurance

+3 percentage points  
from prior year

#### Scope

4%

Sustainability  
Report

54%

GHG Only

42%

Specified  
Section(s)

#### Level

83%

Limited /  
Moderate

6%

Reasonable /  
High

9%

Combination

1%

Not  
Specified

#### Provider

10%

Consulting  
Firm

13%

Accountant

72%

Engineering  
Firm

5%

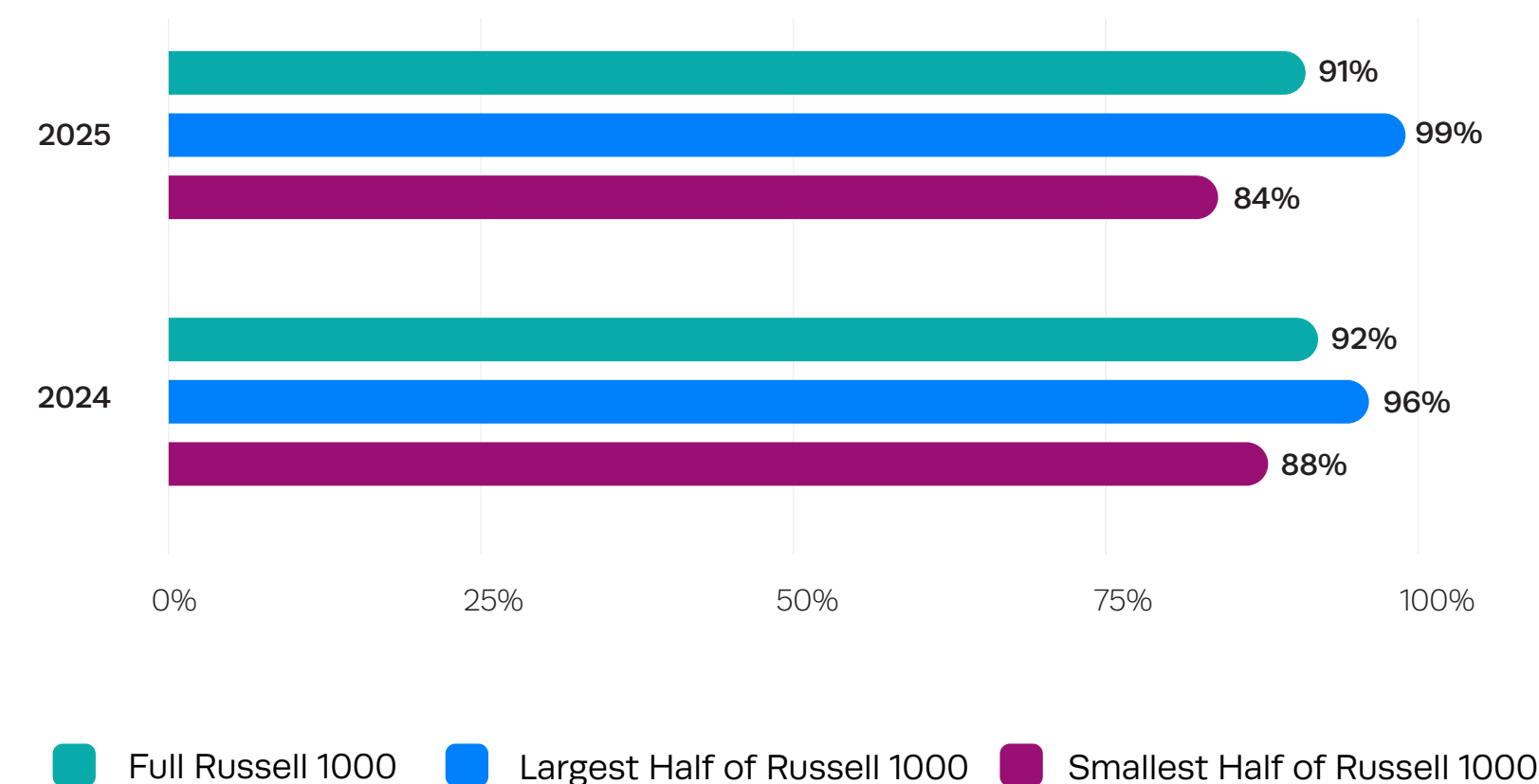
Not  
Specified

0%

Combination

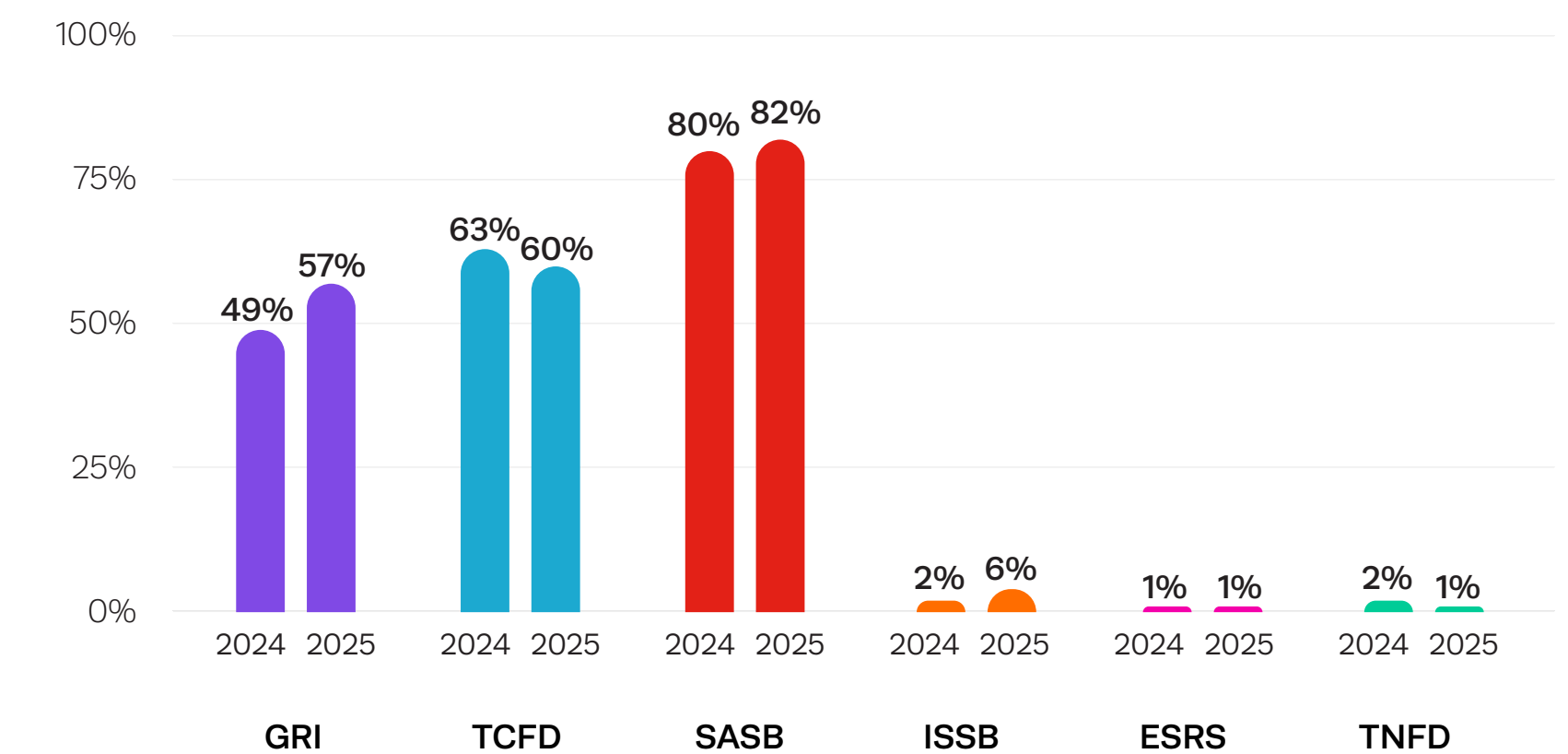
### Reporting Overview: 2-Year Trend

Percentage of Industrials Sector Companies Publishing Sustainability Reports



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## Information Technology

Total Companies in Russell 1000

2024  
138

2025  
138

### 2025 Key Statistics

18

Non-reporters  
remaining

+9 from 2024

87%

Reporting **down**  
from 93% in 2024

### Top SDGs

13 Climate Action

8 Decent Work &  
Economic Growth

12 Responsible Consumption  
& Production

9 Industry, Innovation  
& Infrastructure

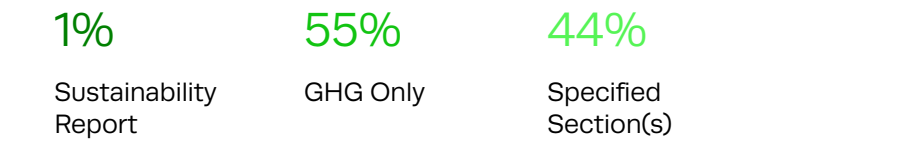
### 2025 Assurance Details



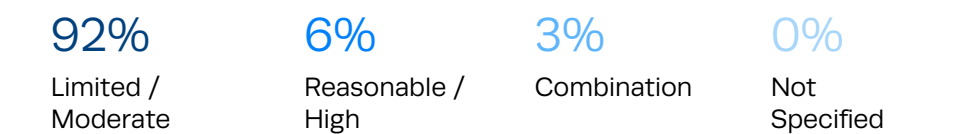
of Information Technology  
**reporters** sought  
external assurance

+3 percentage points  
from prior year

#### Scope



#### Level

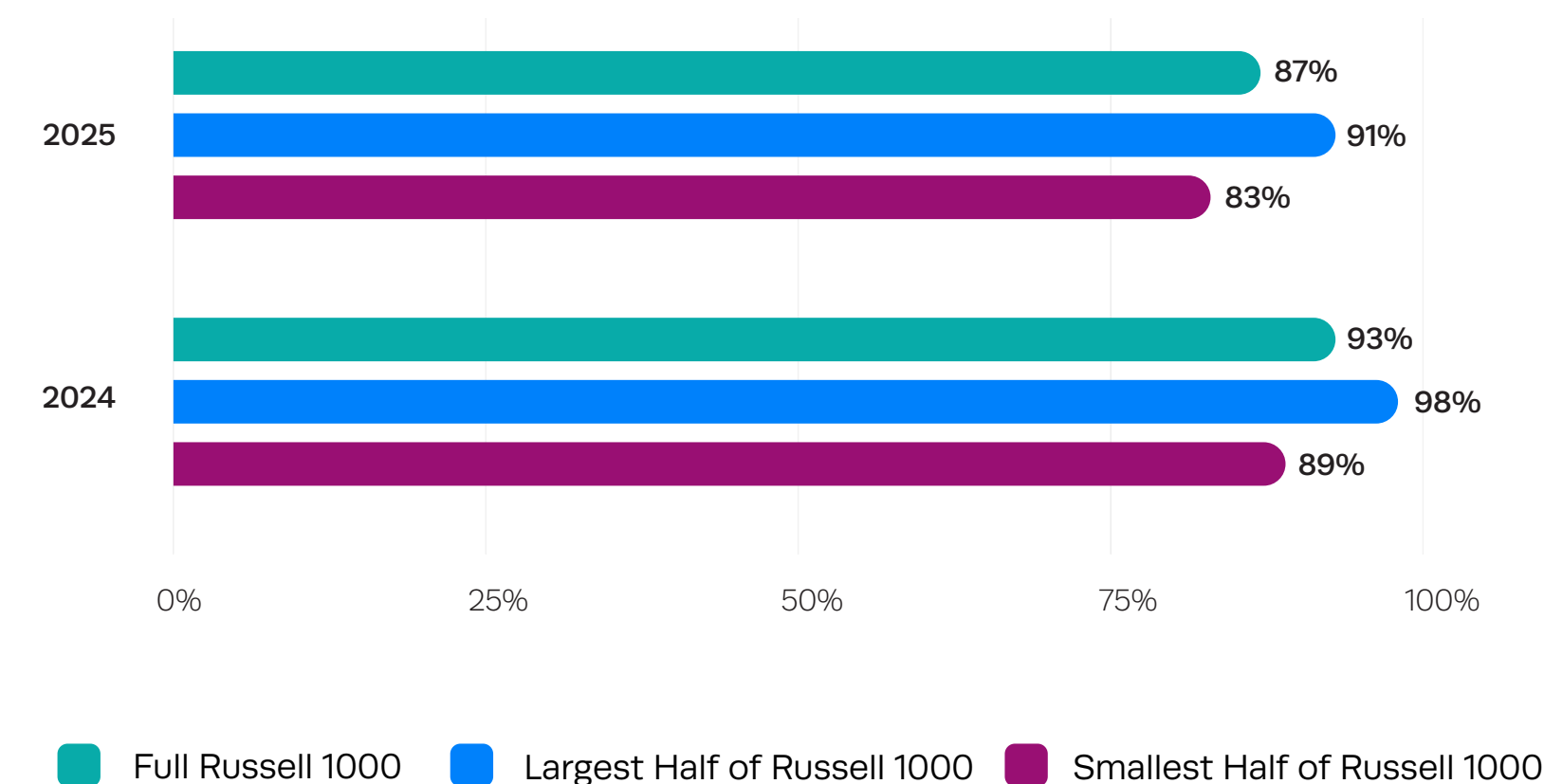


#### Provider



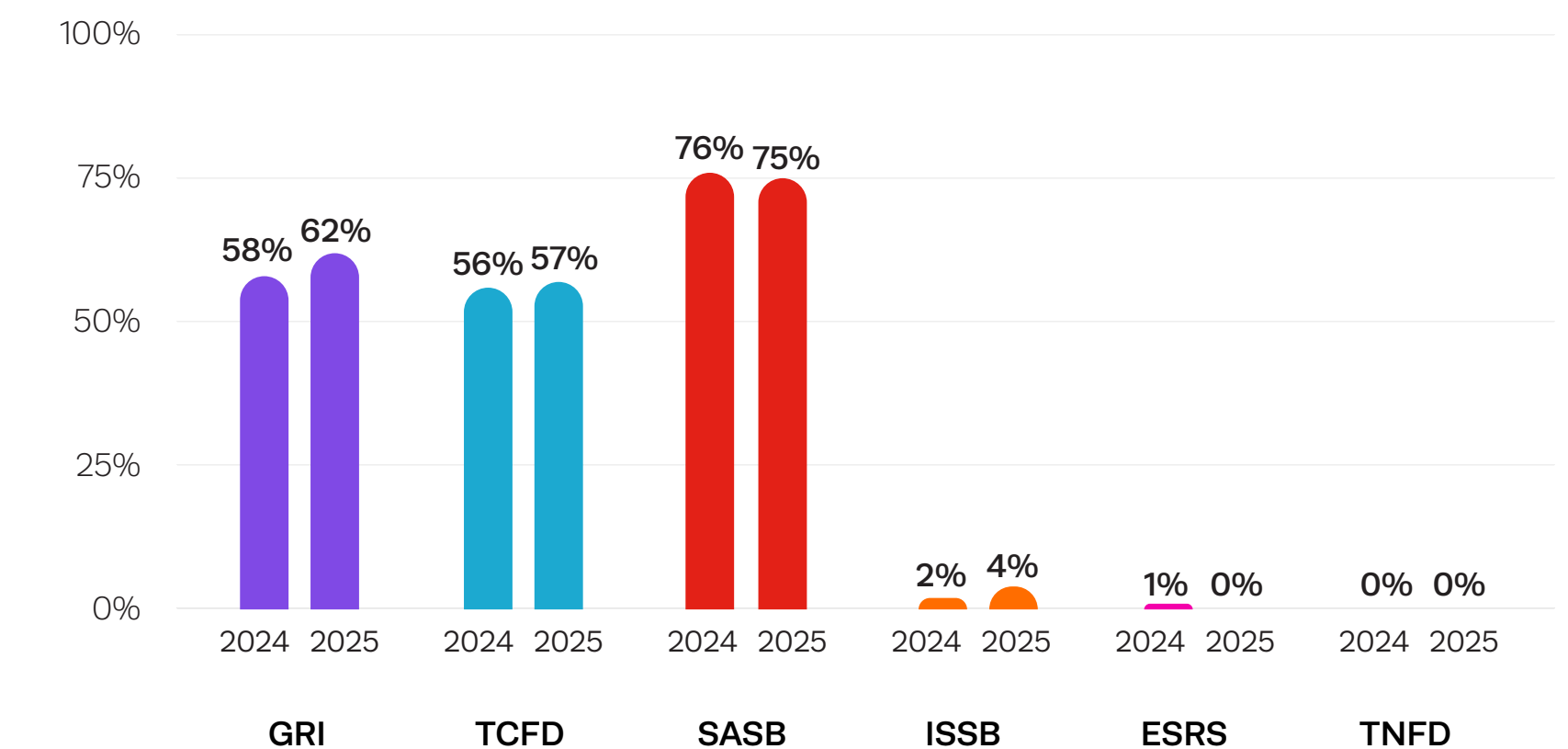
### Reporting Overview: 2-Year Trend

Percentage of Information Technology Sector Companies Publishing Sustainability Reports



### Frameworks & Standards: 2-Year Trend

Percentage of Information Technology Sector Reporters Aligning with GRI, TCFD, SASB, ISSB, ESRs, TNFD





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## Materials

Total Companies in Russell 1000

2024

56

2025

55

### 2025 Key Statistics

1

Non-reporters  
remaining

+1 from 2024

98%

Reporting **down**  
from 100% in 2024

### Top SDGs

13

Climate Action

12

Responsible Consumption  
& Production

8

Decent Work &  
Economic Growth

6

Clean Water & Sanitation

3

Good Health &  
Well-Being

## 2025 Assurance Details



of Materials **reporters**  
sought external assurance

-2 percentage points  
from prior year

### Scope

3%

Sustainability  
Report

25%

GHG Only

72%

Specified  
Section(s)

### Level

91%

Limited /  
Moderate

0%

Reasonable /  
High

9%

Combination

0%

Not  
Specified

### Provider

6%

Consulting  
Firm

38%

Accountant

50%

Engineering  
Firm

6%

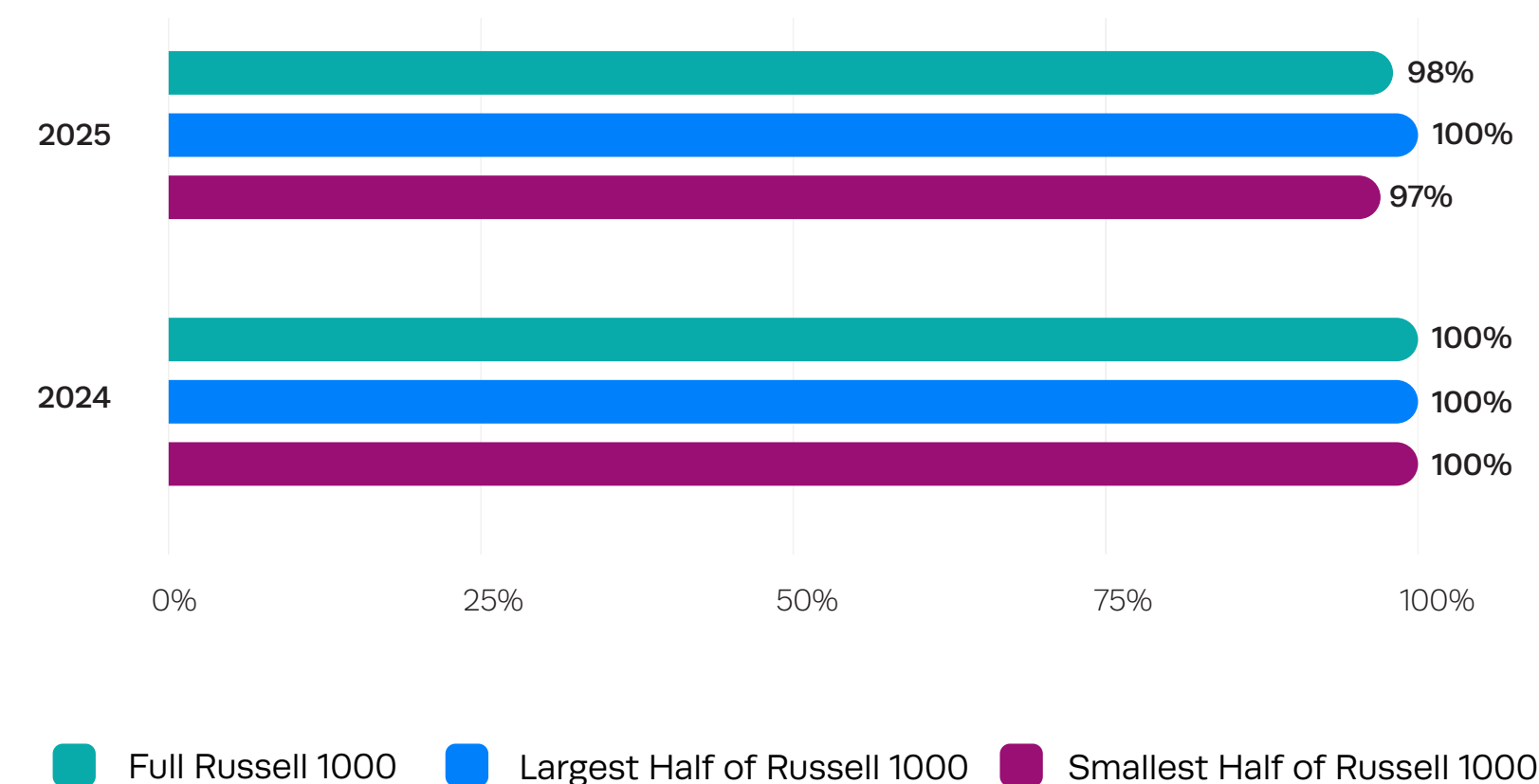
Not  
Specified

0%

Combination

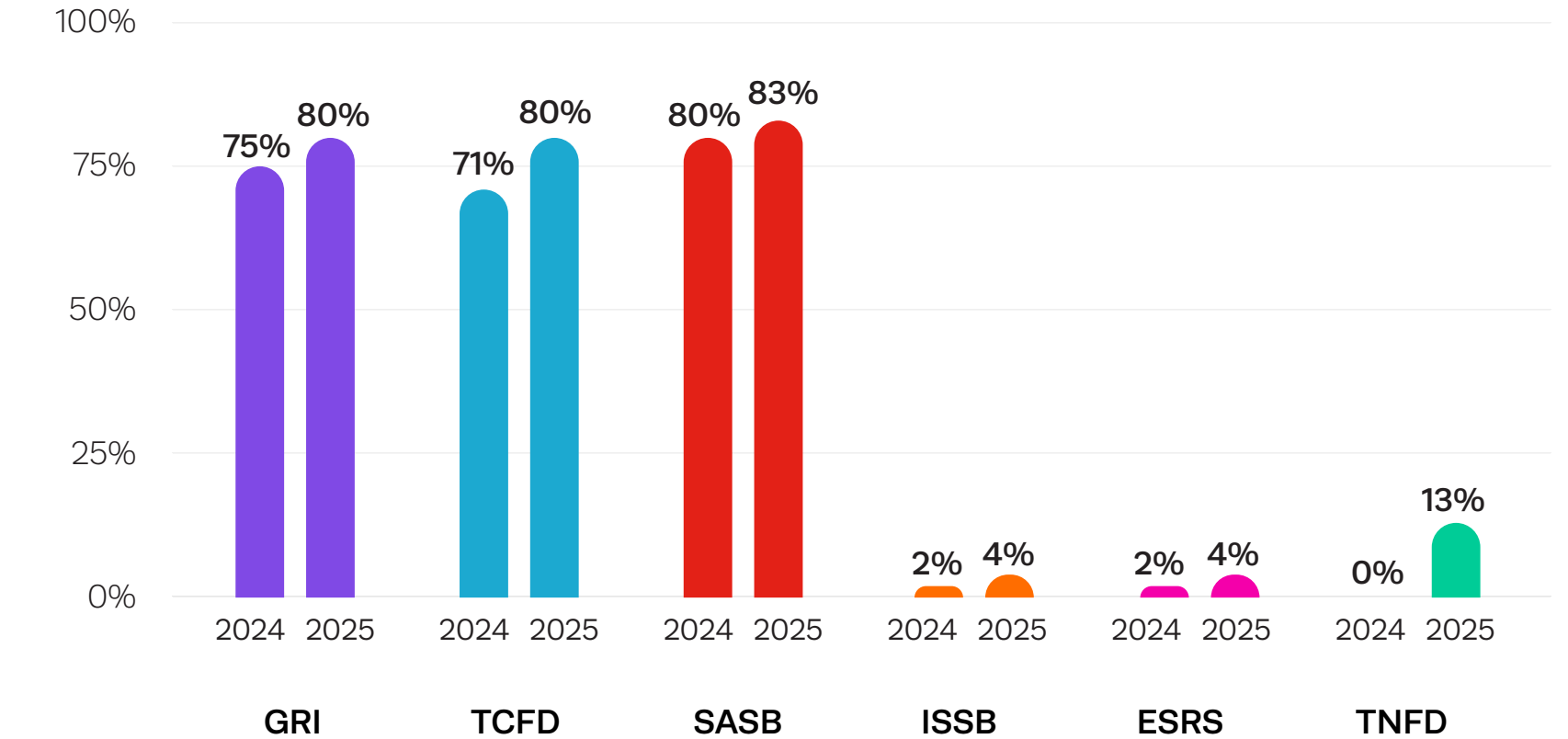
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Percentage of Materials Sector Companies Publishing Sustainability Reports



## Frameworks & Standards: 2-Year Trend

Percentage of Materials Sector Reporters Aligning with GRI, TCFD, SASB, ISSB, ESRS, TNFD







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## Real Estate

Total Companies in Russell 1000

2024  
62

2025  
64

### 2025 Key Statistics

5

Non-reporters  
remaining

+3 from 2024

92%

Reporting **down**  
from 97% in 2024

### Top SDGs

7

Affordable & Clean Energy

13

Climate Action

11

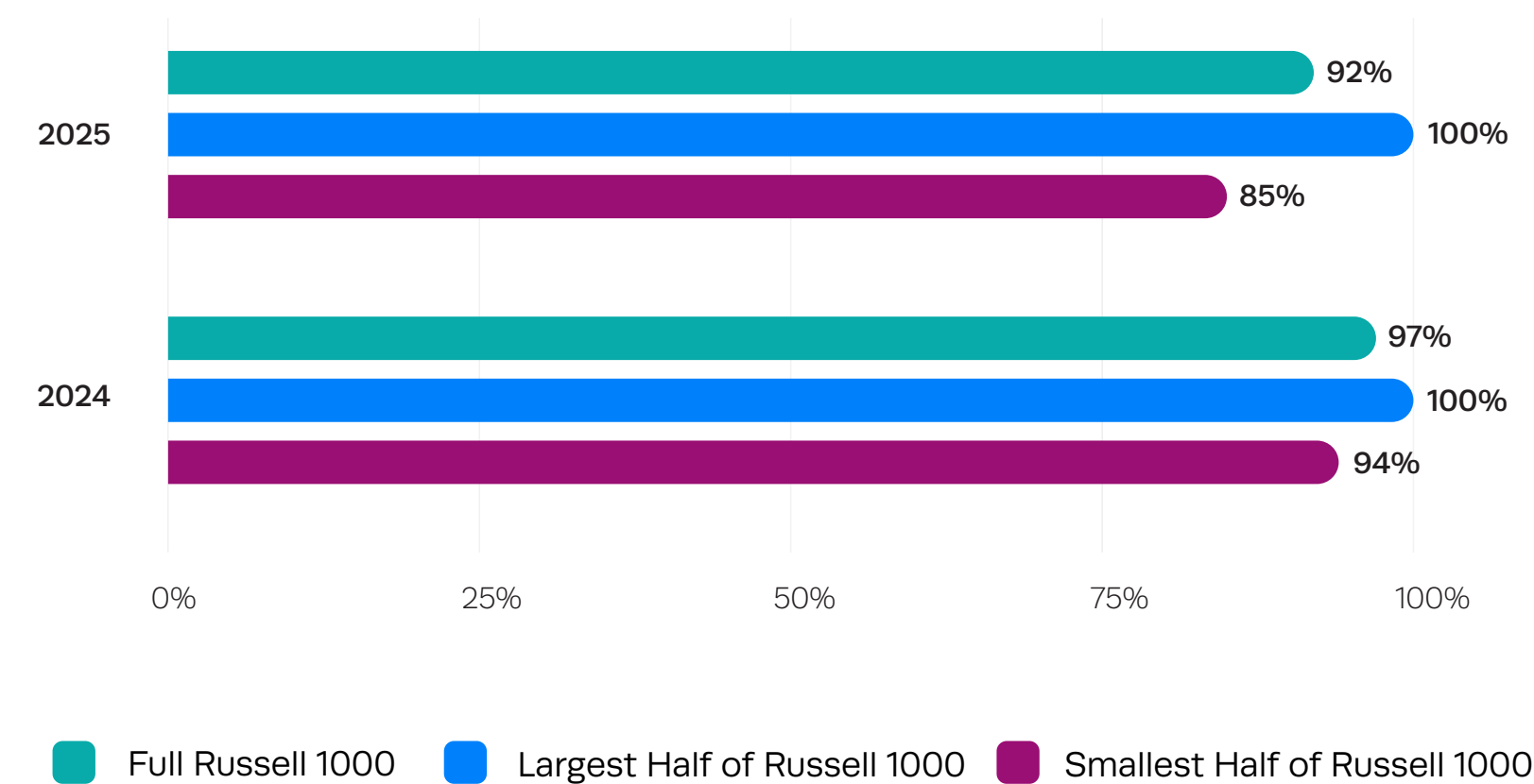
Sustainable Cities  
& Communities

8

Decent Work &  
Economic Growth

### Reporting Overview: 2-Year Trend

Percentage of Real Estate Sector Companies Publishing Sustainability Reports



### 2025 Assurance Details



of Real Estate **reporters**  
sought external assurance

+6 percentage points  
from prior year

#### Scope

2%

Sustainability  
Report

21%

GHG Only

76%

Specified  
Section(s)

#### Level

83%

Limited /  
Moderate

5%

Reasonable /  
High

2%

Combination

10%

Not  
Specified

#### Provider

33%

Consulting  
Firm

7%

Accountant

57%

Engineering  
Firm

2%

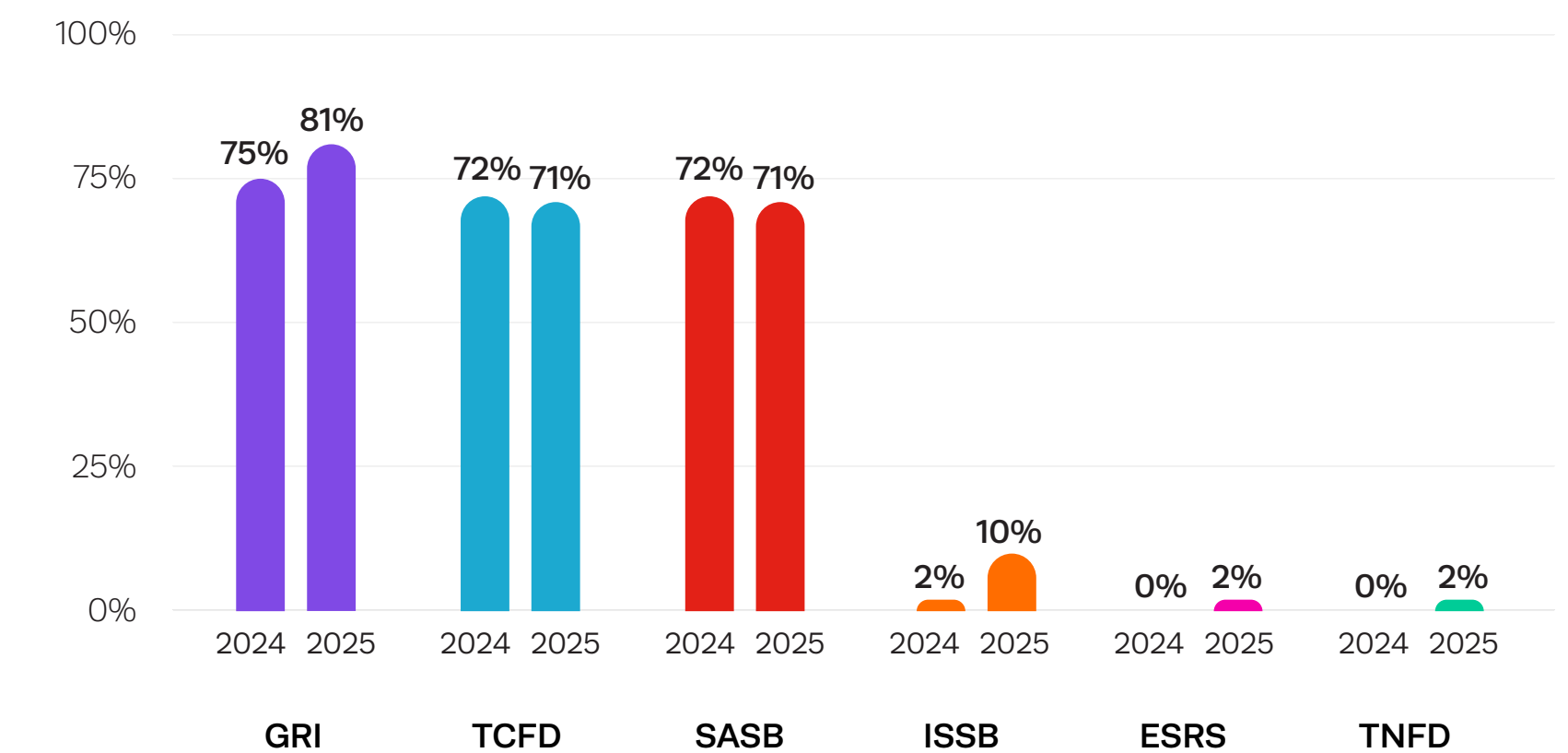
Not  
Specified

0%

Combination

### Frameworks & Standards: 2-Year Trend

Percentage of Real Estate Sector Reporters Aligning with GRI, TCFD, SASB, ISSB, ESRS, TNFD





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## Utilities

Total Companies in Russell 1000

2024  
39

2025  
40

### 2025 Key Statistics

4

Non-reporters  
remaining

+4 from 2024

90%

Reporting down  
from 100% in 2024

### Top SDGs

- 7 Affordable & Clean Energy
- 13 Climate Action
- 9 Industry, Innovation & Infrastructure
- 11 Sustainable Cities & Communities
- 8 Decent Work & Economic Growth

## 2025 Assurance Details



of Utilities **reporters**  
sought external assurance

+2 percentage points  
from prior year

### Scope

0% Sustainability Report  
81% GHG Only  
19% Specified Section(s)

### Level

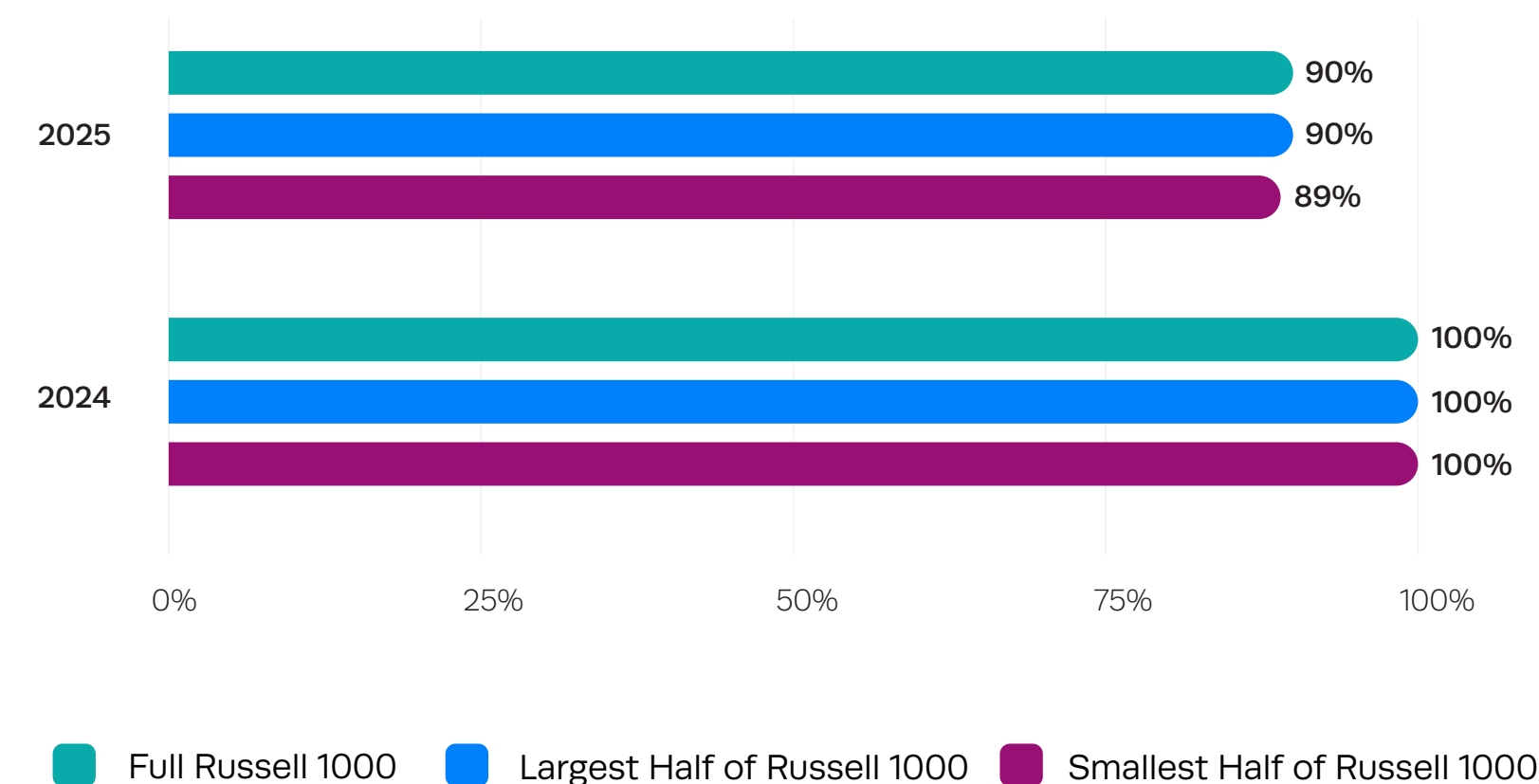
62% Limited / Moderate  
10% Reasonable / High  
14% Combination  
14% Not Specified

### Provider

14% Consulting Firm  
19% Accountant  
52% Engineering Firm  
10% Not Specified  
5% Combination

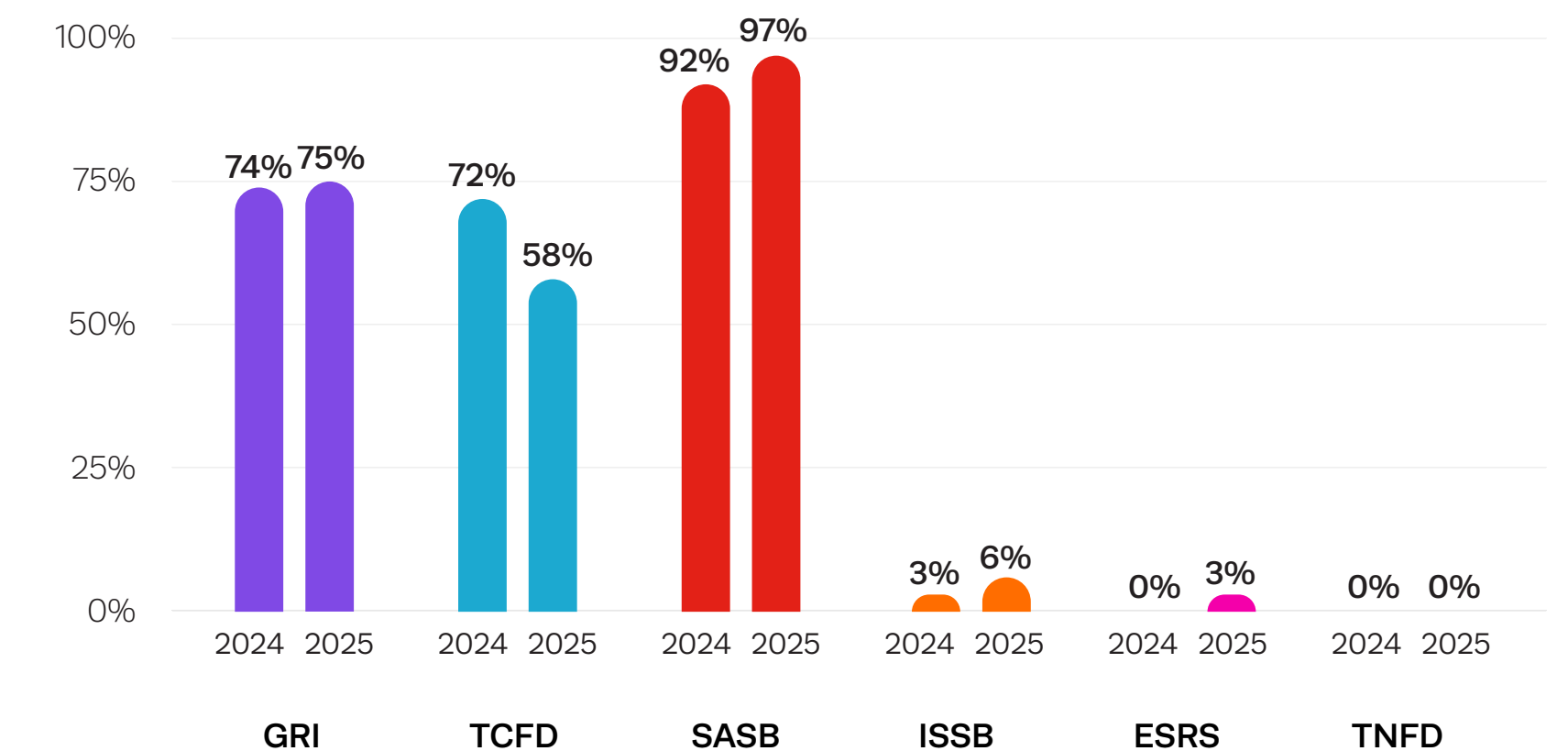
## Reporting Overview: 2-Year Trend

Percentage of Utilities Sector Companies Publishing Sustainability Reports



## Frameworks & Standards: 2-Year Trend

Percentage of Utilities Sector Reporters Aligning with GRI, TCFD, SASB, ISSB, ESRS, TNFD





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# Changes to the Reporting Landscape

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At the time of publishing this report, Russell 1000 companies faced lingering uncertainty about the status of mandatory climate reporting in the U.S., while political factors and international regulations raised pressure to disclose on various sustainability topics, often through the lens of materiality. This has led to a period of recalibration in sustainability reporting – the nascent effects of which are captured in the 2025 data we analyze in this report. This recalibration may continue in the year ahead as companies seek to understand and navigate regulatory, political, and reputational risk.

As U.S. multinationals wait for a confirmed reporting deadline for California’s climate disclosures, they also face increasing regulations around the world aligned with IFRS and ESRS, which respectively take a financial materiality and a double materiality lens. Companies’ latest reporting behaviors indicate a trending cautious approach to navigating these waters: streamlining public disclosures in line with materiality-based mandates, while taking a “wait and see” approach on regulations that are yet to be finalized. The stay on California’s Climate-Related Financial Risk Act (SB 261), and the delay on its Climate Corporate Data Accountability Act (SB 253), for example, have led many in-scope companies to withhold the preparation or release of reports that had previously been due in the first half of 2026.

Another judgment call companies face in the coming year, given the primacy of materiality in reporting mandates, is whether to continue to voluntarily report non-material information in annual sustainability reports. Legal departments in particular face the question: is more disclosure beneficial or does it jeopardize the company’s position? Even with a smaller scope of companies subject to the CSRD, and many U.S. companies not expected to report until the year 2028, this consideration may lead to a retraction in voluntary reporting as companies seek to minimize the risks that come from releasing varied versions of their sustainability information.

Looking forward, this set of factors leaves double materiality in a strong position. It is increasingly popular even among companies not subject to CSRD, and is emerging as the best practice for companies of all sizes that are looking to create or refresh their sustainability strategies.

We anticipate that reporting initiatives that align with, or have interoperability with, mandatory regulations are more likely to remain in a company’s disclosure practices, while more variability may emerge when it comes to reporting in alignment or accordance with voluntary standards.

In spite of uncertainties, common ground exists between initiatives, especially in the areas of governance, strategy, management, and metrics. Companies may wish to focus on those elements, which are relevant to ESRS, IFRS, and the California climate laws.

While U.S. companies prepare to consolidate their data for reporting at the group level for ESRS and California reporting requirements, we expect a counter force to the consolidation trend, as some companies will also need to provide country-level data in jurisdictions that are adopting the IFRS S1 and S2 Standards. New, smaller scopes of sustainability metrics will need to be reported by multinational companies, as jurisdiction-specific requirements expand – not only for metrics within the IFRS, but for other requirements such as extended producer responsibility (EPR) data for packaging, as well. At the same time, customer data requests may include metrics that no longer align with the supplier company’s mandatory reporting; though public disclosures may be tightened, the need to maintain data and targets in line with key customers remains.

In 2026, the largest companies in the U.S. are navigating competing requests, priorities, and pressures. Two groups of companies appear on track for the smoothest year in sustainability reporting. First, those with mature sustainability data collection and reporting practices will be better positioned for compliance due to the interoperability and consolidation trends that G&A has tracked in recent years. Meanwhile, companies that consistently track data requested by other stakeholders will be better positioned to respond to requests from customers reflecting other priorities. A discerning sustainability strategy will be required in order for companies to weather competing pressures in their current environment.



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# In Focus – Climate

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When G&A first began tracking trends in corporate sustainability reporting 15 years ago, many of the climate standards, frameworks, and tools now widely used across the Russell 1000 were not yet developed, or were in their infancy. These initiatives have collectively accelerated climate disclosure and emissions management, as the trends throughout this report demonstrate. But it's also become clear that these standards need updating to stay relevant for the next 15 years and beyond. In response, both SBTi and the GHG Protocol are actively revising their standards and guidance.

Although the GHG Protocol released its groundbreaking Corporate Accounting and Reporting Standard back in **2001**, the supplemental guidance documents that most companies now rely on to build their GHG inventories came later. The Scope 3 Standard followed in **2011**, establishing a framework for companies to account for emissions across their value chains. Scope 2 Guidance came next in **2015**, giving companies targeted direction for addressing emissions from purchased energy. This guidance also laid the foundation for the modern renewable electricity market through market-based emissions accounting. That same year, SBTi launched to help companies manage emissions through formal target-setting, and in **2017** TCFD released its recommendations, creating a standardized framework for disclosing climate-related financial risks and opportunities.

**2026** gave us our first real look at how those familiar, and important, institutions may evolve. SBTi released Version 2.0 of the Corporate Net-Zero Standard in **June 2026**, with updates designed to alleviate the technical complexity that had discouraged many companies from setting targets in the first place. The updated Standard introduces a five-year target cycle, with the base year reset to the most recent year of available emissions data at the start of each cycle. This ensures the base year reflects a company's current structure and emissions profile. Progress toward net-zero-aligned targets will now be assessed on a best-efforts basis throughout the cycle, with room to course-correct if a target isn't met.

Historically, many companies hesitated to commit to net-zero targets with distant end dates (2045, 2050). These long timeframes often seemed out of alignment with typical three-to-five-year corporate planning cycles. That mismatch has shown up in our data on corporate practices: science-based target adoption among the Russell 1000 has skewed heavily toward near-term targets. By breaking the long-term goal into more manageable milestones, the shift to five-year cycles may make net-zero-aligned targets a more realistic commitment for more companies.

## G&A COLLABORATION

## Early Trends in Climate Risk Reporting in California

Lessons from Initial Voluntary Corporate Reports Under California's SB 261



By breaking the long-term goal into more manageable milestones, the shift to five-year cycles may make net-zero-aligned targets a more realistic commitment for more companies."





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It has also been a productive year for the GHG Protocol. In **January 2026**, it released the Land Sector and Removals Guidance, establishing the first official standard for accounting for emissions and carbon removals from agricultural land use and carbon removal technologies. That came alongside progress to revise the Scope 2 and Scope 3 Standards.

While they are not yet finalized at the time of this writing, the Protocol's Scope 3 progress update and Scope 2 draft guidance provide early indicators about the future state of carbon accounting.

The proposed revisions focus on increasing the integrity of data and the accuracy of emissions calculations. As GHG accounting has become standard practice for most publicly-traded companies, the underlying standards must evolve to keep pace to ensure emissions can be measured, compared, and trusted with a level of rigor the market now expects.

To review key changes being proposed, see recent [G&A's issue brief](#).

Taken together, these 2026 updates mark an inflection point for corporate climate accounting. After 15 years in which companies were largely asked simply to report emissions, the common thread in updates to the SBTi and GHG Protocol standards is toward holding those numbers to a much higher standard of proof. The next 15 years of climate disclosure is likely to be defined less by whether a company discloses its GHG emissions and more by how rigorously it can substantiate what it reports. Companies that begin building that data infrastructure now will be better positioned to meet these new expectations as updates take effect around 2027.

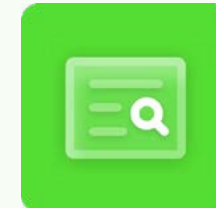
## Need support evolving your GHG accounting? G&A can help!



### Scope 1 & 2 GHG Emissions Inventory

Understand the climate impacts  
of your operations

[Learn More →](#)



### Scope 3 GHG Emissions Inventory

Discover your company's full climate  
impact with a Scope 3 Inventory

[Learn More →](#)



### Product GHG Inventory

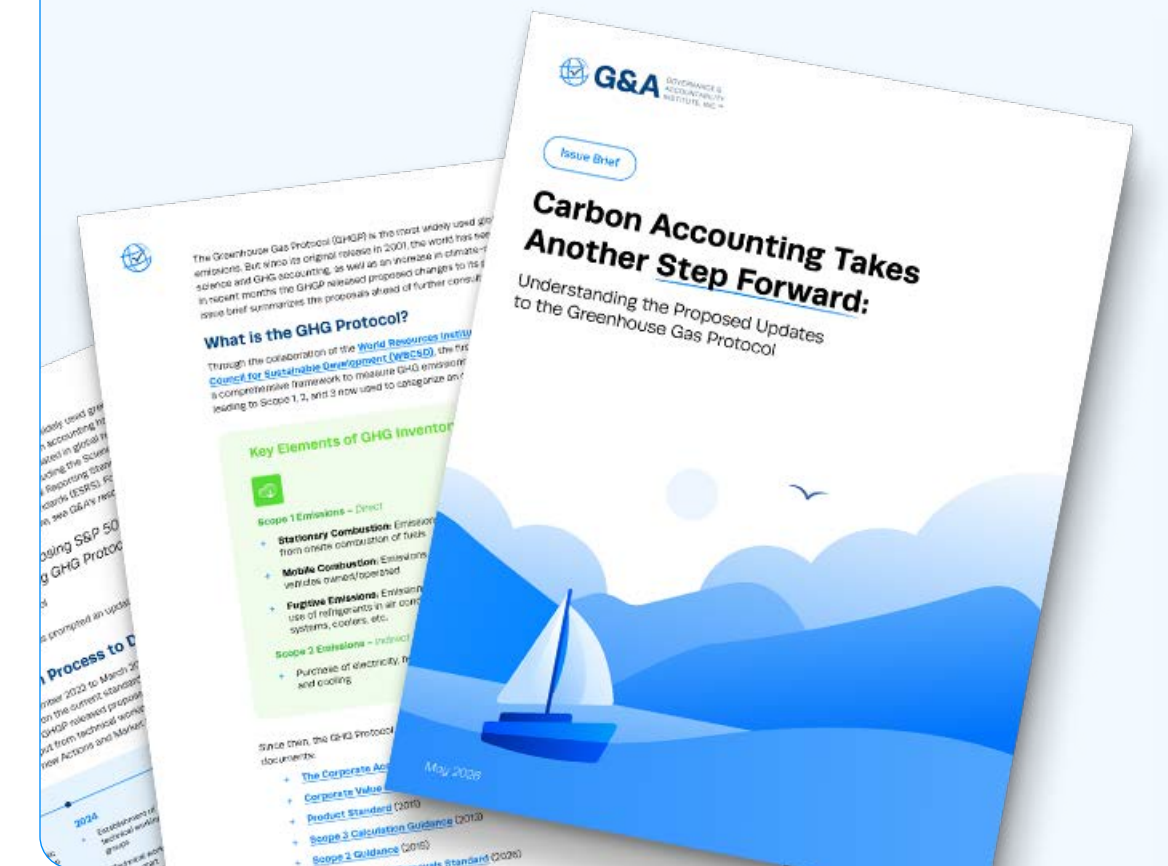
Measure the carbon footprint  
of your products

[Learn More →](#)

## G&A ISSUE BRIEF

## Carbon Accounting Takes Another Step Forward

Understanding the Proposed Updates  
to the Greenhouse Gas Protocol



After 15 years in which companies were largely asked simply to report emissions, the trend in updates to the SBTi and GHG Protocol standards is toward holding those numbers to a much higher standard of proof."





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# Our Research Team

Each year, a small group of highly qualified analysts research, document, and analyze the prior year’s corporate sustainability disclosure and reporting activities. G&A’s CEO and Co-Founder, Louis Coppola, has been the architect and overall manager of the research since our first analysis in 2011. In 2026, the G&A analyst team worked under the supervision of Charlotte Perrottey, VP of Sustainability Consulting, and Natali Alsunna, Senior Sustainability Analyst. We proudly recognize this year’s talented intern analysts, April Ransom, Jillian Gordon, Phoebe Ryu, and Sheccid Rodríguez, who were led by Amelia Veleber, Intern Team Leader. We also acknowledge members of G&A’s core team who supported the research and development of this report.

**Louis Coppola** New York

Research Architect and Manager

CEO & Co-Founder

**Charlotte Perrottey** New York

Research Supervisor

VP, Sustainability Consulting

**Natali Alsunna** Florida

Team Leader

Senior Sustainability Analyst

**Madeline Blankenship** Georgia

Senior Sustainability Analyst

**Neva Modric** Montana

Sustainability Analyst

**Amelia Veleber** New Jersey

Intern Team Leader

BS, Environmental Sciences & Sustainability, Ecology & Policy  
Double Major, 2025

**April Ransom** New York

Intern Analyst

MSc, Sustainable Communities, 2026  
BS, Environmental Science, 2024

**Jillian Gordon** Texas

Intern Analyst

BS, Environmental Science, 2025

**Phoebe Ryu** New Jersey

Intern Analyst

MS, Environmental Sciences, 2026  
BS, Environmental Sciences, 2025

**Sheccid Rodríguez** Washington, DC

Intern Analyst

MS, Environment & Sustainability Management, 2026  
BA, Political Science and Environmental Studies, 2025

Additional Support

**Kirstie Dabbs** Pennsylvania

Director, Client Sustainability Solutions

**Faye Leone** New York

SVP, Sustainability Content

**Lucas Alvarez** Georgia

SVP, Creative Design

**Chloe Aldrich** Texas

Senior Creative Designer

**Christina Carlton** Washington

Senior Sustainability and Climate Analyst

## Interested in Participating?

Details on the 2027–2028 Research Analyst Internship will be posted [here](#) later this year.

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THEN 2018 ··· 2025 NOW

Our research team was our entire staff (of three!)

Three experienced analysts guide five interns to track trends in corporate disclosure practices, supported by designers, writers, and senior leadership

# Specialized Team, Expansive Offerings

Founded in 2006, Governance & Accountability Institute (G&A) is a New York–based sustainability consulting and research firm advising corporate leaders and investors at the intersection of strategy, governance, and regulation. For two decades, we have partnered with executive teams and boards to translate sustainability strategy into durable enterprise value — helping organizations navigate shifting market expectations, evolving policy landscapes, and increasing capital market scrutiny.

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## Sustainability & ESG

We partner with organizations to shape strategy, strengthen ESG management and reporting, and navigate evolving disclosure requirements with practical, data-driven insight.



## Climate & Nature

We help organizations assess climate risk, reduce emissions, and plan for mitigation with data-driven strategies.



## Communications & Design

From strategy to execution, we help organizations communicate sustainability performance through reporting, campaigns, and digital experiences.



## Investor Relations

From ESG investor relations consulting to reporting and engagement, we help organizations translate sustainability performance into clear, decision-useful insights for capital markets.



## Corporate Sustainability Reporting



## GHG Emissions Inventory



## Printed Content



## ESG Data Rater Engagement



## Materiality Assessment



## Climate-related Risk and Opportunity Assessment



## Interview Video Series



## Investor Perception Studies



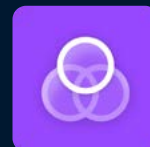
## CDP Response



## SBTi Target Setting



## Social Media Campaign



## Shareholder Base Profiling

Discover More



Discover More



Discover More



Discover More







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# Permission to Use

## Our Findings Are for All

G&A is proud to invite your in-depth review of our comprehensive research findings and analysis. As a public service to further G&A's mission of education and information-sharing, we publish annual updates on the sustainability reporting trends found in this report to inform the corporate sustainability community. Our findings are meant to be used by various stakeholder groups, including investors, companies, professionals, governments, and more.

Permission is granted for reuse of data results and the graphics presented throughout this publication with accurate attribution to G&A. Please provide a link back to our website as a source ([ga-institute.com](https://ga-institute.com)).

### Want to know more? Let's Talk!

For information about G&A's Russell 1000 Index research effort and our suite of sustainability, ESG, and climate change services, contact:

**646.430.8230**

[info@ga-institute.com](mailto:info@ga-institute.com)

[ga-institute.com](https://ga-institute.com)

**Governance & Accountability Institute, Inc.**

14 Wall Street, 20th Floor  
New York, New York 10005

